Coefficient Extraction Operators in the Theory of Multidimensional Random Walk Enumeration

by

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Abstract

In this work we apply an operator approach to multidimensional random walk enumeration in order to automatize some of the process in solving these problems. In particular given a random walk model in any number of dimensions we can use operators to write down a functional equation $(1 - t\Gamma S)Q = q$ for the generating function Q where Γ is an operator and S is the Laurent step polynomial for the model. Further we use the operator perspective to further and unify some of the different kernel methods (orbit and obstinate methods in particular). This operator paradigm work for both classic random walk models and models with interactions with hyperplanes. Near the end we solve some two-dimensional problems with interactions.

Preface

This work intends to establish a new framework of notation and tools for the enumeration of random walks with or without interactions, and similar problems. The notation makes it much easier to explore the symmetries of the problem and write down summation formulas where it was not possible to do so before (with a simplified notation). The tools make the derivation of functional equations for various problems an almost trivial matter. The real power is in combining both approaches to gain insights into the generating function world of enumerating random walks on constrained regions in multidimensional spaces.

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Glossary

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Why do we study random walks? Apart from being an interesting mathematical object that leads to a lot of interesting mathematics, they have some real world applications. A lot of processes can be modeled via random walks - from stock market objects to proteins and polymers. There is a rich theory of continuous and discrete random walks. Specifically in random walk enumeration we attempt to find out things about the numbers of walks of some length and of certain type with certain geometrical constraints. The topic often leads to the use of generating functions as a powerful tool in the analysis. In the end we gain insight into what makes certain random walk models "easy" and others more difficult. In this thesis we look at the enumeration for constrained random walks with interactions in order to gain insight into the deeper workings of random walk enumeration problems.

1.1 Recent History

With the terminology from autorefch:Preliminaries in place we are ready to discuss some of the recent history of random walk enumeration. In the most basic case random walks starting at the origin on d dimensions have no restrictions $\mathcal{D}$ is the whole space and there are no interactions. We can enumerate these walks easily by writing the full generating function

$$\begin{aligned} Q(x_1, \ldots, x_d; t) &= \frac{1}{1 - tS(x_1, \ldots, x_d)} \\ &= 1 + tS(x_1, \ldots, x_d) + t^2 S(x_1, \ldots, x_d)^2 + \cdots . \end{aligned} \tag{1.1}$$

This works since we can use each individual steps and every walk is uniquely represented by a sequence of steps from $\mathcal{S}$. This works for arbitrary initial conditions too since we can start the walks at any point and evolve them. The coefficients of each power of t are Laurent polynomials in the variables $x_1, \ldots, x_d$. If we have the generating function for a random walk model we have a

lot of information at our hands. Replacing x_k with 0 for each k gives us the generating function for walks returning to the origing. Similarly taking higher derivatives and evaluating at zero allows us to find the number of walks ending at specific points. If we set all the $x_k = 1$ inf Q we obtain the length generating function for the random walks in the plane. There are numerous questions we can ask about each of those characteristics of the model.

The nest step up is to deal with half-spaces - here $\mathcal{D}$ is the region where one of the $x_k \geqslant 0$. These cases are not as simple to solve but they are doable. Check [3], [4], [5] and [6] for work on the one-dimensional case that can be extended to general d. The generating functions we can obtain are algebraic. Naturally we are led to consider cases where $\mathcal{D}$ is an intersection of half-spaces. Even for $d = 2$ the problem has generated a rich theory of quadrant (or quarter-plane) walks. We obtain functional equations for the function Q that are not easy to solve in general - often the generating functions here are not even D-finite although there are D-finite examples. The main object of study in these cases has been a group G of bi-rational transformations preserving the polynomial $K = 1 - tS$ called the kernel of the model.

When G is finite (in the 23 non-equivalent cases) we obtain a D-finite generating function (full?) as can be seen the classifications [7],[8] and [9], [10] for specific cases. The main tool in the study of the finite group cases has been the algebraic kernel method in which we sum different functional equations produced by group actions by elements of G in order to cancel the majority of the terms in the functional equation. See [11] for treatment of models with repeated steps with finite groups.

There are 56 non-equivalent cases of quarter-plane walks with an infinite group. For 51 of them both the full generating function [12] and the length generating function for walks returning to the origin are not D-finite [13]. The remaining 5 cases have been dealt with in [14] and [15]. The main tool used to tackle these 5 cases is the iterated kernel method in which we use the roots of the kernel K to show the generating function is not D-finite.

Naturally we are led to invesitigating higher-dimensional variants of this problem. See [16] and [17] for when $\mathcal{D}$ is a Weyl chamber. In three dimensions we have the recent partial classification [18] of random walk models with up to six steps where the authors extend the algebraic kernel method to handle the majority of finite group cases encountered.

Another generalization is to consider walks with interactions and/or self-avoiding walks (or SAWs). These two types of generalizations have important applications in physics because they can be used to model polymers, proteins and other chains. For some research on SAWs with various interactions see [19],[20], [**?**] [21], [22], [23] and [24]. The topic of SAWs doesn't lend itself as nicely to using generating functions like the ones considered so far so as a simpler first step we can consider regular random walks with interactions. See [25] and [26] for walks with interactions in an octact. See [27], [28], and [29] for walks with interactions in the plane.

A long-standing dream goal in random walk enumeration research is the automatization of the process of determining characteristics of the models and similar problems. There has been some progress in this direction. See for example [30] and [31] for details on symmetric functions, [32] for a holonomic approach to combinatorics, [33] for automatic classification of lattice walks, and finally [34] for some of the computational challenges involved in automation.

A related subject of study is the asymptotics of random walks where some automation can be performed. For examples of the theory see [35], [36] and [37]. A lot of the works mentioned so far have also discussed asymptotics.

1.2 Thesis Objectives

This thesis grew out of work on regular quadrant random walks with interactions with the axes. The derivation of the functional equation in the non-interacting case is a simple inclusion-exclusion process but doing the same for the interacting case is somewhat more involved. It is possible to further simplify the equation via coefficient extraction and back-substitution. It works out beautifully to give us a much more compact functional equation. However, the process is quite painstaking even for three dimensions, let alone for higher-dimensions, although it is possible.

The mathematicians who study random walk enumeration have as a goal to classify random walks according to various characteristics like step set, dimension, group size associated to the kernel, and perhaps most importantly - D-finitenes. They also dream of being able to make the process automatic whenever it is possible. In this thesis we aim to further the study of random walk models towards this goal of automatization. We might as well be as optimistic as possible and suppose that a general algorithm exists that takes an arbitrary random walk model - in arbitrarily many dimensions, with arbitrary finite step sets and with arbitrary constraints, and outputs various data about the model - functional equation for the generating function, a solution and information about the model's D-finiteness. It is only logical that if such an algorithm were to exist it would not have difficulty with the particulars of the random walk model. While this kind of algorithm may be too strong to envision (it may be the case that there are atrocious random walk models which we cannot solve), the idea of the existence of such an algorithm has been a strong motivator in our pursuit of generalization. This thesis succeeds in demonstrating that the first task is achievable. For a vast assortment of random walk models we can almost-automatically write down a functional equation for its generating function counting length, position and interactions of the random walks. The equation looks like

$$(1 - t\Gamma S)Q = q \tag{1.2}$$

where Γ is an operator on the variables of Q, S is the Laurent step polynomial (keeping inventory of the steps in polynomial form) and q is some Laurent polynomial initial condition. The operator idea is powerful and we'll use it as much as we can in this thesis. A secondary achievement is the furthering of the theory of the orbit summation method which along with the obstinate kernel method combine in a nicer theory of operators consisting of group actions. However time and space have not been sufficient to go too far in these lines. Near the end we present some solutions and partial solutions to random walk problems in two dimensions with interactions.

1.3 Layout of Thesis

In the first few chapters we go through motivating examples which will serve as a springboard into further generalizations. First we'll start off with one-dimensional random walks with and without interactions in Chapter 2. Then we'll quickly move on to two-dimensional random walks in **??**. On the way we'll develop some of the basic operator theory involved in the random walk models. In Chapter 4 we'll make a detour to random walks on a honeycomb lattice - a problem that will show some of the group-theoretic and operator tools. In Chapter 5 we'll tackle the d-dimensional random walk model functional equations using operators. In chapter 6 we'll finally go through operators in a much generality as we can, deriving all sorts of properties for them along the way. In chapter 7 we'll discuss generalizations of the random walk models and we'll push the operator notation as far as we can to see what kind of problem we can hope to tackle with the theory.

In Chapter 8 we'll become more practical and deal with group-theoretic operators relevant to both two-dimensional and higher-dimensional random walk models. In Chapter 9 we extend the persistent kernel method as much as we can for the two-dimensional interacting walks. Then in Chapter 10 we attempt to solve as many highly-symmetrical two-dimensional interacting models as we can via the vanishing kernel method. In Chapter 11 we work on some models with higher group orders.

1.4 Notation and Conventions

1.4.1 Formal Series

We will work in the setting of formal power series and Laurent series. Issues with convergence will not be addressed in much detail. If we are given a ring R we may construct several formal objects with a commutative indeterminate x with coefficients in R.

- $R[x]$: Ring of polynomials with monomials x^k for integers $k \geqslant 0$.

- $R[x, 1/x]$: Ring of Laurent polynomials with monomials x^k for integers k.
- $R[[x]]$: Ring of formal power series with monomials x^k for integers $k \geqslant 0$.
- $R((x))$: Field of formal Laurent series with monomials x^k for integers k.

We can also define their multivariate analogues like $R[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$, $R[x_1, \overline{x_1}, \ldots, x_n, \overline{x}_n]$ and their series counterparts $R[[x_1, \ldots, x_n]]$ and $R((x_1, \ldots, x_n))$. For a thorough treatment of the subject please see [1]. When we work with a combination of objects coming from different rings/fields over the indeterminate x we'll consider all objects as part of the most general ring/field at the time. If in doubt, we'll always work in the field of formal Laurent series. Given a sequence (w_n) we may consider its generating function $W(x)$ given by $\sum_n w_n x^n$ which lives appropriately in one of the rings over x. The multivariate case for a multi-index sequence $(w_{n_1,\ldots,n_m})$ is defined analogously as

$$W(x_1, \ldots, x_d) = \sum_{n_1,\ldots,n_m} w_{n_1,\ldots,n_m} x_1^{n_1} \ldots x_m^{n_m} \tag{1.3}$$

whenever this series is a formal Laurent series. When we solve enumeration problems via generating functions we often need to extract particular coefficients from the formal polynomial/series. In the one-variable case we have the coefficient extraction operators on formal series

$$[x^n]W(x) = w_n \,. \tag{1.4}$$

The multivariate case is handled analogously with the caveat that whenever the number of variables extracted is less than the number of variables present we extract by treating these remaining variables as parameters. For a more detailed discussion please consult [2]. When we deal random walk generating functions we often work with functional equations. In the broadest sense in this thesis we'll discuss functional equations which may involve a function F, the function evaluated at various arguments and various coefficient extractions of F. This will be done via operators so in the end we'll have a functional equation involving F and operators. We'll write the identity operator as 1.

1.4.2 Random Walk Models

In this work we'll investigate random walk models on the n-dimensional lattice $\mathbb{Z}^n$. A specific model $\mathcal{M}$ will consist of several ingredients

- $\mathcal{S}$: a finite set of steps that we can take from a point in $\mathbb{Z}^n$ to another point in $\mathbb{Z}^n$. In general this step set may differ from point to point (e.g., a honeycomb lattice embedded in $\mathbb{Z}^2$). The

steps themselves will be written as vectors $s = (s_1, \ldots, s_n)$. For example $\mathcal{S}$ could be a set of small steps defined by coordinates among $\{-1, 0, 1\}$. Another example is when we have more than one step of a given kind.

- $\mathcal{D}$: a domain for the random walks. This is the region in $\mathbb{Z}^n$ where the random walks will live. The easiest cases involve the whole space or a half-space. Starting with quarter-plane regions the analysis becomes rather complicated. One can further constrain the walks to live on semi-infinite strips.

- $\mathcal{D}_0$: an interaction domain for the random walks. This is a sub-region in $\mathcal{D}$ and we'll want to count how many times random walks interact with it by stepping on coordinates that are part of it. We may count different points from $\mathcal{D}_0$ in different ways. This less-studied paradigm may involve marking visits to the origin, axes in two dimensions, various higher-dimensional hyperplanes, a cone, infinite strip, the sides of a box and so on.

- $\mathcal{Q}$: a set of random walks acting as an initial condition from which all other random walks evolve. This could be as trivial as starting with the empty walk ending at the origin to a set of infinitely many walks with some pattern.

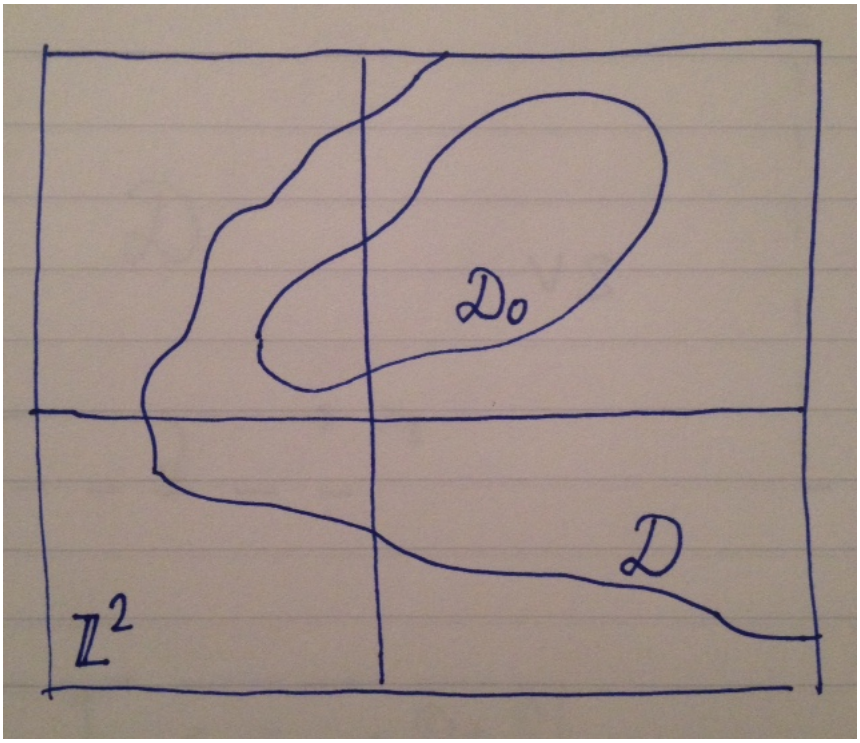


Figure 1.1: The regions

It is natural to consider the generating function that will keep track of all the information characterizing the random walks in the model. For each random walk w its length $|w|$ will be the total number of steps that it was taken and we'll keep track of it via a parameter t. We'll keep track of its endpoint coordinates in $\mathbb{Z}^n$ by the indeterminates $x_1, \ldots, x_n$ and its interactions with $\mathcal{D}_0$ via marking parameters a_m where m is some specific subscript index. The marking is highly dependent on the geometry of $\mathcal{D}_0$ and the way we want to count interactions. If the end coordinates of the random walk are $(m_1, \ldots, m_n)$ and if the marking monomial (a product of a_m's) is $a(w)$ we can write the generating function for the random walk model as

$$Q(x_1, \ldots, x_n; t) = \sum_{w \in \mathcal{M}} a(w) x_1^{m_1} \ldots x_n^{m_n} t^{|w|} \,. \tag{1.5}$$

Other important objects are the step polynomial (or characteristic polynomial) $S(x_1, \ldots, x_n)$ defined by

$$S(x_1, \ldots, x_n) = \sum_{s \in \mathcal{S}} x_1^{s_1} \ldots x_n^{s_n} \tag{1.6}$$

and the starting polynomial

$$q(x_1, \ldots, x_n; t) = \sum_{w \in \mathcal{Q}} a(w) x_1^{m_1} \ldots x_n^{m_n} t^{|w|} \,. \tag{1.7}$$

Usually we see S a Laurent polynomial of degree (or valuation) 1 in each variable and we have $q = 1$. Note that in all of these quantities the variables a_m have been supressed from the notation. We can include those too whenever necessary especially if there are only finitely many of them. Furthermore it'll be useful to use the quantities $b = a - 1$ and $c = b/a = 1 - \overline{a}$.

Example 1. To illustrate the notation we'll investigate a random walk model on the plane. We'll look at random walks starting at the origin, restricted to the quarter plane, and which have only small diagonal steps. We'll count their interactions with the axes. In our terminology we have a random walk model $\mathcal{M}$ with $\mathcal{S}$ given by

$$\mathcal{S} = \{(-1, -1), (1, -1), (-1, 1), (1, 1)\} \,. \tag{1.8}$$



Figure 1.2: The model {NW, NE, SW, SE}

The region $\mathcal{D}$ consists of all points in $\mathbb{Z}^2$ with non-negative coordinates. Next $\mathcal{D}_0$ is composed of the two non-negative axes with overlap at the origin - we'll count visits to the origin as visits to each axis. Finally $\mathcal{Q}$ consists of the empty walk. In the language of generating functions we have $q = 1$ and

$$S = S(x_1, x_2) = x_1 + \overline{x}_1 + x_2 + \overline{x}_2 = (x_1 + \overline{x}_1)(x_2 + \overline{x}_2) \,. \tag{1.9}$$

We have a choice in naming the variables counting the interactions so we'll go with their defining quality (as this proves notationally simpler later on) - we mark the locations where one coordinate is zero. That is mark walks ending on $x_k = 0$ by incrementing the power of a_k in the generating function. In this model the only first step we can take is $(1, 1)$ which contributes a monomial $x_1 x_2 t$. From here on we can build on the single random walk of size one by taking a step in any of the four directions. This action lead to the following monomials. ZZPICTUREZZ

- $(1, 1)$: monomial $x_1^2 x_2^2 t^2$ since there are no interactions.
- $(1, \text{-}1)$: monomial $a_2 x_1^2 t^2$ since the walk lands on the x_1-axis with coordinate $x_2 = 0$.
- $(\text{-}1, 1)$: monomial $a_1 x_2^2 t^2$ since the walk lands on the x_2-axis with coordinate $x_1 = 0$.
- $(\text{-}1, \text{-}1)$: monomial $a_1 a_2 t^2$ since the walk lands on the origin which is on both axes.

Since we've seen all the random walks of size at most 2 we see that the generating function $Q = Q(x_1, x_2; t)$ starts as

$$\begin{aligned} Q &= 1 + x_1 x_2 t + (a_1 a_2 + a_1 x_2 + a_2 x_1 + x_1 x_2) t^2 + \cdots \\ &= 1 + x_1 x_2 t + (a_1 + x_1)(a_2 + x_2) t^2 + \cdots . \end{aligned} \tag{1.10}$$

The fact that the first few coefficients factor in this case may be unexpected but it is due to the factoring of $S(x_1, x_2)$ itself. We'll see a more general result later.

1.4.3 Thesis Notation

In the interest of generalizing the problem-solving strategies involved in random walk enumeration we will need powerful notation to handle all the intricacies of the problem. In fact it is the notation itself that paved the way towards generalization because it is suggestive and points towards the deeper connections between the generating functions and quantities involved. With this thesis we aim to make this kind of notation more common in higher-dimensional random walk analysis. Typically in multivariate setting we see multi-index notation where a bolded, vectorial or even supressed notation denotes the collection of variables involved. We would use this notation as well but it is insufficient when working with restricted geometries for $\mathcal{D}$ and $\mathcal{D}_0$.

Definition 2. *Let $\mathbb{O} := (0, \ldots, 0)$ and $\pm\mathbb{I} := (\pm 1, \ldots, \pm 1)$ where we have as many terms in these sequences as needed in the specific context and let $[n] = \{1, \ldots, n\}$*

Definition 3. *For sequences $I = (i_1, \ldots, i_m)$ and $J = (j_1, \ldots, j_m)$ and a symbol x we denote the monomial*

$$x_I^J = x_{i_1}^{j_1} \cdots x_{i_m}^{j_m}. \tag{1.11}$$

with the special cases

$$x_I^{\mathbb{I}} = x_I, \quad x_I^{\text{-}\mathbb{I}} = \frac{1}{x_I} = \overline{x}_I \,. \tag{1.12}$$

Definition 4. *For sequences I, J as before and indeterminate x we denote the coefficient extraction*

$$[x_I^J]F = [x_{i_1}^{j_1} \cdots x_{i_m}^{j_m}]F = F_I^J \tag{1.13}$$

with special cases:

- $F_I^J = F$ *if* I *is empty.*
- $F_I^J = F_J$ *if* I *is the full set of variables ordered unambiguously.*

We'll primarily be using this notation for extractions w.r.t. the x variables in the generating functions but sometimes we'll be using such a coefficient extraction w.r.t. to other variables, most commonly t. We'll never mix such extractions with this notation.

Example 5. Here's an illustrative example of the notation. If $Q(x_1, x_2; t)$ is given as in the previous example we have

$$Q_1^0 = [x_1^0]Q(x_1, x_2) = Q(0, x_2) = 1 + a_1(x_2 + a_2)t^2 + \cdots, \tag{1.14}$$

$$Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = Q_{0,0} = Q(0, 0) = 1 + a_1 a_2 t^2 + \cdots. \tag{1.15}$$

Furthermore we may write

$$S_1^{-1} = [\overline{x}_1](x_1 + \overline{x}_1)(x_2 + \overline{x}_2) = x_2 + \overline{x}_2 \tag{1.16}$$

and $S_{1,2}^{\pm 1, \pm 1} = 1$.

Chapter 2

One-dimensional random walks

2.1 Derivation of the functional equation

Before we tackle the higher dimensional random walk problems it will be instructive to visit the one-dimensional case first, which will help illustrate the methods and ideas that we will employ throughout this work. We'll focus on one-dimensional random walk models with smalls steps (the size is at most 1). Here the step set is $\mathcal{S} \subseteq \{\text{-}1, 0, 1\}$ and we encode this information via the step polynomial

$$S = S_{\text{-}1}\overline{x} + S_0 + S_1 x\,. \tag{2.1}$$

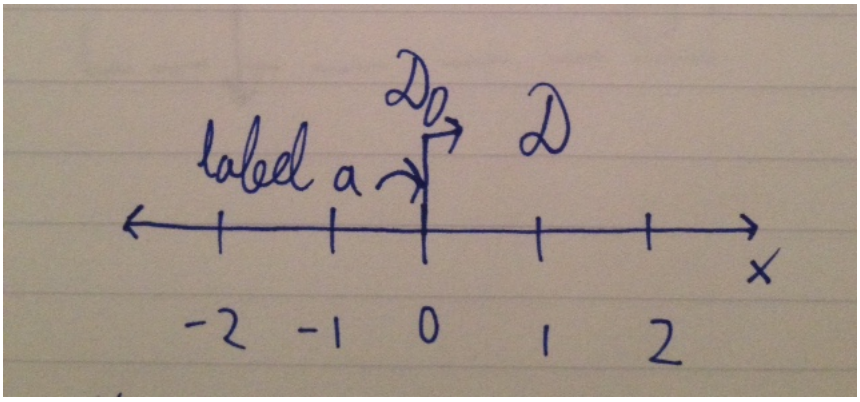


Figure 2.1: Regions on the line

Here $S_k = 1$ if $k \in S$ or 0 otherwise. Suppose that we have a walk ending on integer n. Then

we may step back, stay in one place or move forward. In the full generating function we keep track of the location of the walk with x^n. Then stepping back would be the same as multiplying the monomial x^n by $\overline{x}$. Adding of coordinates corresponds to multiplication of monomials. Since each possible step is either in $\mathcal{S}$ or not, the number of possible models with small steps on the axis is $2^3 = 8$. For random walks with interactions we'll also mark every visit to the origin. For example if we have a walk ending on x and take a step back we multiply by $\overline{x}$ and obtain x^0. To mark this visit we also multiply by a label a. Thus repeated visits will result in an increase of the power of a. To illustrate the use of different regions we could either have no restrictions or maybe we can restrict the walks to be on the non-negative axis.

One basic way we can obtain the generating function for a specific model is by a brute-force iteration. We start with the empty walk which will grow into all the other different walks. Its tracking monomial is just 1 since it has length 0 (so t^0), ends at the origin (so x^0) and has not stepped back at the origin yet a^0. Then we can obtain more walks by extending the walk we have with one of the possible steps. If we have all 3 possible steps we'll have three new monomials $xt\,, t$ and $\overline{x}t$, since each walks is now of length 1. However, if the region is restricted we'll have to remove some walks. Then we can repeat the procedure - extend all walks of length n by one step, remove those that venture outside of the domain of interest, and mark the ones that step onto the origin. This iteration will eventually produce as many terms of the generating function as we wish. The key idea here is to encapsulate this idea with an equation, and this has helped produce all the generating function analysis with regarding random walks. Suppose that the generating function of walks of length k is $Q_k t^k$. Then the full generating function is

$$Q = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} Q_k t^k \,. \tag{2.2}$$

Using the brute-force iteration we can write a functional equation relating Q_{k+1} and Q_k. We multiply the function $Q_k t^k$ by tS to extend all the walks of length k to ones with length $k+1$. Here is the key idea of this whole work - we use some sort of operator Γ that will remove all the unwanted terms and mark those at the origin, and we'll worry about its representation later. For now we have the iteration

$$Q_{k+1} t^{k+1} = \Gamma(tSQ_k t^k) = \Gamma(SQ_k) t^{k+1} \,. \tag{2.3}$$

In other words $Q_{k+1} = \Gamma(SQ_k)$ for all $k \geqslant 0$. We may sum both sides of the equation for $k \geqslant 0$ to

obtain

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} Q_{k+1} t^{k+1} &= \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \Gamma(SQ_k) t^k \\ Q - Q_0 &= t\Gamma S \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} Q_k t^k \\ Q &= 1 + t\Gamma(SQ) \end{aligned} \tag{2.4}$$

where we factor out the t since the operator only acts on monomials x^n and not on t. We've also assumed that we could factor out Γ from the infinite summation. We are working with formal series after all and we are looking for an easiest approach. In fact we'll use this to define how Γ acts as an operator - it acts term-wise on the series. We may re-write the functional equation as

$$\mathcal{L}Q = (1 - t\Gamma S)Q = 1 \tag{2.5}$$

which highlights the operator nature of the equation. We can invert this operator $\mathcal{L}$ formally as

$$Q = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (t\Gamma S)^k (1) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma S)^k (1)\,, \tag{2.6}$$

where the operator ΓS acts by multiplying by S first and then applying Γ on the result. The power here indicates iteration.

All we need to do is find a good representation of the operator Γ. Firstly, we need to remove all walks that end outside of the domain of interest. For illustrative purposes we'll use the domain of the non-negative integer coordinates. We must remove any walks that venture outside of this region. However, starting with a valid walk we cannot go too far - the furthest we may go with one step is the coordinate -1 where the walk will now have monomial $a^i \overline{x} t^j$ for some $i, j \geqslant 0$. So, at worst, when we multiply Q_k by S we may pick up some terms with monomials that contain $\overline{x}$. Since we don't want these it's enough to just remove terms with monomials $\overline{x}$. This can easily be represented as follows. Let

$$E = 1 - \overline{x}[\overline{x}]\,, \tag{2.7}$$

where 1 is the identity operator and $\overline{x}[\overline{x}]$ acts as to pick out the $\overline{x}$ term of whatever function E is applied to. For the marking we can do this by picking out walks that end at 0, which have monomials

with x^0 and multiplying them by a. This can be represented by the operator

$$L = 1 + (a-1)[x^0] = 1 + b[x^0] \tag{2.8}$$

where $b = a - 1$. What this operator does is take a function and add to it $(a-1)$ times the $[x^0]$ term. The final function has a $[x^0]$ term with coefficient $1 + (a-1) = a$. We may write $\Gamma = LE$ where we keep in mind that since Γ acts term-wise on power series in t, so do L and E. We may perform computations involving these operators. For example, we may expand the product LE as

$$\begin{aligned} \Gamma = LE &= (1 - \overline{x}[\overline{x}])(1 + b[x^0]) \\ &= 1 + b[x^0] - \overline{x}[\overline{x}] - \overline{x}[\overline{x}]b[x^0] \\ &= 1 + b[x^0] - \overline{x}[\overline{x}]\,. \end{aligned} \tag{2.9}$$

The last term vanished because once we've made the first extraction $[x^0]$ that term no longer contains a variable x, and the $[\overline{x}]$ extraction will pick out nothing. We would have obtained the same result if we computed EL instead, and so this shows that the operators commute.

Example 6. We'll now illustrate how the operators work. Suppose that $S = x + \overline{x}$. Then starting with $Q_0 = 1$,

$$Q_1 = LES(1) = (1 + b[x^0] - \overline{x}[\overline{x}])(x + \overline{x}) = x + \overline{x} - \overline{x} = x \tag{2.10}$$

$$Q_2 = LES(Q_1) = (1 + b[x^0] - \overline{x}[\overline{x}])(x^2 + 1) = x^2 + 1 + b = a + x^2 \tag{2.11}$$

$$Q_3 = LES(Q_2) = (1 + b[x^0] - \overline{x}[\overline{x}])(a\overline{x} + ax + x + x^3) \tag{2.12}$$

$$= a\overline{x} + ax + x + x^3 - a\overline{x} = (1+a)x + x^3\,. \tag{2.13}$$

Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} Q &= Q_0 + Q_1 t + Q_2 t^2 + Q_3 t^3 + \cdots \\ &= 1 + xt + (a + x^2)t^2 + ((1+a)x + x^3)t^3 + \cdots\,. \end{aligned} \tag{2.14}$$

Note that if we apply Γ to the resulting Q we obtain Q again with the first term $Q_0 = 1$ missing.

The theory so far is consistent with the present methods of obtaining functional equations for the generating functions for random walk models because in the end we obtain the same functional equations. To show this we'll expand the operator form and write down a functional equation that does not involve operators. For the rest of the chapter we'll use the notation $Q_k = [x^k]Q$ to reduce

clutter. To this end we first compute

$$\begin{aligned}[x^0]SQ &= [x^0]((S_{\text{-}1}\overline{x} + S_0 + S_1 x)Q) \\ &= (S_{\text{-}1}x[x] + S_0\overline{x}[\overline{x}] + S_1\overline{x}^2[\overline{x}^2])Q \\ &= S_{\text{-}1}Q_1 + S_0Q_0\end{aligned} \tag{2.15}$$

and the last line follows since $Q_{\text{-}1} = 0$ since that would include walks ending on $\overline{x}$. A similar computation shows that $\overline{x}[\overline{x}]SQ = S_{\text{-}1}Q_0$ and this brings us to the functional equation

$$\begin{aligned}1 = Q - tLE(SQ) &= Q - t(SQ + b[x^0]SQ - \overline{x}[\overline{x}]SQ \\ &= Q - t(SQ + b(S_{\text{-}1}Q_1 + S_0Q_0) - \overline{x}(S_{\text{-}1}Q_0))\,.\end{aligned} \tag{2.16}$$

We can rewrite this equation in the following form

$$(1 - tS)Q - t(bS_0 - \overline{x}S_{\text{-}1})Q_0 - btS_{\text{-}1}Q_1 = 1\,. \tag{2.17}$$

Here $Q_1^0 = Q(0)$ and $Q_1 = Q'(0)$ where $Q = Q(x)$. In the interest of simplifying the equation we can eliminate the Q_1^1 term by applying $[x^0]$ to both sides of the equation.

$$\begin{aligned}1 &= Q_1^0 - t(S_{\text{-}1}Q_1 + S_0Q_0) - tbS_0Q_0 - btS_{\text{-}1}Q_1 \\ &= (1 - atS_0)Q_0 - atS_{\text{-}1}Q_1\,.\end{aligned} \tag{2.18}$$

We can solve this equation for Q_1 as

$$tS_{\text{-}1}Q_1 = \overline{a}((1 - atS_0)Q_0 - 1) \tag{2.19}$$

and substitute the result into the first functional equation (for now we don't worry about the possibility of $S_{\text{-}1} = 0$ because it leads to the same thing anyway). Then

$$\begin{aligned}1 &= (1 - tS)Q - t(bS_0 - \overline{x}S_{\text{-}1})Q_0 - c((1 - atS_0)Q_0 - 1) \\ &= (1 - tS)Q - (c - t\overline{x}S_{\text{-}1})Q_0 + c\end{aligned} \tag{2.20}$$

and therefore we can rewrite the equation as

$$(1 - tS)Q - (c - t\overline{x}S_{\text{-}1})Q_0 = \overline{a} \tag{2.21}$$

since $1 - c = 1 - (1 - \overline{a}) = \overline{a}$. We'll call this the master functional equation.

Example 7. When $S = x + \overline{x}$ we have the functional equation

$$(1 - t(x + \overline{x}))Q - (c - t\overline{x})Q_0 = \overline{a}\,. \tag{2.22}$$

It turns out that the back substitution is unnecesary and this is a good thing because in higher dimensions we literally have to perform an exponential number of back substitutions to obtain such an equation. Previous approaches in [29] and [**?**] have had to put up with this and luckily only for two-dimensional problem with only a few back substitutions. The key here is to think about operators again. Marking a monomial is just done by a multiplication by the indeterminate a. This means that to undo the marking we just need to multiply by $1/a$. This tells us immediately that L has an inverse

$$L^{-1} = M = 1 + \left(\frac{1}{a} - 1\right)[x^0] = 1 - c[x^0]\,, \tag{2.23}$$

which we allowed to apply onto the operator functional equation. The RHS is simply $L^{-1}(1) = 1 - c = \overline{a}$ and the LHS is

$$\begin{aligned} L^{-1}(1 - tLES)Q &= L^{-1}Q - tESQ && (2.24)\\ &= (Q - cQ_0) - t(SQ - \overline{x}S_{-1}Q_0) && (2.25)\\ &= (1 - tS)Q - (c - t\overline{x}S_{-1})Q_0 && (2.26) \end{aligned}$$

and we've arrived at the master functional equation in a much faster way. That's neat!

Proposition 8. *The one-dimensional random walk model restricted to the non-negative axis, and with Laurent step polynomial $S = S_{-1}\overline{x} + S_0 + S_1 x$ has a generating function Q satisfying the functional equations*

$$\begin{aligned} (L^{-1} - tES)Q &= \overline{a}\,, && (2.27)\\ (1 - tS)Q - (c - t\overline{x}S_{-1})Q_0 &= \overline{a}\,. && (2.28) \end{aligned}$$

and we call them the operator and master functional equations.

The operator notation/perspective is powerful. It will allow us to derive functional equations for many random walk models in arbitrary dimensions with ease. Usually derivations have employed inclusion-exclusion and careful book-keeping [8], [15] to write master functional equations (or their precursors) in a direct manner. Unfortunately that approach is difficult to generalize to arbitrary dimensions and more dificult restrictions/marking.

We can also deal with coefficient extraction in a neater way. Instead of extracting $[x^k]$ from the master functional equation it is better to first go through the operator equation since $[x^k]$ interacts with L and E in a nice way. We have

$$[x^0]L^{-1} = [x^0] - [x^0]c[x^0] = [x^0] - c[x^0] = \overline{a}[x^0] \tag{2.29}$$

$$[x^0]E = [x^0] - [x^0]\overline{x}[\overline{x}] = [x^0]\,. \tag{2.30}$$

When we extract the x^0 from the functional equation we have

$$\begin{aligned} [x^0]\overline{a} = \overline{a} &= [x^0](L^{-1} - tES)Q \\ &= ([x^0]L^{-1} - t[x^0]ES)Q \\ &= (\overline{a}[x^0] - t[x^0]S)Q \\ &= [x^0](\overline{a} - tS)Q\,. \end{aligned} \tag{2.31}$$

Therefore we have a functional equation for the first coefficient

$$[x^0](1 - atS)Q = 1\,. \tag{2.32}$$

We can perform the extraction immediately and it simplifies to

$$(1 - atS_0)Q_0 - atS_{-1}Q_1 = 1\,. \tag{2.33}$$

Extracting higher coefficients is not difficult either. If $k \geqslant 1$ we have

$$[x^k]L^{-1} = [x^k] - [x^k]c[x^0] = [x^k]\,, \tag{2.34}$$

$$[x^k]E = [x^k] - [x^k]\overline{x}[\overline{x}] = [x^k]\,, \tag{2.35}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} [x^k]\overline{a} = 0 = [x^k](L^{-1} - tES)Q \\ = ([x^k] - t[x^k]S)Q \\ = [x^k](1 - tS)Q\,. \end{aligned} \tag{2.36}$$

This extraction translates to the equation

$$\begin{aligned} Q_k - t(S_{-1}Q_{k+1} + S_0Q_k + S_1Q_{k-1}) &= 0 \\ (1 - S_0t)Q_k - t(S_{-1}Q_{k+1} + S_1Q_{k-1}) &= 0\,. \end{aligned} \tag{2.37}$$

Proposition 9. *The one-dimensional model with $S = S_{-1}\overline{x} + S_0 + S_1x$ has generating functions $[x^k]Q = Q_k$ for the walks ending at coordinate k satisfying the following functional equations*

$$(1 - atS_0)Q_0 - atS_{-1}Q_1 = 1\,, \tag{2.38}$$

$$(1 - S_0t)Q_k - t(S_{-1}Q_{k+1} + S_1Q_{k-1}) = 0\,, \tag{2.39}$$

where $k \geqslant 1$ in the second equation.

2.2 Solving the functional equation for various S

The one-dimensional random walk models have nice algebraic generating functions while the higher-dimensional generalizations may not even have D-finite generating function (in the variable t). Nevertheless the one-dimensional models allow us to showcase some of the methods we'll use later on in the higher dimensional settings. The difficulties in the solutions tend to scale up with the higher number of steps with negative coordinates. Although it may be surprising this is a consequence of the form of the master functional equation - the coefficients become more complicated. We'll start with the easier case first.

2.2.1 The $S_{-1} = 0$ case.

This condition allows us to find Q_0 directly from the $[x^0]$ equation.

$$Q_0 = \frac{1}{1 - aS_0t}\,. \tag{2.40}$$

We can substitute this into the master functional equation.

Proposition 10. *The generating function Q for random walk models with small steps on the half-line with $S_{-1} = 0$ is given by*

$$Q(x, a; t) = \frac{\overline{a}}{1 - tS}\left(1 + \frac{b}{1 - atS_0}\right) = \frac{1 - tS_0}{(1 - tS)(1 - atS_0)}\,. \tag{2.41}$$

This takes care of half of all 8 models. It's interesting to note a relationship between $Q(x, a; t)$ and $Q(x, 1; t)$, where the latter function is the generating function for the unmarked problem. When

we set $a = 1$ in the above equation we find

$$[b^0]Q = \widehat{Q} = \frac{1 - S_0 t}{(1 - st)(1 - S_0 t)}\,. \tag{2.42}$$

By inspection we can see that

$$(1 - aS_0 t)Q - (1 - S_0 t)\widehat{Q} = 0 \tag{2.43}$$

which we may write as $B((1 - aS_0 t)Q) = 0$ using the operator $B = 1 - [b^0]$. We can also find such a relationship for Q_0. Extracting $[x^0]$ from the equation leads to

$$B((1 - aS_0 t)Q_0) = 0 \tag{2.44}$$

and so

$$Q_0 = \frac{1 - aS_0 t}{1 - S_0 t}\widehat{Q_0}\,. \tag{2.45}$$

Proposition 11. *Let $B = 1 - [b^0]$ and let Q be the generating function for a random walk model with small steps on the half-line with $S_{-1} = 0$. Then Q satisfies the functional equations*

$$B((1 - aS_0 t)Q) = 0\,, \quad B((1 - aS_0 t)Q_0) = 0\,. \tag{2.46}$$

In other words

$$Q = \frac{1 - aS_0 t}{1 - S_0 t}\widehat{Q}\,, \quad Q_0 = \frac{1 - aS_0 t}{1 - S_0 t}\widehat{Q_0}\,. \tag{2.47}$$

Even such small example already show connections between Q and $\widehat{Q}$. It will be interesting to find such relationship for higher-dimensional random walk models.

2.2.2 The $S_{-1} \neq 0$ case.

In this case we will apply the Obstinate Kernel as is done in the two dimensional cases in [29], page 11 of [**?**]. ZZCITEZZ It requires finding an x value that makes the kernel $K = 1 - tS$ equal to zero in the functional equation

$$(1 - tS)Q - (c - t\overline{x})Q_0 = \overline{a}\,. \tag{2.48}$$

Such a solution will exist since $S_{-1} = 1$ and therefore the equation $1 - tS = 0$ is nontrivial and of degree at least 1. Let one such solution be $x = \sigma$ and suppose that we can substitute it into the functional equation. ZZCITEZZ For now we have to assume that the whole term KQ vanishes and we obtain

$$-(c - t\overline{\sigma})Q_0 = \overline{a}\,. \tag{2.49}$$

Then

$$Q_0 = \frac{\overline{a}}{\overline{\sigma}t - c} \tag{2.50}$$

and we can now solve for Q explicitly

$$Q = \frac{\overline{a}}{1 - tS}\left(1 - \frac{t\overline{x} - c}{t\overline{\sigma} - c}\right) = \frac{t}{1 - tS}\left(\frac{\overline{x} - \overline{\sigma}}{b - a\overline{\sigma}t}\right) = \frac{t(\sigma - x)}{x(1 - tS)(b\sigma - at)}\,. \tag{2.51}$$

Proposition 12. *For a random walk model with small steps on the half-line with $S_{-1} = 1$ let σ be a root of K that makes KQ vanish. Then generating function Q is given by*

$$Q = \frac{t}{1 - tS}\left(\frac{\overline{x} - \overline{\sigma}}{b - a\overline{\sigma}t}\right) \tag{2.52}$$

and it has a first term

$$Q_0 = \frac{\overline{a}}{\overline{\sigma}t - c}\,. \tag{2.53}$$

Here σ depends on the rest of the step set $\mathcal{S}$.

As before we can find a linear relationship between $Q(x, a; t)$ and $Q(x, 1; t)$.

Proposition 13. *Let $B = 1 - [b^0]$ and let Q be the generating function for a random walk model with small steps on the half-line with $S_{-1} = 1$. Then Q satisfies the functional equations*

$$B((a\overline{\sigma}t - b)Q) = 0\,, \quad B((a\overline{\sigma}t - b)Q_0) = 0\,. \tag{2.54}$$

In other words

$$Q = \frac{t}{at - b\sigma}\widehat{Q}\,, \quad Q_0 = \frac{t}{at - b\sigma}\widehat{Q_0}\,. \tag{2.55}$$

The final task for this section will be to find what σ will be for various cases. We already know

$S_{\text{-}1} \neq 0$ so the result depend on S_0 and S_1. In general the kernel is zero when

$$\begin{aligned} tS &= 1 \\ t(S_{\text{-}1} + S_0 x + S_1 x^2) &= x \\ tS_1 x^2 - (1 - S_0 t)x + tS_{\text{-}1} &= 0\,. \end{aligned} \tag{2.56}$$

When $S_1 = 0$ we have the equation $(1 - S_0 t)x = t$ so the single root is

$$\sigma = \frac{t}{1 - S_0 t}\,. \tag{2.57}$$

When $S_1 = 1$ the equation $tx^2 - (1 - S_0 t)x + t = 0$ is quadratic with two roots that are functions of t. We have to pick the one which has no singularity at $t = 0$. The roots are

$$\sigma = \frac{1 - S_0 t - \sqrt{(1 - S_0 t)^2 - 4t^2}}{2t}, \quad \sigma^* = \frac{1 - S_0 t + \sqrt{(1 - S_0 t)^2 - 4t^2}}{2t}\,, \tag{2.58}$$

and they multiply to 1 so $\overline{\sigma} = \sigma^*$. Note that in the relationship between the marked and unmarked Q_0 we have

$$Q_0 = \frac{t}{at - b\sigma}\widehat{Q_0} \tag{2.59}$$

where σ is a function containing a square root, i.e. not a polynomial. However we can go at the problem from a different angle - that of the Algebraic Kernel method used extensively in the quarter-plane model classification ZZCITEZZ. We obtain a polynomial $f(a, t)$ for which $B(fQ_0) = c$ which is not quite zero but it's a simpler relationship. This will also illustrate the group approach together with the kernel method. The two cases that we need to work on both have $S_{\text{-}1} = S_1 = 1$ with S_0 being 0 or 1. This means that S is left invariant under sending $* : x \mapsto \overline{x}$. We can apply this on the functional equation and now have a system of two functional equations

$$(1 - tS)Q - (c - t\overline{x})Q_0 - \overline{a} = 0\,, \tag{2.60}$$

$$(1 - tS)Q^* - (c - tx)Q_0 - \overline{a} = 0\,. \tag{2.61}$$

We can multiply the first by $c - tx$, the second by $c - t\overline{x}$ and subtract the equations to eliminate the Q_0 term. We can divide everything out by $1 - tS$ and finally obtain

$$(c - tx)Q(x) - (c - t\overline{x})Q(\overline{x}) - \overline{a}\delta = 0\,. \tag{2.62}$$

where

$$\delta = \frac{t(\overline{x} - x)}{1 - tS} \tag{2.63}$$

and crucially δ doesn't depent on a. We extract the x^1 coefficient from the equation to obtain an equation relating Q_1 and Q_0

$$cQ_1 - tQ_0 - \overline{a}\delta_1 = 0\,. \tag{2.64}$$

We can set $a = 1$ here to find

$$-\delta_1 = t\widehat{Q_0} \tag{2.65}$$

and we can substitute this back into the original equation to obtain

$$\begin{aligned} cQ_1 &= tQ_0 - \overline{a}t\widehat{Q_0} \\ bQ_1 &= t(aQ_0 - \widehat{Q_0})\,. \end{aligned} \tag{2.66}$$

Earlier we had the equation

$$(1 - aS_0t)Q_0 = 1 + aS_{\text{-}1}tQ_1 = 1 + atQ_1 \tag{2.67}$$

which we can solve for Q_1 this time and insert the solution into the above equation

$$b((1 - aS_0t)Q_0 - 1) = t^2a(aQ_0 - \widehat{Q_0})\,. \tag{2.68}$$

Collecting coefficients and simplifying leads us to the equations

$$\begin{aligned} (b(1 - aS_0t) - a^2t^2)Q_0 - (-at^2)\widehat{Q_0} &= b\,, \\ (c(1 - aS_0t) - at^2)Q_0 - (-t^2)\widehat{Q_0} &= c\,. \end{aligned} \tag{2.69}$$

This gives $f(a,t) = c(1 - aS_0t) - at^2$ so that

Proposition 14. *When $S_{\text{-}1} = S_1 = 1$ we have*

$$B((c(1 - aS_0t) - at^2)Q_0) = c. \tag{2.70}$$

With two different approaches we obtained slightly different relationships upon applying the operator B.

2.2.3 Conclusion

In this section we were able to find explicit solutions for Q_0, Q and also B-operator relationships for Q and $\widehat{Q}$. In higher dimensions this may not be quite possible but we should still be able to find B-operator relationships for the equivalent of Q_0 and $\widehat{Q_0}$. Here is a table showing the resuls for the one-dimensional random walk models with small steps and an interaction with the origin. Here σ depends on S_1 and S_0.

Case	S	Q_0	Q	$f(a,t)$
$S_{\text{-}1} = 0$	$S_0 + S_1 x$	$\dfrac{1}{1 - aS_0 t}$	$\dfrac{1 - S_0 t}{(1 - tS)(1 - atS_0)}$	$1 - atS_0$
$S_{\text{-}1} = 1$	$1 + S_0 + S_1 x$	$\dfrac{\sigma}{at - b\sigma}$	$\dfrac{t(x - \sigma)}{x(1 - tS)(at - b\sigma)}$	$a\overline{\sigma}t - b$
Add the two subcases				

Table 2.1: Generating functions for walks with small steps on the non-negative half-life.

Chapter 3

Higher Dimensional Random Walk Models

We can easily generalize the one-dimensional results to two or more dimensions. The following diagram illustrates the two-dimensional case.

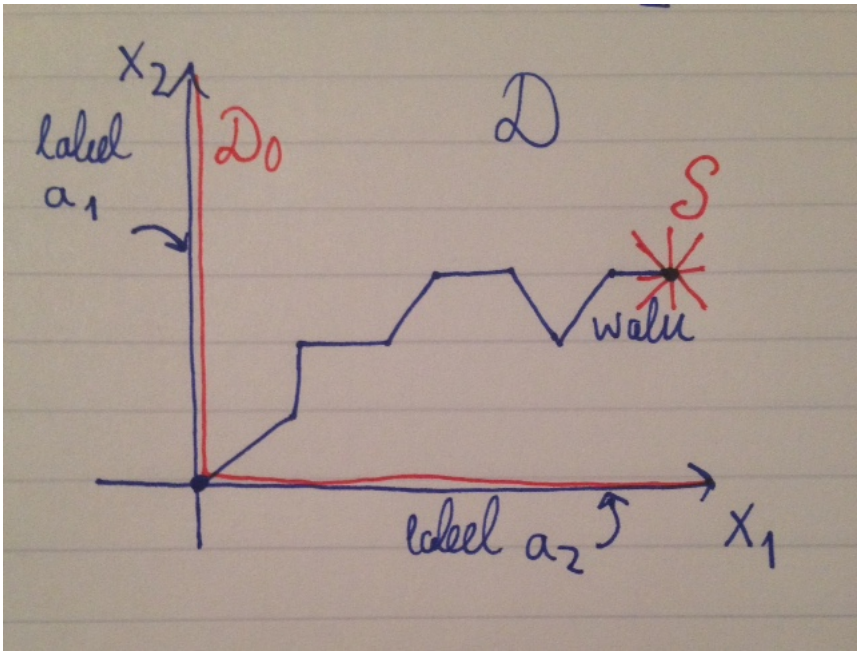


Figure 3.1: 2D random walk model constraints

In the past we've performed inclusion-exclusion to arrive at functional equations for the two-

dimensional problems but when it comes to generalizing to higher dimensions, the process is difficult and prone to error. For a view of difficulties involved in not using the operator notation see [29] where the authors have to wrestle with case-by-case analysis. Instead, we use operators to derive the functional equations cleanly and without pain. First, we'll illustrate the inclusion-exclusion with the noninteracting two-dimensional problem. This is the usual procedure carried out in problems so far [8]. As in the one-dimensional problem we may start with the generating function Q for the random walks on the quarter-plane. Then we extend the walks by one step via a multiplication by tS and remove those that step outside of the quarter plane. To do this we can subtract the walks that end on coordinates $(\text{-}1, k)$ or $(k, \text{-}1)$. But then we've removed too many walks. We need to add back in those walks that end on $(\text{-}1, \text{-}1)$.

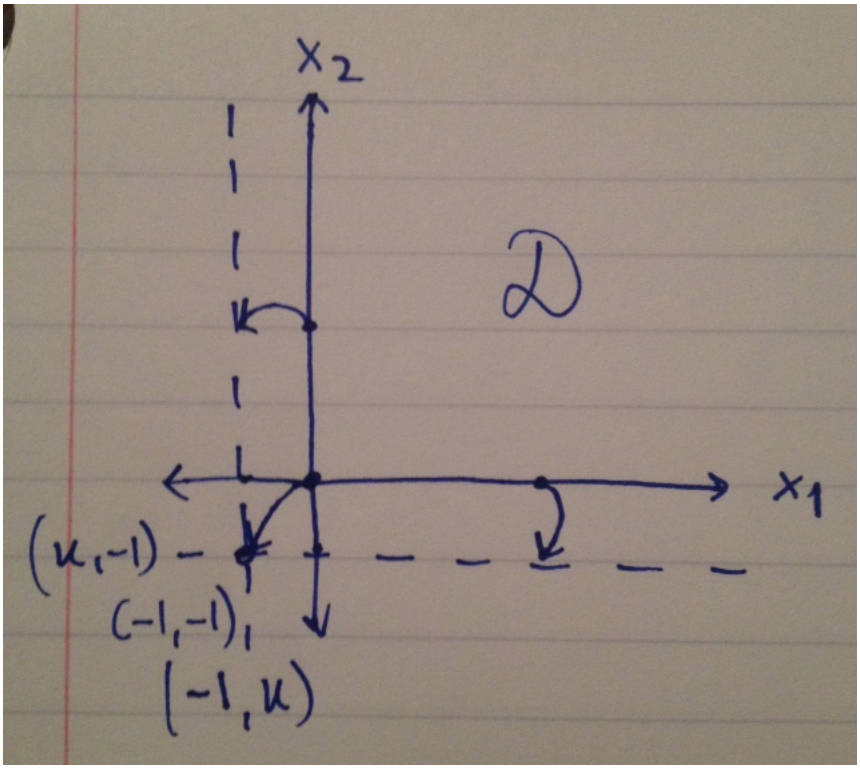


Figure 3.2: Inclusion-exclusion of regions

The walks that step on $(\text{-}1, k)$ are those coming from the boundary and stepping with steps in the negative x_1 direction. To compute the generating function term we start with Q_1^0 and multiply by $t\overline{x}_1 S_1^{-1}$. The situation is similar for the $(k, \text{-}1)$ coordinates. Finally we add back in those walks that step on $(\text{-}1, \text{-}1)$. Those are walks coming from the origin in a diagonal step so we multiply $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$ by $t\overline{x}_1\overline{x}_2 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}$. What we've obtained is Q again but with the t^0 term missing.

This leads to the functional equation for Q

$$Q = 1 + tSQ - t\overline{x}_1 S_1^{-1} Q_1^0 - t\overline{x}_2 S_2^{-2} Q_2^0 + t\overline{x}_1\overline{x}_2 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1} Q_{1,2}^{0,0} \tag{3.1}$$

which is rather large even for two dimensions. Contrast this notation to the one in [8] (page 10). The problem quickly runs into notational difficulties for d-dimensional problems but that can be dealt with by writing the equation as a sum over subsets of $[d]$ as is done for the noninteracting case in [15]. This method really runs into trouble when we start considering interactions. We take the functional equation for the noninteracting case and modify it to add interactions. This has been done before in ZZCITEZZ by adding in terms like $(a_1 - 1)T$ where T is some expression involving extractions of Q and S but we won't go into the messy details. Instead we'll use the operator notation to handle the problem in a slicker manner.

3.1 Using Operators to Derive the Functional Equation

If we use operators we can obtain the generalizations to higher-dimensions in a straight-forward manner. As before we start with Q and extend the random walks by multiplying by tS. Then we apply some abstract operator E to remove all the walks that venture outside of the positive orthant (nonzero coordinates x_k). Finally we apply a marking operator to this term that marks the walks on the boundary hyperplanes $x_k = 0$. Since we've extended all walks by one step we no longer have walks of size 0. Adding that term to the expression leads us back to Q itself. That is,

$$Q = 1 + LE(tSQ) \tag{3.2}$$

and the only remaining task is to find L and E. Like in the one-dimensional problem we start removing monomials with coordinates outside of the positive orthant. The important idea here is that if we have an operator that just removes monomials, then it doesn't matter in which order we end up removing them. Let $E_k = 1 - \overline{x}_k[\overline{x}_k]$ be the operator removing monomials with x_k coordinate equal to -1. Then we may write $E = E_1 \cdots E_d$. For example

$$E_1 E_2 = (1 - \overline{x}_1[\overline{x}_1])(1 - \overline{x}_2[\overline{x}_2]) = 1 - \overline{x}_1[\overline{x}_1] - \overline{x}_2[\overline{x}_2] + \overline{x}_1\overline{x}_2[\overline{x}_1\overline{x}_2] \tag{3.3}$$

and this shows that the inclusion-exclusion is a natural consequence of how the operator is set up. Similarly if we let $L_k = 1 + (a_k - 1)[x_k^0]$ then we may write $L = L_1 \cdots L_d$. Here order does not matter since we are marking monomials with variables a_k. It doesn't matter if we first multiply by a_1 and then by a_2 or vice-versa. As in the one-dimensional case the operators L_k are invertible with inverses $L_k^{-1} = 1 - c_k[x_k^0]$ and thus L is also invertible. We can apply the operator L^{-1} to the

functional equation

$$L^{-1}(1-tLES)Q = (L^{-1}-tES)Q = L^{-1}(1) = \sum_{I\subseteq[d]} c_I = \overline{a}_{[d]} \tag{3.4}$$

which allows us to write down the following result.

Proposition 15. *The $d-$dimensional random walk model with small steps in the positive orthant and marking of hyperplane $x_k = 0$ interactions has a generating function Q satisfying the functional equations*

$$(1-tLES)Q = 1\,, \tag{3.5}$$

$$(L^{-1}-tES)Q = \overline{a}_{[d]} \tag{3.6}$$

where L, E, L^{-1} are of the form $\Gamma = \Gamma_1 \cdots \Gamma_d$.

Previously we've had to deal with coefficient extractions and back-substitution to find the expanded form of the second functional equation (page 9 of [29] and page 12 of [**?**]). Using the operator notation allows us to skip this process. In general the second functional equation has many less terms.To see this we take a look at the L_kE_k operator

$$L_kE_k = 1 + b_k[x_k^0] - \overline{x}_k[\overline{x}_k] \tag{3.7}$$

which increases the number of terms in the equation by a factor of 3. We have 3^d terms relating to SQ by the end of applying LE. On the other hand once we apply the operator L^{-1} we introduce 2^d terms relating to Q but then since we only have E applied on SQ we'd only have at most 2^d terms from this. For the case of walks of step size at most 1 and labelling the hyperplane interactions we have exactly 2^d terms $Q_I^{\mathbb{O}}$, one for each subset $I \subseteq [d]$. In this case we can write out the functional equation explicitly. Firstly,

$$\begin{aligned} L^{-1}Q &= (1-c_1[x_1^0])\ldots(1-c_d[x_d^0])Q \\ &= \sum_{I\subseteq[d]} (-1)^{|I|} c_I Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} \end{aligned} \tag{3.8}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} ESQ &= (1-\overline{x}_1[\overline{x}_1])\dots(1-\overline{x}_d[\overline{x}_d])(SQ) \\ &= \sum_{I\subseteq[d]} (-1)^{|I|}\overline{x}_I[x_I^{-\mathbb{I}}](SQ) \\ &= \sum_{I\subseteq[d]} (-1)^{|I|}\overline{x}_I S_I^{-\mathbb{I}} Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} \end{aligned} \tag{3.9}$$

where the last line follows from the fact that there are no negative powers of x_k in Q for any k. Therefore the functional equation is

$$\sum_{I\subseteq[d]} (-1)^{|I|}(c_I - t\overline{x}_I S_I^{-\mathbb{I}})Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} = \overline{a}_{[d]}\,. \tag{3.10}$$

As in the two-dimensional case we let $K_I = c_I - t\overline{x}_I S_I^{-\mathbb{I}}$ where if $I = \varnothing$ we have the empty products and empty extractions leaving us with $K_\varnothing = K$. Finally we can write the master equation in d-dimensions.

Theorem 16. *The full generating function Q for random walks with interactions satisfies the functional equation*

$$\sum_{I\subseteq[d]} (-1)^{|I|} K_I Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} = \overline{a}_{[d]} \tag{3.11}$$

where $K_I = (c_I - t\overline{x_I} S_I^{-\mathbb{I}})$.

This is the interacting version of the functional eqaution obtained in [15] which written our notation is

$$KQ - \sum_{\substack{I\subseteq[d]\\ I\neq\varnothing}} (-1)^{|I|}\overline{x}_I S_I^{-\mathbb{I}} Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} = 1\,. \tag{3.12}$$

3.2 Coefficient extractions

3.2.1 Using operator notation for fast coefficient extraction

As in the two-dimensional case we can now perform coefficient extractions with $[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}]$ to obtain further functional equations relating $Q_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ to other Q terms of the same variables or fewer variables.

The operator $[x_i^k]$ commutes with all M_j, E_j with $j \neq i$ so we only need to consider the action on the operators $M_i = L_i^{-1}$ and E_i. We've already done so in the one-dimensional case. The zeroth power extraction yields

$$[x_i^0]M_i = [x_i^0] - [x_i^0]c_i[x_i^0] = [x_i^0] - c_i[x_i^0] = \overline{a_i}[x_i^0]\,, \tag{3.13}$$

$$[x_i^0]E_i = [x_i^0] - [x_i^0]\overline{x}_i[\overline{x}_i] = [x_i^0] \tag{3.14}$$

and the k-th power extraction for $k \geqslant 1$ yields

$$[x_i^k]M_i = [x_i^k] - [x_i^k]c_i[x_i^0] = [x_i^k]\,, \tag{3.15}$$

$$[x_i^k]E_i = [x_i^k] - [x_i^k]\overline{x}_i[\overline{x}_i] = [x_i^k]\,. \tag{3.16}$$

So, for $k \geqslant 0$ the operator $[x_i^k]$ eliminates both M_i and E_i from the picture while for $k = 0$ it removes E_i but leaves a residual $\overline{a_i}$ behind for M_i. Therefore if we extract $[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}]$ from the functional equation we have

$$\begin{aligned}[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}]a_{[d]} = \overline{a}_{[d]} &= [x_I^{\mathbb{O}}](M_{[d]} - tE_{[d]}S)Q \\ &= \left(\overline{a}_I M_{[d]\setminus I}[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}] - tE_{[d]\setminus I}[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}]S\right)Q \\ &= [x_I^{\mathbb{O}}](\overline{a}_I M_{[d]\setminus I} - tE_{[d]\setminus I}S)Q\end{aligned} \tag{3.17}$$

so that

$$\overline{a}_{[d]\setminus I} = [x_I^{\mathbb{O}}](M_{[d]\setminus I} - a_I tE_{[d]\setminus I}S)Q\,. \tag{3.18}$$

Written in another way this becomes

$$\overline{a}_I = [x_{[d]\setminus I}^{\mathbb{O}}](M_I - a_{[d]\setminus I}tE_I S)Q \tag{3.19}$$

and we can use whichever notation is more useful at the time. The latter notation underscores the idea that when we extract coefficients for walks that end at some hyperplane intersection we are having a reduced version of the functional equation at the cost of an added a term. When we extract a general term we can use the operator $[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}x_J^P]$ where P is a set of powers greater than 0 and $I \cap J = \varnothing$, $|P| \geqslant 1$ and $I \cup J = K$. We find

$$\begin{aligned}[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}x_J^P]a_{[d]} = 0 = [x_I^{\mathbb{O}}x_J^P](M_{[d]} - tE_{[d]}S)Q \\ = [x_I^{\mathbb{O}}x_J^P](\overline{a}_I M_{[d]\setminus K} - tE_{[d]\setminus K}S)Q\end{aligned} \tag{3.20}$$

which we can write as

$$[x_I^{\mathbb{O}} x_J^P](M_{[d]\setminus K} - a_I t E_{[d]\setminus K} S)Q = 0\,. \tag{3.21}$$

If I is empty then

$$[x_J^P](M_{[d]\setminus J} - t E_{[d]\setminus J} S)Q = 0\,. \tag{3.22}$$

The main role of these calculations is to provide a shortcut for manual calculations.

3.2.2 Further functional equations

We need to go further in order to obtain equations similar to the master functional equation. We know that

$$[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}]SQ = S_I^{\mathbb{O}} Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} + R_I \tag{3.23}$$

where R_I is a collection of $S_I^{-P} Q_I^P$ terms that involves sets P whose terms are not all zero. We can use this inside the functional equation

$$\begin{aligned} \overline{a}_{[d]\setminus I} &= M_{[d]\setminus I}[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}]Q - a_I t E_{[d]\setminus I}[x_I^{\mathbb{O}}](SQ) \\ &= M_{[d]\setminus I} Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} - a_I t E_{[d]\setminus I}(S_I^{\mathbb{O}} Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} + R_I) \\ &= (M_{[d]\setminus I} - a_I t E_{[d]\setminus I} S_I^{\mathbb{O}}) Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} - a_I t E_{[d]\setminus I} R_I \end{aligned} \tag{3.24}$$

so we can re-write the functional equation as

$$(M_{[d]\setminus I} - a_I t E_{[d]\setminus I} S_I^{\mathbb{O}}) Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} = a_I(\overline{a}_{[d]} + t R'_I) \tag{3.25}$$

where $R'_I = E_{[d]\setminus I} R_I$. We compute the following terms

$$M_{[d]\setminus I} Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} = \sum_{J \subseteq [d]\setminus I} (-1)^{|J|} c_J Q_{I,J}^{\mathbb{O},\mathbb{O}}\,, \tag{3.26}$$

$$a_I t E_{[d]\setminus I} S_I^{\mathbb{O}} Q_I^{\mathbb{O}} = \sum_{J \subseteq [d]\setminus I} (-1)^{|J|} a_I t \overline{x}_J S_{I,J}^{\mathbb{O},\text{-}\mathbb{I}} Q_{I,J}^{\mathbb{O},\mathbb{O}}\,, \tag{3.27}$$

and the functional equation can be written as

$$\sum_{J\subseteq[d]\setminus I}(-1)^{|J|}(c_J - a_I t\overline{x}_J S_{I,J}^{\mathbb{O},\text{-}\mathbb{I}})Q_{I,J}^{\mathbb{O},\mathbb{O}} = a_I(\overline{a}_{[d]} + tR'_I)\,. \tag{3.28}$$

This suggests the notation

Definition 17. *For sets I and J we write*

$$K_J(I) = c_J - a_I t\overline{x}_J S_{I,J}^{\mathbb{O},\text{-}\mathbb{I}} \tag{3.29}$$

where when $I = \varnothing$, $K_J(I) = K_J$.

This notation allows us to write the 2^d functional equations in a simplified form.

Corollary 18. *For $I \subseteq [d]$ the function Q satisfies the functional equation*

$$\sum_{J\subseteq[d]\setminus I}(-1)^{|J|}K_J(I)Q_{I,J}^{\mathbb{O},\mathbb{O}} = \overline{a}_{[d]\setminus I} + a_I t R'_I \tag{3.30}$$

where the R'_I term involves only higher order coefficient extractions from Q, that is not all the powers are zero.

To compute the R'_I terms we first determine what R_I is. It is a sum of terms $S_I^{\text{-}P}Q_I^P$ for various nonnegative P with size $|I|$ whose elements are not all 0. To calculate R'_I we apply the operator $E_{[d]\setminus I}$ on R_I. We can try calculating some of these quantities. A key observation is that the terms Q_I^P are power series in the remaining variables so they don't have non-negative coefficients. Let $sq = S_I^{\text{-}P}Q_I^P$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} E_j sq &= sq - \overline{x}_j(sq)_j^{\text{-}1} \\ &= sq - \overline{x}_j(s_j^{\text{-}1}q_j^0 + s_j^0 q_j^{\text{-}1} + s_j^1 q_j^{\text{-}2}) \\ &= sq - \overline{x}_j s_j^{\text{-}1} q_j^0\,. \end{aligned} \tag{3.31}$$

Hence

$$E_K sq = \sum_{J\subseteq K}(-1)^{|J|}\overline{x}_J s_J^{\text{-}\mathbb{I}} q_J^{\mathbb{O}}\,. \tag{3.32}$$

Finally we can write

$$\begin{aligned} R'_I &= E_{[d]\setminus I} R_I \\ &= \sum_{P>\mathbb{0}} E_{[d]\setminus I} S_I^{-P} Q_I^P \\ &= \sum_{P>\mathbb{0}} \sum_{J\subseteq[d]\setminus I} (-1)^{|J|} S_{I,J}^{-P,-\mathbb{I}} Q_{I,J}^{P,\mathbb{0}} \\ &= \sum_{J\subseteq[d]\setminus I} (-1)^{|J|} \sum_{P>\mathbb{0}} S_{I,J}^{-P,-\mathbb{I}} Q_{I,J}^{P,\mathbb{0}} \,. \end{aligned} \tag{3.33}$$

Proposition 19. *The functions R'_I are given by*

$$R'_I = \sum_{J\subseteq[d]\setminus I} (-1)^{|J|} \sum_{P>\mathbb{0}} S_{I,J}^{-P,-\mathbb{I}} Q_{I,J}^{P,\mathbb{0}} \,. \tag{3.34}$$

This formula is mostly of theoretical value although it can be used to speed up manual calculations.

3.3 Simple Solutions

3.3.1 Formal Neumann series solution

So far we've obtained the equation

$$(1 - tLES)Q = 1 \,. \tag{3.35}$$

Let $\Gamma = LE$. Then we can think of the formal inverse of this operator given as Neumann series as

$$(1 - t\Gamma S)^{-1} = \frac{1}{1 - t\Gamma S} = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma S)^k \,. \tag{3.36}$$

We can write the series solution

$$Q = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma S)^k (1) \tag{3.37}$$

where $(\Gamma S)^k(1) = \Gamma S(\ldots(\Gamma S(1))\ldots)$. This allows us to compute the series expansion for Q directly using an iteration. The next coefficient is the previous one with ΓS applied to it. It can be easily implemented in symbolic calculation software like Maple or Mathematica. The iteration is a

formalized way of finding the first few terms of the series in the naive way - by taking a set of walks of length n, extending them by 1 step, removing the ones that end outside of the quarter-plane and finally mark the ones that interact with the hyperplanes $x_i = 0$ at their endpoint. We haven't been able to find closed forms for the repeated operator applications in general. Here's an example that illustrates the use of the operators.

Example 20. Let $S = x_1 + \overline{x}_1 + x_2 + \overline{x}_2 = S_1(x_1) + S_2(x_2)$. We start with $\Gamma S^0(1) = 1$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\Gamma S^1(1) &= LE(S_1 + S_2) = L(x_1 + x_2) = a_2 x_1 + a_1 x_2\,, \\
\Gamma S^2(1) &= LE(S_1 + S_2)(a_2 x_1 + a_1 x_2) \\
&= LE(a_2 S_1 x_1 + a_1 x_2 S_2 + a_2 x_1 S_2 + a_1 x_2 S_1) \\
&= L(a_2 S_1 x_1 + a_1 x_2 S_2 + (a_1 + a_2) x_1 x_2) \\
&= a_1 a_2^2 + a_2^2 x_1^2 + a_1 a_2^2 + a_1^2 x_2^2 + (a_1 + a_2) x_1 x_2
\end{aligned}$$

which allows us to write

$$Q = 1 + (a_2 x_1 + a_1 x_2)t + \left(a_1 a_2 (a_1 + a_2) + (a_2^2 x_1^2 + a_1^2 x_2^2) + (a_1 + a_2) x_1 x_2\right) t^2 + \cdots\,. \tag{3.38}$$

3.3.2 Hadamard product solutions

We take a moment to mention a result that falls out of the operator notation and which was covered in more generality in [18] where the authors consider a generalization of the situation $S(x_1, x_2) = S_0(x_1) + S_1(x_1)S_2(x_2)$. We'll consider the simpler case $S = S_1(x_1)S_2(x_2)$ and its generalizations to many dimensions.

Example 21. When $d = 2$ we have the special case $S = S_1(x_1)S_2(x_2)$. The operator ΓS factors as

$$\Gamma S = \Gamma_1 \Gamma_2 S_1 S_2 = (\Gamma_1 S_1)(\Gamma_2 S_2) \tag{3.39}$$

because Γ_2 doesn't interact with S_1 and the operators commute. Then

$$(\Gamma S)^k = (\Gamma_1 \Gamma_2 S_1 S_2)^k = (\Gamma_1 S_1)^k (\Gamma_2 S_2)^k \tag{3.40}$$

and we use the Neumann series to find

$$Q = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma S)^k = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma_1 S_1)^k (\Gamma_2 S_2)^k = \left(\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma_1 S_1)^k \right) \odot_t \left(\sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma_2 S_2)^k \right) \quad (3.41)$$

where $\odot_t$ denotes the Hadamard product of two power series with respect to variable t. From now on we'll drop the subscript t unless it is needed. Here we may write

$$Q_i(a_i, x_i; t) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma_i S_i)^k \quad (3.42)$$

and by reversing the iteration we obtain the functional equations

$$(1 - t\Gamma_i S_i) Q_i = 1 \quad (3.43)$$

for each i. The functions Q_i are solutions to one-dimensional problems with step sets S_i and Q is expressed as

$$Q(a_1, a_2, x_1, x_2; t) = Q_1(a_1, x_1; t) \odot_t Q_2(a_2, x_2; t) \quad (3.44)$$

Example 22. Once we know the form of the solution we can prove that it works by a method that doesn't use the series solution. Suppose that Q_i is a solution to the functional equation

$$(L_i^{-1} - tE_i S_i) Q_i = \overline{a}_i \quad (3.45)$$

for $i = 1$ and $i = 2$. Then we claim that $Q = Q_1 \odot Q_2$ is a solution to the functional equation

$$(L^{-1} - tES) Q = \overline{a}_1 \overline{a}_2 \,. \quad (3.46)$$

To this end we compute

$$\begin{aligned} (L^{-1} - tES) Q &= L^{-1}(Q_1 \odot Q_2) - tES(Q_1 \odot Q_2) \\ &= (L_1^{-1} Q_1 \odot L_2^{-1} Q_2) - t((E_1 S_1 Q_1) \odot (E_2 S_2 Q_2)) \,. \end{aligned} \quad (3.47)$$

Then we substitute $L_i^{-1}Q_i = \overline{a}_i + tE_iS_iQ_i$ into the first term and expand it to find

$$\begin{aligned}(L_1^{-1}Q_1 \odot L_2^{-1}Q_2) &= (\overline{a}_1 + tE_1S_1Q_1) \odot (\overline{a}_2 + tE_2S_2Q_2) \\ &= \overline{a}_1 \odot \overline{a}_2 + \overline{a}_1 \odot (tE_2S_2Q_2) + \overline{a}_2 \odot (tE_1S_1Q_1) \\ &\quad + (tE_1S_1Q_1) \odot (tE_2S_2Q_2)) \,.\end{aligned} \tag{3.48}$$

Since we are working with power series

$$\overline{a}_i \odot (tE_jS_jQ_j) = \overline{a}_i[t^0]tE_jS_jQ_j = 0 \tag{3.49}$$

and thus

$$(L_1^{-1}Q_1 \odot L_2^{-1}Q_2) = \overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2 + t((E_1S_1Q_1) \odot (E_2S_2Q_2)) \,. \tag{3.50}$$

and this establishes that Q is indeed a solution to the equation.

Lemma 23. *Let Q be the generating function for a two-dimensional random walk model with small steps and interactions on the quarter plane with $S = S_1(x_1)S_2(x_2)$. Let Q_i be the generating function for a one-dimensional random walk model with small steps and interaction with the origin and step polynomial S_i. Then*

$$Q(x_1, x_2, a_1, a_2; t) = Q_1(x_1, a_1; t) \odot Q_2(x_2, a_2; t) \,. \tag{3.51}$$

This allows us to prove the following result via induction.

Theorem 24. *Consider a d-dimensional random walk model with small steps restricted to the region with $x_k \geqslant 0$ and having interactions with the $x_k = 0$ hyperplanes. Suppose that $S(x_1, \ldots, x_d) = S_1 \ldots S_r$ where S_i and S_j don't share variables when $i \neq j$. Then the generating function Q is given by*

$$Q = Q_1 \odot \cdots \odot Q_r \tag{3.52}$$

where Q_k is the sub d-dimensional problem with smalls steps restricted to the region with $x_i \geqslant 0$ and having interactions with the $x_i = 0$ hyperplane where x_i is a varible present in S_k.

Example 25. Consider the two-dimensional model with $S = (x_1 + \overline{x}_1)(x_2 + \overline{x}_2)$. The one dimen-

sional problems are the same and have solutions

$$\widetilde{Q}_0 = \frac{\sigma}{at - b\sigma}, \quad \widetilde{Q} = \frac{t(x-\sigma)}{x(1-t(x+\overline{x})(at-b\sigma)} \tag{3.53}$$

where

$$\sigma = \frac{1-\sqrt{1-4t^2}}{2t}. \tag{3.54}$$

We can expand and simplify $\widetilde{Q}_0$ and $\widetilde{Q}$ to find

$$\widetilde{Q}_0 = \frac{2-a-a\sqrt{1-4t^2}}{2(1-a+a^2t^2)} \tag{3.55}$$

$$\widetilde{Q} = \frac{((a-2)t+(1-a)x+2axt^2)+(at+(1-a)x)\sqrt{1-4t^2}}{2(1-a+a^2t^2)(x-t-tx^2)}. \tag{3.56}$$

We have the expansion

$$\widetilde{Q} = 1 + xt + (a+x^2)t^2 + x(1+a+x^2)t^3 + \cdots. \tag{3.57}$$

This allows us to write

$$\begin{aligned} Q(x_1,x_2,a_1,a_2;t) =& \widetilde{Q}(x_1,a_1;t) \odot \widetilde{Q}(x_1,a_2;t) \\ =& 1 + x_1x_2t + (a_1+x_1^2)(a_2+x_2^2)t^2 \\ &+ x_1x_2(1+a_1+x_1^2)(1+a_2+x_2^2)t^3 + \cdots. \end{aligned} \tag{3.58}$$

However obtaining an explicit function via the Hadamard product seems to be rather messy. The function will not be algebraic since the unmarked variant is not algebraic. But at least the function Q is D-finite since both functions in the product are.

3.4 Specializing to 2 dimensions

Until the end of the chapter we'll focus on the 2-dimensional models with interactions.

Corollary 26. *The generating function function Q satisfies the master functional equation*

$$KQ - K_1Q_1^0 - K_2Q_2^0 + K_{1,2}Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = \overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2. \tag{3.59}$$

Corollary 27. *The generating function Q satisfies the additional functional equations*

$$(1 - ta_1 S_1^0)Q_1^0 - (c_2 - ta_1\overline{x}_2 S_{1,2}^{0,-1})Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - a_1 t(S_1^{-1}Q_1^1 - \overline{x}_2 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}Q_{1,2}^{1,0}) = \overline{a}_2\,,$$
$$(1 - ta_2 S_2^0)Q_2^0 - (c_1 - ta_2\overline{x}_1 S_{1,2}^{-1,0})Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - a_2 t(S_2^{-1}Q_2^1 - \overline{x}_1 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}Q_{1,2}^{0,1}) = \overline{a}_1\,,$$
$$(1 - a_1 a_2 t S_{1,2}^{0,0})Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - ta_1 a_2 t(S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}Q_{1,2}^{1,1} + S_{1,2}^{-1,0}Q_{1,2}^{1,0} + S_{1,2}^{0,-1}Q_{1,2}^{0,1}) = 1$$

where $S_{1,2}^{0,0} = 1$ if we have resting steps and zero otherwise.

3.4.1 First examples in the plane

Quarter-plane models with small steps and without interactions have been investigated extensively but the case with interaction has not been investigated as much and we are interested in finding the generating function Q explicitly, or at least $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$. This appears to be difficult in most nontrivial cases so in general we may have to resort to finding if Q or $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$ is D-finite in the t variable. Apart from that recent research into two-dimensional random walks with interactions has shown that there are models where we have an explicit relationship between Q or $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$ and unmarked variants. As we saw in the previous chapter the on-dimensional cases admit a linear relationship with polynomial coefficients. There two-dimensional models that exhibit a rational relationship. It is possible that other models don't even have such a relationship with their unmarked counterparts.

Our work can be split into several cases of increasing difficulty. We start with trivial models, continue through some semi-trivial models, go through some nontrivial models and finish at some difficult problems in the latter chapter. The trivial models are those where we don't have to do any work to find the generating functions. There are models with walks that never leave the origin. However complicated $\mathcal{S}$ it doesn't matter because $Q = 1$ when we don't have resting steps and $1/(1 - a_1 a_2 S_0 t)$ when we have a resting step. There are also the semi-triviall models where walks leave the origin but never come back to any axis. We'll solve such models explicitly later on but for now it suffices to say that $Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = 1$ in the case with no resting steps and $Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = 1/(1 - a_1 a_2 S_0 t)$ in the case with resting steps. In each of these situations we have a relationship between the interacting and noninteracting models. In any of these simple cases we can write $BQ_{1,2}^{0,0} = 0$ and sometimes $BQ = 0$ where $B = B_1 B_2$ and $B_k = 1 - [b_k^0]$ as in the one-dimensional case.

Here are all the easy cases of step sets that lead to walks that either don't leave the origin or leave it and never come back. We're not allowing resting steps here. There are 80 such sets among the 256 non-resting possible cases. Of course we could use symmetries to eliminate cases bu we won't do that.

There are $2^5 = 32$ types of walks that don't leave the origin. Those are walks with steps among

the set {NW,W,SW,S,SE}. Next we look at the walks that leave the origin but never come back. There is the case of $S = \{NE\}$ that never comes back to any axis. Let's look at those walks that never come back to the x_1 axis. We have some steps that go in the positive x_2 direction, that is one of {N, NE, E} together with some steps from {NW, W, SW}. If we were to include any other steps we would come back to the x_1 axis. If we only have a N step, we have 8 new cases, if we have only a NE step we have 3 new cases and if we have both, we have 4 new cases. This gives a total of 15 new cases. There's an equivalent number of walks that leave the x_2 axis and never come back to it. The running total is $32 + 1 + 15 + 15 = 63$.

To finish off we have 17 cases of walks that leave the origin, eventually interact with both axes but never come back to the origin. For this we must only include steps in such a way that we cannot pick a selection of steps that will decrease both the x_1 and x_2 coordinates. We have to pick a subset of steps from {N, NE, E} so the only other steps allowed are NW and SE. The new cases coming from {N, NE, E}, {N,E}, {N, NE }, {NE, E}, {N}, {NE}, {E} are 4, 4, 2, 2, 1, 2, 2 respectively.

Before we consider walks that come back to the origin we'll look at the behavior Q depending on whether S factors in some nice way or not.

3.4.2 Kernel Group Considerations

It is important to find more functional equations if we can. One way to do this is by applying a transformation on the pair (x_1, x_2) that leaves as many parts of the functional equation as we can but still adding some information in the form of a new equation. One way to do this is to cosider mapping x_1 and x_2 to some quantities separately and then consider the full group generated by such maps. Since we usually eliminate the kernel in front of Q it is useful to consider transformations that preserve the kernel. This is a fruitful approach in the noninteracting case and it has been covered in ZZCITEZZ. We'll call this group $G(K)$, although it won't be the full group of rational transformations preserving the kernel. For example $(x_1, x_2) \mapsto (x_2, x_1)$ will not be in the group. Any transformation on (x_1, x_2) that preserves the kernel $K = 1 - tS$ must necessarily preserve the step polynomial S. Here

$$S = \alpha\overline{x} + \beta + \gamma x \tag{3.60}$$

where $x = x_1$ or x_2 and α, β, γ change correspondingly. We consider sending $x \mapsto y$ and solve for y to determine the possible transformations we can perform. That is we have

$$\alpha\overline{x} + \gamma x = \alpha\overline{y} + \gamma y \tag{3.61}$$

$$(\alpha - \gamma xy)(y - x) = 0\,. \tag{3.62}$$

We have cases

- $\alpha = 0, \gamma = 0$. The equation is then trivially true and any transformation preserves the kernel although this is not very useful though.
- $\alpha = 0, \gamma \neq 0$. Then $y = x$ and only the identity transformation preserves the kernel.
- $\alpha \neq 0, \gamma = 0$. Here $y = x$ as well.
- $\alpha \neq 0, \gamma \neq 0$. Here we either have $y = x$ or $y \neq x$ and $y = \overline{x}\alpha/\gamma = \overline{x}S_{-1}/S_1$.

In conclusion, either every transformation works and we don't have an interesting case or we have the identity transformation plus a possible second one. The last transformation creates a nontrivial group and we can have groups of various orders. Let

$$g_1 : x_1 \mapsto \overline{x}_1 \frac{S_1^{-1}}{S_1^1}, \quad g_2 : x_2 \mapsto \overline{x}_2 \frac{S_2^{-1}}{S_2^1} \tag{3.63}$$

whenever the S quantities are non-zero. Note that $g_i(g_i(x_1)) = x_1$, that is they are involutions. Contrast this suggestive notation to the notation in previous approaches in ZZCITEZZ and ZZCITEZZ. We have three cases for each x

- 1: Any transformation can be applied.
- 2: We only have the identity transformation.
- 3: We have two transformations.

We'll combine cases for analysis in the form "case $i.j$" to mean we have case i for x_1 and case j for x_2.

Case 1.1: Here we can apply any transformation on both x_1 and x_2. From the transformation analysis this means that $S_1^{-1} = S_1^1 = S_2^{-1} = S_2^1 = 0$ and thus means that we have no steps that go away from the origin. Therefore $S = S_{1,2}^{0,0}$. Thus we have only two models - no steps or a resting step.

Case 1.2: Here any transformation applies on x_1, so $S_1^{-1} = S_1^1 = 0$ so the model has no steps that step away from the origin in the x_1-direction. Since the only transformation on x_2 is the identity transformation we either have $S_2^{-1} = 0$ or $S_2^1 = 0$ in which case the model consists of only an up step or a down step, together with a possible resting step. Similarly, the 2.1 case involves a single x_1 or $\overline{x}_1$ step with a possible resting step.

Case 1.3: (and 3.1): This case is similar to the previous one except that now we have two transformations for x_2 and this means $S_2^{-1}, S_2^1 \neq 0$. This means we must have either both vertical steps x_2 and $\overline{x}_2$ in the 1.3 case or two horizontal steps x_1 and $\overline{x}_1$ in the 3.1 case.

Case 2.2: In this case both transformations are the identity transformations. Therefore exactly one of S_1^{-1} and S_1^1 is zero and exactly one of S_2^{-1} and S_2^1 is zero. WLOG, assume that $S_1^1 \neq 0, S_2^1 \neq 0$ (the other models can be obtained by a rotation around the origing of 90, 180 and 270 degrees). The possible models are the ones with steps in {N,E,NE} except the ones going either only in the N direction or only in the E direction. Here are the models in the positive quadrant



Figure 3.3: Models from case 2.2

This is a case of group $G(K)$ or order 1.

Case 2.3: In this case there is only one transformation for x_1 and two for x_2. This means $S_1^{-1} = 0$ (positive case) or $S_1^1 = 0$ (negative case) but not both. Also $S_1^{-1}, S_2^1 \neq 0$ so there must be at least one step going in the positive x_2 direction and one in the negative x_2 direction. We have 17 cases (and another 17 including a resting step). Of course in the 3.2 case we have the meaning of x_1 and x_2 reversed. This is a case of group $G(K)$ of order 2. Here are some but not all of these models.

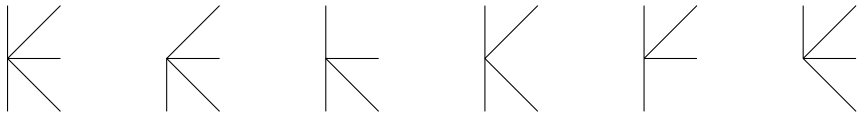


Figure 3.4: Models from case 2.3

Case 3.3: This is the most interesting case with two transformations for x_1 and x_2 each. This means that there must be at least one step going in a positive and one going in a negative coordinate

for each of x_1 and x_2. There are a lot of such cases (in the hundreds). Previous results show that the group $G(K)$ has orders 4, 6, 8 and infinity depending on the step set in question.

Later we'll see that these cases correspond to the idea of dimensionality of the model. Case 1.1 is zero-dimensional. Cases 1.2, 1.3 (and 3.1) are one-dimensional. Cases 2.2, 2.3 and 3.3 are two-dimensional. It should not be a suprise that the 0 and 1-dimensional cases will be easy while the two-dimensional cases will become progressively more difficult.

3.5 Solving basic 2D models

3.5.1 Cases 1.1, 1.2, 1.3

A quick glance at the step models involved shows that we are dealing with essentially one-dimensional problems. This means they can be solved easily explicitly. One can also note that these models are all factorable

$$S(x_1, x_2) = 1 \cdot S(x_2)\,. \tag{3.64}$$

Both Q_1 and Q_2 are functions we solved for in the one-dimensional case

$$Q_1(x_1, a_1, t) = \frac{1}{1 - a_1 t}, \quad Q_2(x_2, a_2, t) = q(x_2, a_2, t) \tag{3.65}$$

for some solution q from that section. Therefore

$$\begin{aligned} Q(x_1, x_2, a_1, a_2, t) &= Q_1(x_1, a_1, t) \odot Q_2(x_2, a_2, t) \\ &= \frac{1}{1 - a_1 t} \odot q(x_2, a_2, t) = q(x_2, a_2, a_1 t)\,. \end{aligned} \tag{3.66}$$

Similarly in the 2.1, 3.1 cases

$$\begin{aligned} Q(x_1, x_2, a_1, a_2, t) &= Q_1(x_1, a_1, t) \odot Q_2(x_2, a_2, t) \\ &= q(x_1, a_1, t) \odot \frac{1}{1 - a_2 t} = q(x_1, a_1, a_2 t) \end{aligned} \tag{3.67}$$

and this completes the solution. What about the relationship with the $B_1 B_2$ transformation? If $f(a, t)$ is the function that goes together with $q(x, a, t)$ then the function $F(a_1, a_2, t)$ that goes

together with $Q(x_1, x_2, a_1, a_2, t)$ is given by

$$F(a_1, a_2, t) = f(a_2, a_1 t)\,. \tag{3.68}$$

Then we have $B_2(FQ) = 0$ and $B_1 B_2(FQ) = 0$.

3.5.2 Case 2.2 - group of order 1

A quick glance at the step models reveals that this case is mostly trivial. We have a lot of models that never leave the origin and those have a trivial solution

$$Q(x_1, x_2, a_1, a_2) = \frac{1}{1 - a_1 a_2 S^{0,0}_{1,2} t}\,. \tag{3.69}$$

We also have a lot of models that are essentially one-dimensional with a single step going along an axis and some steps going off-axis where the latter steps can never be taken by a random walk in this model. They are essentially cases already covered in the previous section. Suppose that the single step is taken in the positive x_1 direction. This is equivalent to the $s_{-1} = 0$ case in 1D with function

$$q(x, a, t) = \frac{1 - s_0 t}{(1 - st)(1 - a s_0 t)} = \frac{1 - s_0 t}{(1 - x_1 s_1 t)(1 - a s_0 t)}\,. \tag{3.70}$$

Then we have

$$\begin{aligned} Q(x_1, x_2, a_1, a_2, t) &= Q_1(x_1, a_1, t) \odot Q_2(x_2, a_2, t) \\ &= q(x_1, a_1, t) \odot \frac{1}{1 - a_2 t} = q(x_1, a_1, a_2 t) \end{aligned} \tag{3.71}$$

and therefore

$$Q(x_1, x_2, a_1, a_2, t) = \frac{1 - a_2 S^{0,0}_{1,2} t}{(1 - (x_1 + S^{0,0}_{1,2}) a_2 t)(1 - a_1 a_2 S^{0,0}_{1,2} t)}\,. \tag{3.72}$$

The interesting models in case 2.2 are those with non-negative steps that we listed. Here

$$S = \alpha x_1 + \beta x_2 + \gamma x_1 x_2 + \delta\,. \tag{3.73}$$

The functional equation and its zero extractions are

$$\begin{aligned}(1-tS)Q - c_1Q_1^0 - c_2Q_2^0 + c_1c_2Q_{1,2}^{0,0} &= \overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2\,,\\ (1-ta_1(\delta+\beta x_2))Q_1^0 - c_2Q_{1,2}^{0,0} &= \overline{a}_2\,,\\ (1-ta_2(\delta+\alpha x_1))Q_2^0 - c_1Q_{1,2}^{0,0} &= \overline{a}_1\,,\\ (1-a_1a_2t\delta)Q_{1,2}^{0,0} &= 1\,.\end{aligned} \tag{3.74}$$

We solve the problem by a simple back-substitution of the variables.

$$Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = \frac{1}{1-a_1a_2\delta t}\,, \tag{3.75}$$

$$Q_1^0 = \frac{\overline{a}_2}{1-ta_2S_1^0}\left(1+\frac{b_2}{1-a_1a_2\delta t}\right) = \frac{1-a_1\delta t}{(1-ta_1S_1^0)(1-a_1a_2\delta t)}\,, \tag{3.76}$$

$$Q_2^0 = \frac{\overline{a}_1}{1-ta_1S_2^0}\left(1+\frac{b_1}{1-a_1a_2\delta t}\right) = \frac{1-a_2\delta t}{(1-ta_2S_2^0)(1-a_1a_2\delta t)} \tag{3.77}$$

$$Q = \frac{1}{1-tS}(\overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2 + c_1Q_1^0 + c_2Q_2^0 - c_1c_2Q_{1,2}^{0,0}) \tag{3.78}$$

$$= \frac{1}{1-tS}\left(\overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2 + \frac{1}{1-ta_1a_2\delta}\left(c_1\frac{1-a_1\delta t}{1-ta_1S_1^0} + c_2\frac{1-a_2\delta t}{1-ta_2S_1^0} - c_1c_2\right)\right) \tag{3.79}$$

$$= \frac{1}{1-tS}\left(\overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2 + \frac{1}{1-a_1a_2\delta t}(c_1f_1(a_1,t) + c_2f_2(a_2,t) - c_1c_2)\right) \tag{3.80}$$

where the last line explicitly shows that Q is composed of functions that depend only on one of a_1, a_2. If we want to find a relation of the type $B(FQ) = 0$ then we must first find a suitable function F. First of all the $1-tS$ part doesn't play a role since it doesn't depend on a_1 or a_2. Then later the variables c_1 and c_2 will vanish when extracting the coefficients of b_1^0 and b_2^0. We'll now show that the function

$$F(a_1,a_2,t) = 1-a_1a_2\delta t \tag{3.81}$$

works exactly. First

$$B((1-a_1a_2\delta t)\overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2) = B(\overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2 - t\delta) = B(\overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2) - B(t\delta) = \overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2 - \overline{a}_2 - \overline{a}_1 + 1 = c_1c_2\,. \tag{3.82}$$

Then

$$B(c_1f_1 + c_2f_2 - c_1c_2) = c_1f_1 + c_2f_2 - c_1c_2 - c_2f_2 - c_1f_1 = -c_2c_2\,. \tag{3.83}$$

Putting the two quantities together along with dividing by $1-tS$ shows that $B(FQ)=0$. Of course this works for $G=Q^{0,0}_{1,2}$ too.

3.5.3 Case 2.3 - group of order 2

There are two possibilities here - positive and negative. In the negative case $S^1_1=0$ and the steps have a non-positive x_1 component. Due to the fact that a lot of steps are not going to be taken by random walks in those models, all of these models reduce to the cases of S consising of a rest step and maybe a single step in a positive direction. This takes care of 34 models (or 68 if we include a rest step). The interesting models are those with a positive x_1 component, or in other words, models where $S^{-1}_1=0$. The calculations for these models become increasingly more complicated. The functional equation and its extracted forms read as

$$\begin{aligned}(1-tS)Q-c_1Q^0_1-(c_2-t\overline{x}_2S^{-1}_1)Q^0_2+c_1c_2Q^{0,0}_{1,2}&=\overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2\,,\\ (1-ta_1S^0_1)Q^0_1-(c_2-ta_1\overline{x}_2S^{0,-1}_{1,2})Q^{0,0}_{1,2}&=\overline{a}_2\,,\\ (1-ta_2S^0_2)Q^0_2-c_1Q^{0,0}_{1,2}-a_2tS^{-1}_1Q^1_2&=\overline{a}_1\,,\\ (1-a_1a_2tS^{0,0}_{1,2})Q^{0,0}_{1,2}-ta_1a_2S^{0,-1}_{1,2}Q^{0,1}_{1,2}&=1\,.\end{aligned}\tag{3.84}$$

We can identify a subproblem that is essentially one-dimensional and therefore already solved. For this we look at the second and fourth equations with the substitution $a_i=a, c_i=c, x_2=x, ta_1=\tau, S^0_1=T, Q^0_1(x_2)=q(x)$. These equations become

$$(1-\tau T)q-(c-\tau\overline{x}T_{-1})q_0=\overline{a}\,,\tag{3.85}$$

$$(1-a\tau T_0)q_0-a\tau S^{0,-1}_{1,2}q_1=1\tag{3.86}$$

where $q_0=q(a,\tau)$. This is the one-dimensional problem again. The solution here is $q(x,a,\tau)$ obtained by the methods in the previous chapter so the original problem has a solution

$$Q^0_1(x_2)=q(x_2,a_2,a_1t),\quad Q^{0,0}_{1,2}=q_0(a_2,a_1t)\,.\tag{3.87}$$

The reason the method worked in this case is that we have steps that keep a random walk staying on the x_2 axis and steps that take it away from the x_2 but no steps that have it return to it. This is similar to the case where a random walk leaves the x_2 axis never to come back. Essentially the problem splits into a one-dimensional one regarding the x_2 axis and a further 2D one once we step

off the axis. We re-write the master equation as

$$(1 - tS)Q - (c_2 - t\overline{x}_2 S_1^{-1})Q_2^0 = \overline{a}_1(\overline{a}_2 + b_1 q - b_1 c_2 q_0) = \overline{a}_1 \phi(x_2)\,. \tag{3.88}$$

Since $S_1^{-1}, S_2^1 \neq 0$ we have a root $x_2 = \sigma_2$ that allows us to remove the $(1 - tS)Q$ term and get

$$Q_2^0 = -\frac{\overline{a}_1 \phi(\sigma_2)}{c_2 - t\overline{\sigma}_2 S_1^{-1}} \tag{3.89}$$

so this allows us to write Q as

$$Q = \frac{1}{1 - tS}\left(\overline{a}_1 \phi(x_2) - \frac{c_2 - t\overline{x}_2 S_1^{-1}}{c_2 - t\overline{\sigma}_2 S_1^{-1}} \overline{a}_1 \phi(\sigma_2)\right)\,. \tag{3.90}$$

Of course, this can be expanded and simplified based on what q and q_0 are from the one-dimensional setting but the important thing is that we can obtain the solution in this case via one-dimensional equations.

3.5.4 Summary

We can give a short summary of the result via a table. Here q stands for a one-dimensional solution and f to its associated function such that $B(fq) = 0$.

Case	Q	$F(a_1, a_2, t)$
1.1	1	1
1.2, 1.3	$q(x_2, a_2, a_1 t)$	$f(a_2, a_1 t)$
2.1, 3.1	$q(x_1, a_1, a_2 t)$	$f(a_1, a_2 t)$
2.2	$\dfrac{\overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2 + \frac{c_1 f_1 + c_2 f_2 - c_1 c_2}{1 - a_1 a_2 \delta t}}{1 - tS}$	
2.3		

Table 3.1: Easy 2D cases

Chapter 4

Random walk models with general constraints

4.1 Introduction

In this chapter we'll push the operator notation further to see what kinds of random walk models have a relatively easy functional equation to write. We start with the following definition for a random walk model in $\mathbb{Z}^d$. Some of the models have more general step sets while others are set in more complicated regions. For example, Definition 1.1 of [7] has a functional equation for the non-interacting random walks on the quarter plane which is valid for models with $\mathcal{S}$ containing negative coordinates of size at most -1. Similarly [11] covers walks in the quarter plane with multiple copies of small steps.

Definition 28. *Let $\mathcal{D}_0 \subseteq \mathcal{D}$ be regions in $\mathbb{Z}^d$ and $\mathcal{S}$ be a set of d-tuples in $\mathbb{Z}^d$. A triple $\mathcal{M} = (\mathcal{S}, \mathcal{D}, \mathcal{D}_0)$ is a random walk model $\mathcal{M}$ with steps $\mathcal{S}$, living in the region $\mathcal{D}$ and interacting with region $\mathcal{D}_0$. We may impose a starting location later on.*

In other words, we are given a set of steps $\mathcal{S}$ and a starting location in $\mathcal{D}$. Then we want to evolve the random walks restricted to the region $\mathcal{D}$. We also have some special locations $\mathcal{D}_0$ within $\mathcal{D}$ and we wish to count the interactions of the random walks with points in this region. The interactions may be further specified later on.

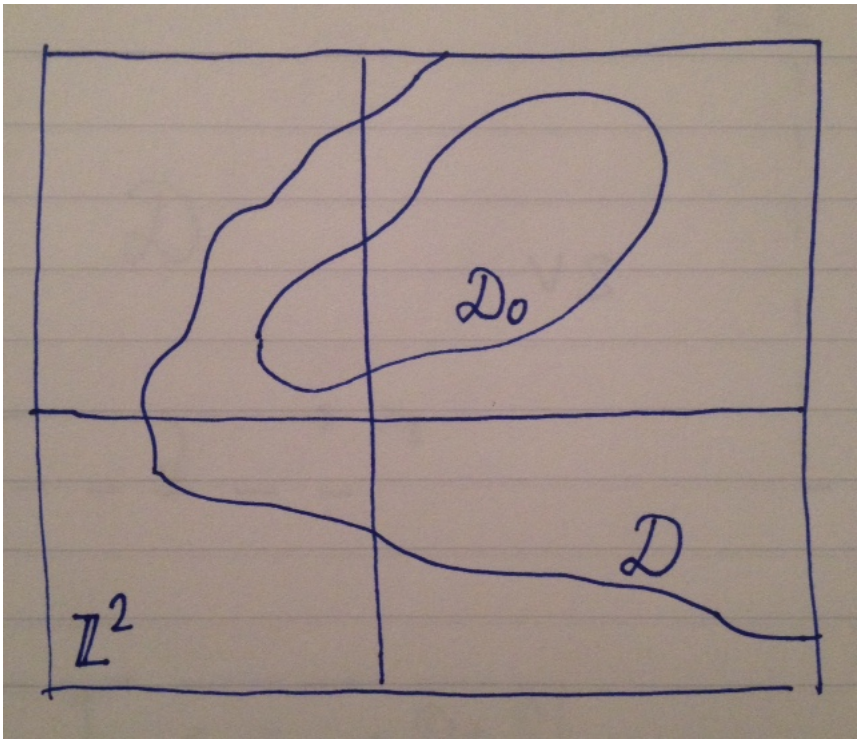


Figure 4.1: General regions in $\mathbb{Z}^2$

For example we may consider a semi-infinite strip on the plane as in [27], [**?**] and [28]. In [26] the author considers random walks in an octant with interactions with the diagonal.

Definition 29. *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a random walk model and Q its associated generating function counting length with t, ending locations with $x_1, \ldots, x_d$ and interactions with $\mathcal{D}_0$ with some multi-index variable a. We write*

$$Q = Q(x_1, \ldots, x_d, a; t) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} q_k(x_1, \ldots, x_d, a)t^k \tag{4.1}$$

where q_k are Laurent poynomials in the x and a variables.

Definition 30. *Suppose Γ is an operator involving the x and a variables but not t. We shall apply D on power series $F = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} f_k t^k$ in the following linearized way*

$$\Gamma F = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} \Gamma(f_k)t^k \tag{4.2}$$

to avoid issues of expanding F in Laurent series in some of the x variables.

Definition 31. *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a given model. We'll denote with S the Laurent polynomial (or series) keeping inventory of the steps $\mathcal{S}$. Let $K = 1 - tS$ be the Kernel of $\mathcal{M}$. Let E be an operator that eliminates monomials $x^P_{[d]}$ when P is not in $\mathcal{D}$. Let L be an operator that marks (or labels) monomials $x^P_{[d]}$ for $P \in \mathcal{D}_0$ in a specified way in the model. Note that L is invertible with inverse L^{-1} that is given by marking with $1/a$ instead.*

This operator notation allows us to write down functional equations for Q really quickly. We have

Theorem 32. *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a random walk model and Q its associated generating function with an initial term $q_0 = q$. Then Q satisfies the following functional equations*

$$(1 - tLES)Q = q \tag{4.3}$$

$$(L^{-1} - tES)Q = L^{-1}(q) = \alpha \tag{4.4}$$

Proof. The second functional equation is obtained by applying L^{-1} on the first one. It only remains to show that the first functional equation holds. We do this via iteration. We start with Q and multiply it with tS. This gives tSQ or an enumeration of all walks extended by a single step. Here the power of t is raised by one to keep track of this extension. Then we apply E to this result to eliminate all random walks that venture outside of the region $\mathcal{D}$. Finally we mark those walks that have arrived at locations in $\mathcal{D}_0$ by applying L to $E(tSQ)$. The resulting expression is almost Q but with one term missing, namely $q_0 = q$. That is we have transformed Q to itself in a nontrivial way giving us the functional equation

$$Q = q + LE(tSQ) = q + tLE(SQ) \tag{4.5}$$

which we re-write in the form at the start of the theorem. □

Example 33. We can also consider a different approach where instead of removing walks that venture outside of $\mathcal{D}$ we just mark them with some variable z for later deletion. Suppose we are given some $\mathcal{M}$ and we want to frame in this new way. We have a new random walk model $\widetilde{\mathcal{M}}$ with $\widetilde{\mathcal{D}} = \mathbb{Z}^d$ and $\widetilde{\mathcal{D}}_0 = \mathcal{D}_0 \cup \mathcal{D}^c$ where we mark monomials in $\mathcal{D}^c$ with z and those in $\mathcal{D}_0$ as in $\mathcal{M}$. Here $\widetilde{E}$ is the identity since we don't remove any walks. We have the functional equations

$$(1 - t\widetilde{L}S)\widetilde{Q} = q\,, \tag{4.6}$$

$$(\widetilde{L}^{-1} - tS)Q = \widetilde{\alpha}\,. \tag{4.7}$$

We can talk about some of the abstract properties of the operators L and E. The operator E has the eigenvalues 1 or 0 for monomials $x^P_{[d]}$ where $P \in \mathcal{D}$ or $P \in \mathcal{D}^c$ respectively. The latter characterizes the monomials contained in $\ker E$. Similarly L has eigenvalues 1 for when $P \in \mathcal{D}^c_0$ and the marking monomial a for when $P \in \mathcal{D}_0$. Here a will varry from point to point. Also L^{-1} will have the reciprocal eigenvalues of L.

The task for the rest of the chapter is to come up with representations for the operators involved. In general this should not be an easy task because if we could express arbitrary operators L and E with a small number of coefficient extractions we'd also be able to use this scheme to compress data without loss, which is impossible in general.

4.2 Marking Operators

The example in the previous section shows that we can talk about marking operators on their own without considering operators E. Alternatively, the operators E are just marking operators which apply a label $a = 0$. Therefore we can combine the discussions for operators L and E into one holistic approach. Whenever invertibility is concerned the discussion will apply to operators L only. Suppose that we wish to mark points $p \in P \subseteq \mathbb{Z}^d$ with labels a_p via an operator Γ_P. It can be written as

$$\Gamma_P = 1 + \sum_{p \in P} (a_p - 1) x^p_{[d]} [x^p_{[d]}] \tag{4.8}$$

The form $a_p - 1$ follows from the fact that we have the original term and we need to remove it before marking with a_p. In the case where we mark points for deletion $P = \mathcal{D}^c$ and $a_p = a$. In the models we have investigated so far we saw that we don't really need the whole operator but just some terms near the boundaries.

Example 34. If we consider random walks with small steps on the half-line in one dimension we have the operator

$$E = 1 - \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \overline{x}^n_1 [\overline{x}^n_1] \tag{4.9}$$

but since we only have small steps there are no walks that go past $\overline{x}_1$ in the negative direction so we can instead use the operator $E' = 1 - \overline{x}_1[\overline{x}_1]$ to the same effect. Although the operators are different in form they are essentially the same with regards to the problem at hand. We'll say they are model-equivalent.

We may think of the random walk models as really living completely within the sumset $\mathcal{S} + \mathcal{D}$

of points that are combinations of points in $\mathcal{D}$ and steps $\mathcal{S}$. This is how far the model can reach from within $\mathcal{D}$ by taking a single step.

Definition 35. *Given sets A and B we let their sumset be defined as*

$$A + B = \{a + b \,|\, a \in A,\, b \in B\}\,. \tag{4.10}$$

Definition 36. *Given a random walk model $\mathcal{M}$ with domain $\mathcal{D}$ and step set $\mathcal{S}$, define the reach of $\mathcal{M}$ to be the sumset $\mathcal{D} + \mathcal{S}$.*

With this in mind we can define a notion of equivalence for operators.

Definition 37. *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a random walk model in $\mathbb{Z}^d$ and let Γ and Γ' be two operators acting on $\mathbb{Z}^d$. Then $\Gamma \equiv_{\mathcal{M}} \Gamma'$ if and only if Γ and Γ' act the same way on monomials from the reach of $\mathcal{M}$. That is, we call these operators model-equivalent if and only if $\Gamma x^P = \Gamma' x^P$ for all $P \in \mathcal{D} + \mathcal{S}$.*

In the preceding example $E \equiv E'$ since they act the same way on monomials from the reach of $\mathcal{M}$, that is monomials x_1^n for $n \geqslant$ -1. Similarly in the two-dimensional problem we have an equivalence between the operator E and the operator $E' = (1 - \overline{x}_1[\overline{x}_1])(1 - \overline{x}_2[\overline{x}_2])$.

$$\Gamma = 1 + (a-1)\sum_{k=1}^{\infty} \overline{x}^k[\overline{x}^k] = 1 + (a-1)\sum_{k=1}^{n} \overline{x}^k[\overline{x}^k] \tag{4.11}$$

When the boundary of $\mathcal{D}$ is complicated we may not find nice model-equivalent operators but there are some cases where we can say something. In the usual problem we have an operator E with infinitely many terms but instead we find that there is a model-equivalent operator E' that is comprised of only finitely many terms. We may investigate which operators have finite equivalent operators.

Definition 38. *Given a model $\mathcal{M}$, a coefficient extraction operator Γ in the variables $x_1, \ldots, x_d$ is of finite type if it is equivalent to an operator Γ' that only has finitely many coefficient extraction terms. That is,*

$$\Gamma \equiv_{\mathcal{M}} \Gamma' = \sum_{\substack{I \subseteq [d] \\ J \subseteq \mathbb{Z}^d}} a_{I,J} x_I^J [x_I^J] \tag{4.12}$$

where each $|J| < \infty$. We'll say that Γ' is of infinite type if it's not of finite type.

For most purposes we won't distinguish between Γ and Γ'. A natural question is to consider which models $\mathcal{M}$ lead to operators of finite type. This very much depends on the region $\mathcal{D}$ and the nature of the marking of region $\mathcal{D}_0$. We have some cases where it is easy to say.

Lemma 39. *Let $\mathcal{D}$ be a d-dimensional box in $\mathbb{Z}^d$ and $|\mathcal{S}| < \infty$. Then the operator $\Gamma = LE$ is of finite type.*

Proof. The operator L is finite since it only needs to mark finitely many points. We can find E explicitly. Let the box have x_k coordinates $[a_k, b_k]$. Suppose that the steps in $\mathcal{S}$ have x_k coordinates of absolute size at most n_k. If $n_k = 0$ the walks don't change their x_k coordinate and the walks don't venture past the boundaries in that coordinate. When $n_k > 0$ we need to remove all monomials x^P with $P_k \in [a_k - n_k, a_k - 1] \cup [b_k + 1, b_k + n_k]$.

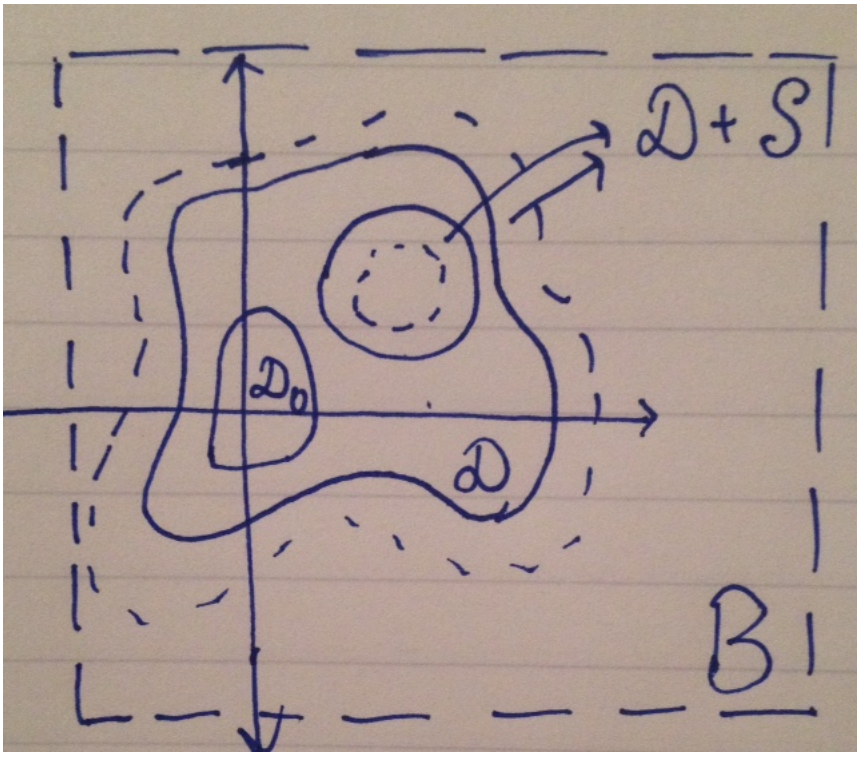


Figure 4.2: Finite region enclosed in box B

This immediately gives us the operator

$$E_k = 1 - \sum_{j=1}^{n_k} x_k^{a_k - j}[x_k^{a_k - j}] + x_k^{b_k + j}[x_k^{b_k + j}], \tag{4.13}$$

which is equal to $E_k = 1$ when $n = 0$. Applying $E_1, \ldots, E_d$ sequentially ensures that we remove all monomials outside of $\mathcal{D}$. That is, $E = E_1 \cdots E_d$. Since each of the operators is finite so is their composition $\Gamma = LE$. □

Theorem 40. *Let $\mathcal{D}$ be a finite region in $\mathbb{Z}^d$ and $|\mathcal{S}| < \infty$. Then the operator $\Gamma = LE$ is of finite type.*

Proof. The region $\mathcal{D}$ lies within a bounding box B so we may write $E = E'E''$ where $E' = E_1 \cdots E_d$ from the lemma and E'' is the operator removing all monomials outside of $\mathcal{D}$ but inside the interior of B. Since there are only finitely many points in that region E'' is finite. Since we're marking only finitely many points $\mathcal{D}_0 \subseteq \mathcal{D}$, L is finite and finally Γ is finite. □

We may also handle semi-infinite regions if we're only marking finitely many points $\mathcal{D}_0$. The analysis is the same as above except that now one or more of a_k, b_k may be infinite, in which case we actually lose parts of Γ_{B^c} and the operator is still finite.

Definition 41. *A random walk model with finitely many steps is of finite type if its extraction and marking operators E and L are of finite type and its starting condition q is of finite degree. Otherwise we say the model is of infinite type.*

Example 42. All the models so far has been of finite type but not all models are of finite type. Consider a one-dimensional model on the whole line where we mark points x_i with monomials a_i using operator L. Then any equivalent marking operator L' would have to have a term like $(a_i - 1)x_1^i[x_1^i]$, otherwise it would not act the same way on monomials in the model's reach $\mathbb{Z}$. Therefore we must not have a finite operator L' either.

Finite models are somewhat nice because they will have functional equations with finitely many terms and they'll perhaps be amenable to analysis of the sort we've performed for quarter-plane walk models. What follows is a rather easy application of the theory so far.

4.3 Kernel Forms

We can write out the functional equations in a way that highlights the kernel K in the equation. We start out as follows

$$(1 - tLES)Q = 1 \tag{4.14}$$

$$(1 - t(LE - 1 + 1)S)Q = 1 \tag{4.15}$$

$$KQ + t(1 - LE)SQ = 1\,. \tag{4.16}$$

This is the form we see in the master functional equation. Another way we could have expanded is as follows

$$\begin{aligned}(1-tLES)Q &= 1\\ (1+LE(1-tS-1))Q &= 1\\ LEKQ+(1-LE)Q &= 1\\ LEKQ+(1-L)Q &= 1\end{aligned} \tag{4.17}$$

where $EQ = Q$ since Q is already of a valid form. We can go with both ways at the same time as well.

$$\begin{aligned}KQ+t(1-LE)SQ &= 1\\ KQ+(1-LE)(1-tS-1)Q &= 1\\ KQ+(1-LE)KQ-(1-L)Q &= 1\,.\end{aligned} \tag{4.18}$$

We can apply the inverse L^{-1} to those equations too, in particular on the second one.

$$L^{-1}(LEKQ+(1-LE)Q) = 1 \tag{4.19}$$

The second form of the functional equation involving L^{-1} should have less terms than the first one by virtue of separating L and E from one another. Using extraction operators we can constrain random walks to lie within a finite region, semi-infinite strip, a semi-infinite sector or any other discrete shape (with diminishing returns for more complicated shapes of course). Furthermore using marking operators we can easily track the behavior of random walks as they cross or interact with boundaries or interact with regions within. For example we may consider walks interacting with the boundary of a box within some region in space.

4.4 Walks without interactions

The Kernel forms above suggest an easier route for dealing with the models without interactions. Those models are equivalent to setting all the $a_k = 1$ which removes any marking or unmarking operators. The first kernel form reduces to the simple functional equation

$$E(KQ) = 1\,. \tag{4.20}$$

This suggests using the following substitution

$$Q = \frac{W}{x_{[d]}K} \tag{4.21}$$

so we have

$$x_{[d]} = x_{[d]}E(KQ) = x_{[d]}E\overline{x}_{[d]}W = \Gamma W \tag{4.22}$$

where $\Gamma = \Gamma_1 \dots \Gamma_d$ and

$$\Gamma_k = x_k E_k \overline{x}_k = x_k(1 - \overline{x}_k[\overline{x}_k])\overline{x}_k = 1 - [x_k]^0 \,. \tag{4.23}$$

Therefore we have the functional equation for W as

Proposition 43. *Let $W = x_{[d]}KQ$ where Q is the generating function for walks without interactions in the positive orthant*

$$\Gamma W = \sum_{I \subseteq [d]} (-1)^{|I|} W_I^{\mathbb{O}} = x_{[d]} \,. \tag{4.24}$$

For example in two dimensions we have

$$W(x_1, x_2) - W_1^0(x_2) - W_2^0(x_1) + W_{1,2}^{0,0} = x_1 x_2 \,. \tag{4.25}$$

Thus we can write the solution to the problem as

$$Q = \frac{1}{x_{[d]}K} \left(x_{[d]} - \sum_{\varnothing \neq I \subseteq [d]} (-1)^{|I|} W_I^{\mathbb{O}} \right) . \tag{4.26}$$

In two dimensions this becomes

$$Q(x_1, x_2) = \frac{x_1 x_2 + W_1^0(x_2) + W_2^0(x_1) - W_{1,2}^{0,0}}{x_1 x_2 (1 - tS)} \,. \tag{4.27}$$

Of course each $W_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ depends on $Q_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ so we could have seen this relationship from the master functional equation for Q too. Interestingly enough this calculation points to a differential equation. Clearly, W satisfies the differential equations

$$\partial_1 \partial_2 W = 1 \tag{4.28}$$

Proposition 44. *The function Q for walks without interactions is D-finite in the $x_1, \ldots, x_d$ variables since it satisfies the inhomogeneous PDE*

$$\partial_1 \ldots \partial_d W = \partial_1 \ldots \partial_d (x_1 \ldots x_d K Q) = 1\,. \tag{4.29}$$

We'll see a more general relationship in a later chapter.

Theorem 45. *The generating function Q for a random walk model of finite type is D-finite in the variables $x_1, \ldots, x_d$.*

Proof. We'll use the kernel form for the functional equation

$$KQ + t(1-\Gamma)SQ = q. \tag{4.30}$$

Here $\Gamma' = 1 - \Gamma$ is purely a coefficient extractor and is of finite type since L and E are finite. We'll prove the theorem by finding the differential equation explicitly. Since the model is of finite type we can bound the degree of x_k that we see on either side of the functional equation. In one scheme we let A_k be the largest power of x_k that we need to clear a negative power of x_k in Γ' and in q. Then we let B_k be the largest power of x_k that we see on either side. Once we multiply by $x_k^{A_k}$ we see that the degree of x_k in the equation is $A_k + B_k$. We take the functional equation and multiply both sides by $x_{[d]}^{A}$

$$x_{[d]}^{A}(KQ + t\Gamma' SQ) = x_{[d]}^{A} q \tag{4.31}$$

and we obtain a polynomial equation in the variables $x_1, \ldots, x_d$. We take the derivative operator

$$D = \partial_{[d]}^{A+B+\mathbb{I}} = \partial_1^{A_1+B_1+1} \ldots \partial_d^{A_d+B_d+1} \tag{4.32}$$

and apply it to both sides of the equation to get

$$D(x_{[d]}^{A}(KQ + t\Gamma' SQ) = D(x_{[d]} KQ) = D(x_{[d]}^{A} q) = 0\,, \tag{4.33}$$

which follows since we're taking more derivatives than the degrees of the monomials which clears all of them. The other scheme lets us obtain a potentially lower degree differential equation at the cost of homogeneity if the degrees of q are large. Let A_k be the power of x_k that we need to clear denominators on the LHS of the functional equation and B_k be the largest power of x_k on that side. Then we have D as before but this time it may have lower A and B values since we are not taking

q into account. We have

$$D(x_{[d]}^{A}(KQ + t\Gamma' SQ) = D(x_{[d]}KQ) = D(x_{[d]}^{A}q)\,. \tag{4.34}$$

□

For example let the powers of x_k be $\{-3, -1, 4\}$ and $\{-2, 0, 6\}$ on the LHS and RHS respectively. We see that $A_k = 3$ and $B_k = 6$. Then we're taking the $A_k + B_k + 1 = 10$-th derivative of both sides of the functional equation. In The second scheme we take $A_k = 3$ still but $B_k = 4$ and we are taking the 8-th derivative w.r.t. x_k this time. Even in the quarter-plane we have models that have a generating function that is not D-finite (with respect to the t variable) but it turns out that every model so far considered is D-finite in the variables $x_1, \ldots, x_d$.

In order to solve the differential equation we need to investigate the kernel of the differential operator.

Corollary 46. *The generating function Q of a finite random model is given by*

$$x_{[d]}^{A}KQ(x_1, \ldots, x_d; t) = \sum_{i=1}^{d}\sum_{j=0}^{B_i} Aij(x_1, \ldots, x_{i-1}, x_i, \ldots, x_d, t)x_i^j \tag{4.35}$$

where A_{ij} are functions that need to be determined.

We could have also obtained this kind of solution from going through the calculations in the functional equation and extracted coefficients. However, this method is more efficient. If we had used the second scheme in the proof we would have ended up with a slightly different form but maybe it would have had a slightly lower degree. It would involve an indefinite integral of q and elements in the kernel of the differential operator.

4.5 Examples of regions we can consider

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Example 47 (Self-avoiding walks)**.** We can handle discrete self-avoiding random walks with this theory. If we pick a marking operator Γ that marks every location on the plane this will allow us to track the random walks' history. All we'll need to do in the end is remove those walks which have stepped at some location more than once. However we'll do this problem in a bit more detail as it serves as an example of the theory. To use the generating function iteration properly we need a sort of limiting argument. For the first n steps we "only" require an operator covering the square region

of $(2n+1)^2$ lattice points. The overall operator is defined through a limiting process of applying the full operator (or truncated version) on a finite Laurent polynomial. Let

$$\Gamma_{i,j} = 1 + b_{i,j} x_1^i x_2^j [x_1^i x_2^j] \tag{4.36}$$

where as usual $b_{i,j} = a_{i,j} - 1$. This operator takes a generating function and marks the monomial $x_1^i x_2^j$. We'll be using a lot of these together so we let

$$\Gamma_n = \prod_{-n \leqslant i,j \leqslant n} \Gamma_{i,j} \tag{4.37}$$

To find a functional equation for SAWs on the plane we perform an iteration. Let Q be the generating function for walks with history, that is they have a mark for each coordinate they pass through and let $Q^{\leqslant n}$ be the truncated version of this generating function. It's given by

$$Q^{\leqslant n} = \sum_{k=0}^{n} Q_k t^k \tag{4.38}$$

where the initial condition is $Q_0 = a_{0,0}$. Starting from Q_n we can find Q_{n+1} by iterating with the step set S, marking with Γ_{n+1} as follows

$$Q_{n+1} = \Gamma_{n+1} S Q_n \tag{4.39}$$

Using a computer we can easily iterate this to get more and more steps. We can also get $Q^{\leqslant n+1}$ from $Q^{\leqslant n}$ since

$$t\Gamma_{n+1} S Q^{\leqslant n} = \sum_{k=0}^{n} \Gamma_{n+1} S Q_k t^{k+1} = \sum_{k=0}^{n} \Gamma_{k+1} S Q_k t^{k+1} = \sum_{k=0}^{n} Q_{k+1} t^{k+1} = Q^{\leqslant n+1} - Q_0 \tag{4.40}$$

or in other words

$$Q^{\leqslant n+1} = a_{0,0} + t\Gamma_{n+1} S Q^{\leqslant n} \tag{4.41}$$

In the interest of finding a functional equation we would like to take the limiit of this as $n \to \infty$. For this we define Γ to be the operator marking all monomials $x_1^i x_2^j$ and acting in the following way

$$\Gamma x^i y^j = \Gamma_{\max(|i|,|j|)} x^i y^j \tag{4.42}$$

and extended by linearity. The limiting process is

$$Q = a_{0,0} + t\Gamma SQ \tag{4.43}$$

We finally have the functional equation for random walks with full history

$$(1 - t\Gamma S)Q = a_{0,0}. \tag{4.44}$$

As in the example of an infinte marking operator, it stands to reason that Γ is of infinite type as well. From the equation we can obtain the generating function W for the SAWs by removing all walks with power of mark $a_{i,j}$ greater than 1. For this we need an operator that removes terms with more than one copy of any given label. Let

$$R_{i,j} = a^0_{i,j}[a^0_{i,j}] + a_{i,j}[a_{i,j}] \tag{4.45}$$

$$R_n = \prod_{-n \leqslant i,j \leqslant n} R_{i,j} \tag{4.46}$$

$$R = \lim_{n \to \infty} R_n \tag{4.47}$$

where the limit is understood as in the example of Γ above. The solution for Q can also be restated as

$$Q = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma S)^k (a_{0,0}) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (\Gamma_k S)^k (a_{0,0}) \tag{4.48}$$

We can either redo the analysis applying R at every iteration or we can apply R to Q and get

$$W = RQ = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k R(\Gamma S)^k (a_{0,0}) = \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} t^k (R\Gamma S)^k (a_{0,0}) \tag{4.49}$$

We can write this as a functional equation

$$\mathcal{L}W = (1 - t\Sigma)W = (1 - tR\Gamma S)W = a_{0,0}. \tag{4.50}$$

It's not clear if the operator $R\Gamma$ is of finite type. Now it's enough to set all the remaining labels to 1 and we will obtain the full generating function of SAWs with steps from $\mathcal{S}$.

The discussion lends itself nicely to generalization where now we have d variables and operators $\Gamma_{i_1,\ldots,l_d}$, $R_{i_1,\ldots,i_d}$, etc defined analogously. The eigenpair discussion works out in the same way with

eigenfunctions for $\lambda = 1$

$$u = \frac{a^2_{i_1,\ldots,i_d} a^m_{j_1,\ldots,j_d}}{a_{k_1,\ldots,k_d} S} x_1^{r_1} \ldots x_d^{r_d} t^n \tag{4.51}$$

We can also constrain the SAWs on a part of $\mathbb{Z}^d$ with an extraction operator E and mark special locations with an operator L. The functional equation is

$$(1 - tLE\Sigma)W = a_{0,\ldots,0} \tag{4.52}$$

for arbitrary number of dimensions, with region constraints and marking of special locations.

Chapter 5

Further research directions

In this thesis we explored the usefulness of using operators to simplify the derivation of functional equations pertaining to random walk models on $\mathbb{Z}^d$ and to simplify the first steps in solutions to the problems. The sleek approach of operators makes us wonder if we can extend the work further into territories like Sturm-Liouville theory where we may investigate the spectra of operators and find alternative solutions to the functional equations via eigenfunctions and eigenvalues of these operators. For this to work we need a suitable inner product for which we may investigate if the operators are self-adjoint and so on. Unfortunately, we haven't found such suitable inner products apart from inner products on symmetric functions which may be promising. In this chapter we'll only provide the start of such analysis which may be undertaken as future research.

5.1 Operators

The operators we've seen in this thesis are almost invariably marking operators (like L and E), marking operators in combination of multiplication by another function (like ΓS) or a combination of operators (like $L^{-1} - tES$). In this order we'll investigate the operators' properties, eigenvalues, eigenvectors, kernels and invertibility.

5.1.1 Marking operators

The building block of the operators are coefficient extractions $[x_I^J]$ and in our case we see term extractions $x_I^J[x_I^J]$. We'll use the notation

Definition 48. *For sets I and J of equal size we define the term extraction operator as*

$$[[x_I^J]] \equiv x_I^J[x_I^J]\,. \tag{5.1}$$

The main question here is how to compose these term extractions. Suppose that we want to perform the extractions with monomials x_I^P and x_J^Q. Then the composition will contain three extractions - one for the x powers appearing in x_I^P but not in x_J^Q, one for the reversed situation and one for the common terms between the two monomials. However the resulting composition will be the zero operator if the power sequences for the common variables don't match.

Example 49. We compute

$$[[x_{1,2}^{3,4}]][[x_{2,3}^{4,1}]] = [[x_{1,2,3}^{3,4,1}]] \tag{5.2}$$

and

$$[[x_{1,2}^{3,2}]][[x_{2,3}^{4,1}]] = 0\,. \tag{5.3}$$

The next highly-technical lemma makes the composition precise.

Lemma 50. *Let I, J, P, Q be sets and $K = I \cap J$, $I' = I\backslash K$, $J' = J\backslash K$. Then let $P' = P|_{I'}$, $Q' = Q|_{J'}$ and $P'' = P\backslash P'$, $Q'' = Q\backslash Q'$. Then the composition of two term extractions is given by*

$$[[x_I^P]][[x_J^Q]] = \delta(P'', Q'')[[x_{I'}^{P'} x_{J'}^{Q'} x_K^{P''}]] \tag{5.4}$$

That is, the resulting operator is zero if the power sequences P and Q don't match over the variables common to the two extractions. Furthermore the two term extraction operators commute.

Combinatorially speaking, it should be clear that if a marking operator marks several different monomials we may express this operator as a product of marking operators each marking a single monomial. We can make this notion precise with the algebraic form of the marking operators.

Definition 51. *The operator Γ that marks a monomial x_I^J with a label a is given by*

$$\Gamma = 1 + (a-1)x_I^J[x_I^J] = 1 + b[[x_I^J]]\,. \tag{5.5}$$

A finite marking operator is one marking finitely many monomials. An infinite marking operator is one that is not finite.

Lemma 52. *Let α and β be the labels for two different monomials x_I^P and x_J^Q that are marked by Γ. Then*

$$\Gamma = 1 + (\alpha-1)[[x_I^P]] + (\beta-1)[[x_J^Q]] = (1 + (\alpha-1)[[x_I^P]])(1 + (\beta-1)[[x_J^Q]])\,. \tag{5.6}$$

Corollary 53. *Marking operators commute.*

Proof. This can be seen from their combinatorial nature. Since multiplication is commutative and the marking is done via multiplication, the order of applying the marking operators doesn't matter. Algebraically this is a consequence of the commutativity the term extraction operators. □

Combinatorially speaking, we can find some of the eigenvalues and eigenfunctions easily by looking at single monomials. Every non-marked monomial is an eigenfunction with eigenvalue 1. Every marked monomial is an eigenfunction with eigenvalue equal to the label. If we seek eigenfunctions among polynomials of the x variables by linear independence of the indeterminates we'll have that the eigenpairs listed so far are all we have. However this doesn't say anything about eigenvalues for eigenfunctions that are power series or Laurent series in the variables x. Although the analysis is straight-forward for operators marking single monomials.

Proposition 54. *Let Γ be an operator marking a single monomial x_I^J with label a. Let λ and u_λ be an eigenvalue and u be an eigenfunction corresponding to that eigenvalue. Then $\lambda = a$ with $u_\lambda = x_I^J$ or $\lambda = 1$ with u_λ a function not containing x_I^J (in the formal power series sense). In particular every monomial other than x_I^J is an eigenfunction with eigenvalue 1.*

Proof. Let $u_\lambda = u' + u''x_I^J$ where $u \neq 0$ and u'' doesn't share variables with x_I^J. Then

$$\Gamma(u) = u' + au''x_I^J = \lambda(u' + u''x_I^J)\,, \tag{5.7}$$

which we may write as

$$(1-\lambda)u' + (a-\lambda)u''x_I^J = 0\,. \tag{5.8}$$

We have two cases.

- If $u' = 0$ then $u'' \neq 0$ and $\lambda = a$. The eigenfunction is x_I^J.
- If $u' \neq 0$ and there is no term in $u''x_I^J$ that can compesate for this. Therefore $\lambda = 1$ and $u'' = 0$.

□

Corollary 55. *The kernel of a finite marking operator Γ is generated by the monomials marked with label 0.*

The proofs can be extended for finite marking operators. It's not entirely clear how we may prove a similar result for operators marking infinitely many monomials.

5.1.2 Marking operators with multiplication

We'll call an operator inhomogeneous if it consists of a homogeneous operator Γ and a laurent polynomial (possibly infinite) S and and acts in one of the following ways

$$\Gamma S(u) = \Gamma(Su) \quad \text{or} \quad S\Gamma u = S \cdot \Gamma u \,. \tag{5.9}$$

This kind of operator is important because it can be found in the functional equations for random walk models. We seek to find the eigenpairs for inhomogeneous operators. We first show that the two definitions are equivalent when it comes to finding eigenpairs.

Proposition 56. *The two operators have the same eigenvalues with eigenfunctions differing by a multiple of S. That is (λ, u) is an eigenpair for ΓS if and only of (λ, Su) is an eigenpair for $S\Gamma$. In particular, if $\lambda = 0$ we have*

$$\ker(\Gamma S) = \overline{S} \ker(\Gamma) \,. \tag{5.10}$$

Proof. Note that

$$\Gamma S u = \lambda u \quad \iff \quad S\Gamma(Su) = \lambda(Su) \,. \tag{5.11}$$

Therefore the operators have the same eigenvalues and they have the eigenfunctions u and Su respectively. Now if we pick $\lambda = 0$ to find the kernels of the operators we find that $u \in \ker(\Gamma S)$ if and only if $Su \in \ker(S\Gamma) = \ker(\Gamma)$ which completes the proof. □

It is a rather difficult task to find the eigenpairs for such operators as the next example shows

Example 57. Let Γ and an eigenfunction u of ΓS where

$$S = x \,, \quad u = \sum_k u_k x^k \,. \tag{5.12}$$

Computing $(\Gamma S - \lambda I)u$ leads to the system of equations

$$\lambda u_n = a u_{n-1} \,, \tag{5.13}$$

$$\lambda u_k = u_{k-1}, \quad \text{if } k \neq n \,. \tag{5.14}$$

We have a doubly-infinite recursion so we can pick an arbitrary initial condition. If $u_n = 0$ the rest of the terms will be zero as well so we must have $u_n \neq 0$. Set $u_n = 1$. Then via induction we can

find

$$u_{n+k} = 1/\lambda^k, \quad \text{for } k \geqslant 0\,, \tag{5.15}$$

$$u_{n-k} = \lambda^k/a^k, \quad \text{for } k \geqslant 1\,, \tag{5.16}$$

and this shows that we have an eigenfunction for each $\lambda \neq 0$. Computing $u(x)$ formally leads to

$$u(x) = -\frac{\lambda b x^{n+1}}{(\lambda - x)(\lambda - ax)}\,. \tag{5.17}$$

The situation becomes more complicated for more complicated functions S.

5.1.3 Random Walks Operator

In this section we explore the operator $\mathcal{L} = 1 - t\Gamma S$ for a step Laurent polynomial S and some random walk operator Γ. Let (u, λ) be an eigenpair for $\mathcal{L}$. Then we calculate

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathcal{L} - \lambda I)u &= u - \lambda u - t\Gamma S u \\ t\Gamma S u &= (1-\lambda)u = \mu u\,. \end{aligned} \tag{5.18}$$

If $\lambda = 1$ we would have to compute the kernel of ΓS which we did in the previous section - the eigenfunctions of $\mathcal{L}$ for eigenvalue $\lambda = 1$ are the functions $u \in \overline{S}\ker\Gamma$. Let u be given by a finite order Laurent series

$$u = u_n t^n + u_{n+1} t^{n+1} + \dots \tag{5.19}$$

where $u_n \neq 0$. Then we can re-write the functional equation as

$$t^{-n}(1 - t\Gamma S)u = \lambda t^{-n} u\,. \tag{5.20}$$

Letting $t \to 0$ in this equation yields

$$(\lambda - 1)u_n = -\lim_{t\to 0} t^{1-n}\Gamma S u = -\Gamma S \lim_{t\to 0}(t^{1-n}u) = 0\,. \tag{5.21}$$

Since $u_n \neq 0$ this implies that $\lambda = 1$ and again we see that $u \in \overline{S}\ker\Gamma$. Since S is a Laurent polynomial, the resulting functions will indeed be finite order Laurent series. This analysis shows that the only eigenfunctions of $\mathcal{L}$ among finite order Laurent series in t are those that are members of $\overline{S}\ker\Gamma$ with eigenvalue $\lambda = 1$.

Example 58. Let $\Gamma = LE$ in the one-dimensional problem with small steps on the nonnegative line with nontrivial operator E. Then $\ker \Gamma = \ker E$ consists of functions $\alpha(t)\overline{x}$ and the eigenfunctions of $\mathcal{L}$ are $\alpha(t)\overline{x}\,\overline{S}$ for various $\alpha(t)$. In our case we only take finite order Laurent series of $\alpha(t)$. Note that

$$Q = \frac{t(\overline{x} - \overline{\sigma})}{(1 - tS)(b - a\overline{\sigma}t)} = \frac{1}{xS}\frac{\sigma - x}{b\sigma - at}\frac{tS}{1 - tS} \tag{5.22}$$

where we may write

$$\frac{\sigma - x}{b\sigma - at} = \alpha(t) + \beta(t)x \tag{5.23}$$

where $\alpha(t)$ and $\beta(t)$ are algebraic functions of t and a since $\sigma = \sigma(t)$. This at least suggests the possibility of connecting the eigenfunctions of $\mathcal{L}$ to the solution Q

If we are to have a theory similar to Sturm-Liouville theory we still need to find a suitable inner product on multivariate Laurent series that will allow us to write solutions for Q in terms of those eigenfunctions with eigenvalue 1.

Chapter 6

Algebraic Kernel method

In this chapter we'll explore the algebraic kernel method as seen in [18] with extensions to interacting random walk models.

6.1 Groups for walks with small steps

Suppose that the random walk model has a step Laurent polynomial S in the variables $x_1, \ldots, x_d$. We are interested in the bi-rational transformations that leave the kernel $K = 1 - tS$ intact in much the same way as it is done in [8] but with a slightly different notaion. For some $x = x_k$ we have bi-rational transformations sending $g : x \mapsto y$ that preserse K. That is $K(y) = K(x)$. Expanding the definition we have

$$\begin{aligned} 1 - tS(y) &= 1 - tS(x) \\ S(y) &= S(x) \\ S_{\text{-}1}\overline{x} + S_1 x &= S_{\text{-}1}\overline{y} + S_1 y\,. \end{aligned} \tag{6.1}$$

Because of this equation it's equally valid to speak of the birational transformations preserving S. Collecting terms and simplifying yields

$$(S_{\text{-}1} - S_1 xy)(x - y) = 0\,. \tag{6.2}$$

There are cases here. If both $S_{\text{-}1}, S_1$ are zero the equation is trivially valid and g can be anything. When exactly one is zero then the equation only has the trivial solution $y = x$. When neither is zero we have the two solutions $y = x$ and $y = \overline{x}S_{\text{-}1}/S_1$ in which case we say that the transformation is nontrivial. That is we define $g_k = \overline{x}_k S_k^{-1}/S_k^1$ whenever we have a nontrivial transformation. Note

that

$$g_k^2(x_k) = g_k\left(S_k^{-1} x_k S_k^1\right) = x_k \tag{6.3}$$

so these transformations are involutions. We can define a group G_S of the nontrivial transformations.

Definition 59. *Let $G = G_S$ be the group generated by the nontrivial transformations g_k.*

In the case where the transformation on x is trivial there is something we can say about the random walk model. We use the operator $E = 1 - \overline{x}[\overline{x}]$ to gain information on the generating function Q. Since Q only has non-negative powers of x in its expansion $EQ = Q$. However in the master functional equation we have

$$ESQ = SQ - \overline{x}(S_{\text{-}1}Q_1 + S_0Q_0 + S_1Q_{\text{-}1}) = SQ - \overline{x}(S_{\text{-}1}Q_1 + S_0Q_0)\,. \tag{6.4}$$

We have several cases.

1) If $S_{\text{-}1} = 0$ and $S_1 = 0$, $S = S_0$ and therefore $ESQ = S_0EQ = S_0Q$ so the functional equation doesn't "see" the variable x.

2) If $S_{\text{-}1} = 0$ and $S_1 \neq 0$ then

$$ESQ = SQ - \overline{x}(S_{\text{-}1}Q_0 + S_0Q_{\text{-}1}) = SQ \tag{6.5}$$

since $Q_{\text{-}1} = 0$ so the extraction doesn't see the variable x. This is equivalent to saying that even though we are working in the positive orthant we can relax the constraint for the x to the whole space since there are no steps going back in that direction. The variable x is still present in the functional equation. If we have no steps that stay in the $x = 0$ hyperplane then x essentially acts as a parameter in the problem and we can ignore it. Otherwise we'll have

$$\begin{aligned} LESQ = LSQ &= (1 + b[x^0])SQ \\ &= SQ + b(S_{\text{-}1}Q_1 + S_0Q_0 + S_1Q_{\text{-}1}) \\ &= SQ + bS_0Q_0 \neq SQ\,. \end{aligned} \tag{6.6}$$

3) If $S_{\text{-}1} \neq 0$ but $S_1 = 0$ then ESQ is nontrivial but since we cannot take any steps away from the $x = 0$ hyperplane we can eliminate the $S_{\text{-}1}$ term in the analysis of the problem.

In all the cases the random walk model behaves as if $S_{\text{-}1} = 0$. In the non-interacting version of the problem we can fully ignore the x coordinate in the analysis since it acts like a parameter. The

problem is essentially one of lower dimension. In the interacting case we have a bit extra because of the marking operator. In either case we'll define the dimension of the group to be the number of nontrivial generators.

Definition 60. *Let the* dimension *of the model or the group be the number of nontrivial generators of G_S in the defining representation.*

Without loss of generality we will speak of models set in d dimensions that have a full set of generators. Firstly, we can easily show that there are infinitely many different group sizes that are manifested among the different dimensions. Let S be a $(d-1)$-dimensional model with group G of largest finite order (number of elements) for that dimension. Set this model in d dimensions and define a new model $S' = S(x_d + \overline{x}_d)$. This model has a nontrivial generator g_d that S lacks. Therefore the group G' of this new model satisfies

$$G' \cong G \times \langle g_d \rangle \tag{6.7}$$

and $|G'| = 2|G|$ and continuing in this manner allows us to write an infinite sequence of distinct groups. That is, not only are there infinitely many distinct groups but also, there is a group in d dimensions not encountered before in $(d-1)$ dimensions (neither in order nor structure). For example the orders of the finite groups set in 2 dimensions are 1, 2, 4, 6 and 8 (Theorem 3 of [8] along with the simple observation that we also have groups of order 1 and 2). If we were to consider walks with multiple copies of some steps we may obtain even larger group orders as seen in [11]. So in 3 dimensions we have groups of order 1, 2, 4, 6, 8, 12 and 16 at least. In fact there are even larger groups of orders 24 and 48 at least as can be seen in [18].

This discussion would be short without briefly going into the subject of Coxeter groups. The d-dimensional groups defined above are Coxeter groups - a generalization of the dihedral groups encountered in dimension 2 random walk models. Coxeter groups are defined as

$$G = \langle r_1, \ldots, r_d | (r_i r_j)^{m_{i,j}} = 1 \rangle \tag{6.8}$$

where $m_{i,i} = 1$ and $m_{i,j} \geqslant 2$ for all $i \neq j$, and $m_{i,j}$ could also be infinite. We can call these r's reflections. When $m_{i,j} = 2$ the reflections commute. Also $m_{i,j} = m_{j,i}$. The *rank* of G is the number of generators of in this specific representation of G. Often G will have more than one representation with different numbers of generators. So in our discussion of groups for random walks with small steps the rank of G is the dimension of the model. We can draw a graph for each Coxeter group by the following procedure.

- Label vertices with the generators of G.

- Connect the vertices g_i and g_j if $m_{i,j} \geqslant 3$.
- Label the edge with $m_{i,j}$ if $m_{i,j} \geqslant 4$.

If the graph has different components, the Coxeter group factors as a direct product of Coxeter groups represented by the individual components. We can see this in terms of the step polynomial S. Suppose that S factors as

$$S = T(x_1, \ldots, x_k)R(x_{k+1}, \ldots, x_d)\,. \tag{6.9}$$

For a fixed $1 \leqslant i \leqslant k$ we have

$$S_i^j = [x_i^j]S = R[x_i^j]T = RT_i^j \tag{6.10}$$

and therefore

$$g_i(x_i) = \overline{x}_i \frac{T_i^{-1}R}{T_i^1 R} = \overline{x}_i \frac{T_i^{-1}}{T_i^1}\,. \tag{6.11}$$

Similarly if $k+1 \leqslant j \leqslant d$ then

$$g_j(x_j) = \overline{x}_j \frac{R_i^{-1}}{R_i^1}\,. \tag{6.12}$$

Clearly

$$g_i g_j = g_j g_i \tag{6.13}$$

since they don't interfere with each other. Since i and j were arbitrary, this means that the generators from different sets commute and the Coxeter graph of the group factors into two pieces. We can write

$$G_S = G_T \times G_R\,. \tag{6.14}$$

where the subscripts highlight which parts of S they groups are generated by. This factoring also allows us to write the generating function Q as a Hadamard product of lower-dimensional generating functions. We can call each component of the graph a prime model. We can say that a simple small component is one whose group doesn't split nontrivially (its graph has one component).

6.2 Noninteracting Models

6.2.1 Walks with small steps

At the core of the Algebraic Kernel method we have the idea that we can apply group actions from G onto the master functional equation and obtain nontrivially different equations for each $g \in G$. After we sum these equations in a nice way we manage to eliminate the functions Q_1^0, Q_2^0 and $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$ and their orbits leaving only the orbit of the kernel term KQ and a term on the right-hand side. What makes this possible is pre-multiplying the whole equation by $x_1 \dots x_2$. This also works in higher dimensions as we'll show later. Although the generalization has been done before (for example page 11 of [8] for the two dimensional case and page 10 of [18] for the three dimensional one) we will present it in a compact and easy to generalize way. Instead of thinking just in terms of equations and summing them as in [8] we'll encapsulate the process in an operator D_G that will take the functional equation and eliminate the terms we don't want by applying the group actions in a nice way. We start by defining D_G so as to do the same thing as in [8] and [18] in order to formalize the process.

Definition 61. *Let G be a group represented and generated by g_k's preserving the kernel K for a model for small steps. Then let D_G be the operator defined as*

$$D_G = \sum_{g \in G} (-1)^{|g|} g \tag{6.15}$$

in the sense of group actions. Here $|g|$ is the sign of the group element g.

In two dimensions we can obtain the whole group by iterating over the two generators 1, g_i, $g_j g_i$, $g_i g_j g_i$. It's cleaner to write g_{iji} instead of $g_i g_j g_i$ so we have the following notation

Definition 62. *For a sequence $L = (l_1, l_2 \dots)$ of positive integers define*

$$g_L = g_{l_1 l_2 \dots} = g_{l_1} g_{l_2} \cdots \tag{6.16}$$

whenever this makes sense - when the list is finite or when there is a convergence in the case of an infinite list.

In the case of a finite group in two dimensions we have $(g_1 g_2)^n = 1$ for some minimal n. This allows us to re-write D_G in a useful way. The following lemma is just a restatement of the orbit sum method on page 11 of [8], but in operator notation.

Lemma 63. *For a two-dimensional random walk model with small steps possessing a finite group*

of order $2n$ and generators g_1, g_2 we can write the operator D_G as

$$D_G = (1 + g_{ij} + \cdots + (g_{ij})^{n-1})(1 - g_i)\,. \tag{6.17}$$

Proof. We can just check the identity by expanding it as

$$\begin{aligned} D_G &= (1 + g_{ij} + \cdots + (g_{ij})^{n-1})(1 - g_i) \\ &= 1 - g_i + g_{ij} - g_{iji} + \cdots - (g_{ij})^{n-1} g_i \end{aligned} \tag{6.18}$$

giving us one of the possible orbits □

Here are some examples of small groups.

Example 64. When $|G| = 4$ the elements commute so the orbit is $1, g_1, g_{12} = g_{21}, g_2$ and the operator is

$$D_G = 1 - g_1 - g_2 + g_{12} = (1 - g_1)(1 - g_2)\,. \tag{6.19}$$

When $|G| = 6$ the orbit is $1, g_1, g_{21}, g_{121} = g_{212}, g_{12}, g_2$. We can write the operator as

$$\begin{aligned} D_G &= (1 + g_{12} + g_{1212})(1 - g_1) \\ &= 1 + g_{12} + g_{1212} - g_1 - g_{121} - g_{12121} \\ &= 1 - g_1 - g_2 + g_{12} + g_{21} - g_{121}\,. \end{aligned} \tag{6.20}$$

We can generalize the lemma for a multi-dimensional group G.

Lemma 65. *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a model with small steps in $\mathbb{Z}^d$ and let G be its asociated group. For a nontrivial generator g_k we can write the operator as $D_G = D_H(1 - g_k)$ for a subgroup H of G.*

Proof. Simpler proof: each element in the fixed representation of G either ends in g_k or doesn't. We have a bijection between the two sets by using the involution g_k applied on the right. The elements ending in g_k have opposite parity to those not ending on g_k so we can split G into two parts H and Hg_k. We can split the defining sum into two parts and keep track of the sign changes

via $e_g = (-1)^{|g|}$. We have

$$\begin{aligned} D_G &= \sum_{g\in H} e_g g + \sum_{g\in Hg_k} e_g g \\ &= \sum_{g\in H} e_g g + \sum_{g\in H} (-1) e_g g g_k \\ &= \left(\sum_{g\in H} e_g g\right)(1-g_k) \\ &= D_H(1-g_k)\,. \end{aligned} \tag{6.21}$$

I'll have to provide a different proof maybe. Take $H = G/\langle g_k\rangle$. Since g_k is of order 2 the resulting group has $|G|/2$ elements. Consider the elements of G that commute with g_k, that is $h \in G$ where $g_k h = h g_k$. Multiplying by $g_k^{-1} = g_k$ we see that $h = g_k h g_k$. Let H be the subgroup of G generated by those elements. There are two cosets H and Hg_k. □

Lemma 66. *The operator D_G eliminates the term $tS_I^{-\mathbb{I}}Q_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ for $I \neq \varnothing$.*

Proof. By the previous lemma, for some $i \in I$, $D_G(tS_I^{-\mathbb{I}}Q_I^{\mathbb{O}}) = D_H((1-g_i)tS_I^{-\mathbb{I}}Q_I^{\mathbb{O}})) = D_H(0) = 0$ since the variable x_i is not present in the function. □

We obtain the d-dimensional generalization to Proposition 5 in [8].

Theorem 67. *For a model with small steps we have*

$$D_G(x_1\cdots x_d KQ) = D_G(x_1\cdots x_d) \tag{6.22}$$

where the RHS may be zero sometimes.

Proof. When we multiply the master functional equation by $x_1\cdots x_d$ we obtain a lot of terms like the ones in the lemma. The only term that survives the application of D_G on the LHS is $x_1\cdots x_d KQ$ and the equality follows. □

This is a generalization of the orbit summation obtained in [15]. The authors in [8] and [18] have found that sometimes the algebraic kernel method fails. That is, $D_G(x_1\cdots x_d) = 0$ and the equation doesn't give us any new information. We can generalize this as follows.

Corollary 68. *Suppose that there is a group element $h \in G$ with odd parity that permutes the variables $x_1,\ldots,x_d$ in some way and has order 2. Then the regular Algebraic Kernel method fails.*

That is

$$D_G(x_1 \cdots x_d KQ) = 0\,. \tag{6.23}$$

Proof. Since h is an involution the same method applies as before and we can factor $D_G = D_H(1-h)$ for some $H \subseteq G$. The action $1-h$ eliminates the monomial $x_1 \cdots x_d$. □

Example 69. The two dimensional models for which the algebraic kernel method fails are precisely those where we have a permutation as in the corollary. That is $h(x_1, x_2) = h(x_2, x_1)$ and the order of h is three. Proposition 6 in [8] follows.

Example 70. In three dimensions and models with at most 6 steps we see that the algebraic kernel method fails in 62 three-dimensional models (page 13 of [18]). For example, there is a model with group size 12 for which the algebraic kernel method fails. For that model one of the group element is a permutation of two of the variables - in that case x_2 and x_3. Strangely enough G contain the group seen in the previous example for the variables x_2 and x_3. This means that every higher-dimensional model that has group G containing the group above will fail in the regular Algebraic Kernel method.

A natural question is to consider taking D_H instead of $D_G = D_H(1-h)$ and checking if we can perfom a half-orbit summation in general. The answer is yes. The operatro D_H eliminates some of the Q variables and introduces others but the result is a function symmetric under permutation by h. One may hope to perform a method analogous to the half-orbit summation method to prove algebraicity or D-finiteness.

Example 71. There is another way we can prove that D_G does what it advertises. We start with the kernel form $EKQ = 1$ where we make the substitution $Q = W/(x_1 \cdots x_d K)$ and re-write the equation as

$$E'W = x_1 \cdots x_d, \qquad E'_k = 1 - [x_k^0]\,. \tag{6.24}$$

Therefore

$$W = x_1 \cdots x_d - (1-E')W = x_1 \cdots x_d - \sum_{\varnothing \neq I \subseteq [d]} W_I^{\mathbb{O}}\,. \tag{6.25}$$

We immediately see that

$$D_G(x_1 \cdots x_d KQ) = D_G(W) = D_G\left(x_1 \cdots x_d - \sum_{\varnothing \neq I \subseteq [d]} W_I^{\mathbb{O}}\right) = D_G(x_1 \cdots x_d) \tag{6.26}$$

since the $W_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ terms have missing variables. Let's think about this for a moment. The form of W is the same for all random walk models with small steps so if there are two models whose operators both annihilate expressions of the form $W_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ for all non-empty $I \subseteq [d]$ then both models have equations of the above type with each other's operators! In particular we may take the group G of the highly-symmetric models and apply it via the operator D_G for any other model and we obtain an equation of the above type! We'll look into this further.

Definition 72. *Let $g_k(x_k) = \overline{x}_k$. Define the operator $\Delta_k = 1 - g_k$ for this specific g_k. Let $\Delta = \Delta_1 \cdots \Delta_d$.*

Theorem 73. *Let G be the group generated by $g_k(x_k) = \overline{x}_k$ for $1 \leqslant k \leqslant d$. Let $\Delta_k = 1 - g_k$. Then we have $D_G = \Delta$ and*

$$\Delta(x_1 \cdots x_d KQ) = \Delta(x_1 \cdots x_d) = (x_1 - \overline{x}_1) \cdots (x_d - \overline{x}_d) \tag{6.27}$$

for any small step random walk model in dimension d with no interactions.

Proof. It's enough to see that Δ annihilates any term of the form $W_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ for $I \neq \varnothing$. Since the operatos Δ_k commute we only need to apply one Δ_i for some i first and find

$$\Delta_i(W_I^{\mathbb{O}}) = W_I^{\mathbb{O}} - g_i(W_I^{\mathbb{O}}) = 0 \tag{6.28}$$

since the term is missing variable x_i. The rest follows by linearity. □

This won't help show a specific model has a D-finite solution because in general we cannot factor out the K term from the LHS. However the idea is important and it allws us to write the following.

Corollary 74. *All random walk models of dimension d satisfy the functional equation*

$$E'(x_1 \cdots x_d KQ) = x_1 \cdots x_d \,. \tag{6.29}$$

Therefore the only difference between the models is in the initial conditions that go with this functional equation.

We'll extend these ideas in the next section but first we'll look into generalizing the ideas involved in the algebraic kernel method.

Definition 75. *Let G be a group acting on $x_1, \ldots, x_d$. Then we define a weighted orbit summation operator to be any operator of the form*

$$D = \sum_{g \in G} R_g g \tag{6.30}$$

where R_g are functions in the variables $x_1, \ldots, x_d$.

The orbit summation operator is an example of this with $R'_g = 1$ for the groups considered so far. A first view of this kind of operator can be seen on page 11 of [**?**] where the authors use an orbit summation with weights. We can capture various strategies in this notation

Example 76. Since the Algebraic Kernel method fails to give a nice result when G contains permutations we may try to apply the operator D_G on a slightly different equation - one where we multiply the whole equation by a function $T \neq x_1 \cdots x_d$. For a function f we have

$$D_G(Tf) = \sum_{g \in G} g(Tf) = \sum_{g \in G} (g(T))g(f) = \sum_{g \in G} R_g g(f)\,. \tag{6.31}$$

The situation of applying D_G on T times the functional equation is the same as applying a weighted orbit summation operator on the original functional equation with weights $g(T)$ for $g \in G$.

We may also consider the strategy of applying a weighted operator several times in the hopes of obtaining an easier equation to work with. However as we shall see this is no different than looking at a weighted operator in the first place. This is because G is a group and the composition D_G^2 leads to another weighted operator. Also, since some of the operators D_G have nontrivial kernels they are not invertible, so the set of operators is not a group. Howeve we can show that the set is a monoid under composition.

Proposition 77. *For a group G, the set of weighted orbit summation operators form a monoid under composition.*

Proof. Since G is a group we have an identity element 1 which can also be considered as a weighted orbit summation operator with $R_g = 0$ for all $g \neq 1$ and $R_1 = 1$. Thus the set of operator has an

identity element. Since composition of operators is associative just need to check that the set of operators is closed under composition. We have

$$D_1 D_2 = \sum_{g\in G}\sum_{h\in H} R_g g T_h h = \sum_{g\in G}\sum_{h\in H} R_g T_{gh} gh \sum_{g\in G}(\sum_{h\in H} R_{gh_{-1}} T_g) g \tag{6.32}$$

which is also an operator of this form once we collect terms corresponding to the same group elements. □

We hope to apply a weighted operator D to a problem in order to gain more insight into the structure of the generating function Q. Since all models with small steps and finite groups also have a regular orbit summation operator we have two main interesting cases to investigate.

(1) When is $D_G(x_1 \cdots x_d) = 0$ and can we find weights so that a new operator D that acts like D_G but spares $x_1 \cdots x_d$?

(2) Can we create a useful orbit summation operator when G is infinite?

We can answer the first question in the negative when it comes to un-marked random walk models. In general there is no other weighted orbital operator except the one with weights $R_g = 1$ that doesn't also eliminate $x_1 \cdots x_d$. The second case remain unclear.

Here is the strategy we'll employ. If we apply the operator D on the master functional equation we need to eliminate all terms except KQ. That is D needs to annihilate all the Q terms that are missing variables. It is enough to work on the fundamental functional equation for $W = x_1 \cdots x_d KQ$. To go back to the master functional equation case we recognize that $x_1 \cdots x_d$ just make it a weighted operator and we can remove the weight by pre-dividing by $x_1 \cdots x_d$. The resulting operator is also weighted.

Lemma 78. *A weighted operator D exists such that $D(KQ) = D(1)$ if and only if a weighted operator D' exists such that $D'(f_I^{\mathbb{O}})$ for generic functions $f_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ that are missing the variables indexed by I, for all I.*

Proof. The discussion above provides the direction from left to right for $f = W$. To prove it for generic functions f it suffices to note that $f_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ and $f_J^{\mathbb{O}}$ are independent from each other if $I \neq J$. That is, $D(f_I^{\mathbb{O}})$ and $D(f_J^{\mathbb{O}})$ do not share terms. The converse direction is proved by setting $f = W$ and setting $D = D'\overline{x}_1 \cdots \overline{x}_d$ where $(D'\overline{x}_1 \cdots \overline{x}_d)(f) = D'(\overline{x}_1 \cdots \overline{x}_d f)$. □

This essentially turns this into a linear algebra problem. We just need to apply D on generic functions $W_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ that are missing the variables indexed by I, collect the different results and make

their coefficients zero. That is, for every $f = W_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ we look at the orbit

$$\mathrm{Orbit}_G(f) = \{g(f) | g \in G\} \tag{6.33}$$

and collect coefficients in

$$0 = D(f) = \sum_{g \in G} R_g g(f) = \sum_{f' \in Orbit(f)} R'_g f' \tag{6.34}$$

where we set

$$R'_g = \sum_{\substack{g(f)=f' \\ g \in G}} R_g = 0\,. \tag{6.35}$$

Thus we obtain a linear system of $|\mathrm{Orbit}_G(f)|$ equations in $|G|$ unknowns. Of course we can do this for all $2^d - 1$ terms $f = W_I^{\mathbb{O}}$ and hopefully obtain a system with a nontrivial solution. Here is a simple example

Example 79. In $d = 2$ dimensions we have the generic functions $W(0,0) = const$, $W(0,x_2)$, $W(x_1,0)$ where at least one variable is missing. We can write them as $1, f(x_1), f(x_2)$. Now we consider the group generated by $g_k(x_k) = \overline{x}_k$

$$G = \{1, g_1, g_2, g_{12} = g_{21}\}\,. \tag{6.36}$$

We'll write the operator D as

$$D = R - R_1 g_1 - R_2 g_2 + R_{12} g_{12}\,. \tag{6.37}$$

Consider the different orbits. The one with the constant is trivial since the function doesn't change under the group action. Next we have

$$\mathrm{Orbit}_G(f(x_1)) = \{f(x_1), f(\overline{x}_1), f(\overline{x}_1), f(\overline{x}_1)\} = \{f(x_1), f(\overline{x}_1)\} \tag{6.38}$$

and similarly

$$\mathrm{Orbit}_G(f(x_2)) = \{f(x_2), f(\overline{x}_2)\}\,. \tag{6.39}$$

This means we have the equations

$$R - R_1 + R_2 - R_{12} = 0\,, \tag{6.40}$$

$$R = R_2, \quad R_1 = R_{12}\,, \tag{6.41}$$

$$R = R_1, \quad R_2 = R_{12}\,. \tag{6.42}$$

Folowing the implications provided from these operators we find $R = R_1 = R_2 = R_{12}$. The simplest choice is to set $R = 1$ and we find that every weighted orbit summation operator for this group G must be trivially-weighted if it were to annihilate generic functions with missing variables.

Definition 80. *If all the weights are the same we call a weighted operator trivial. We can also call trivial operators unweighted or regular.*

Lemma 81. *Let G be a finite group with d generators for a random walk model in d dimensions with small steps and no interactions. Then any orbital operator is trivial.*

We need to check this proof.

Proof. It is enough to show that $D(W_k^0) = 0$ for all k implies that the operator is trivial. To this end suppose that $D(f) = 0$ where $f = W_k^0$. Then we can partition the group G as before into sets H and Hg_k. We see that $hg_k(f) = h(f)$ so the orbit of f contains at most $|G|/2$ elements. However these elements must all be distinct otherwise they would come from the same operations but the group elements in H are all distinct. So $|\mathrm{Orbit}(f) = |G|/2$. This means that we have the equations $R_h = R_{hg_k}$ for every $h \in H$. Once we go through every k we have overlaps $R = R_1 = \cdots = R_d$ and $R_1 = R_{12} = R_{13}$ etc. This means that all the R's are the same and the operator is trivial. □

This shows that in general there is no clever weighted summation operator that also satisfies the condition $D(x_1 \cdots x_d) \neq 0$. However, the idea will be fruitful in that we may find nontrivial partial solution in the interacting case.

6.2.2 Walks with unconstrained steps

We may go through the process again but this time we take

$$Q = \frac{W}{x_{[d]}^N K} \tag{6.43}$$

where N_k is the maximum negative size of steps in the set $\mathcal{S}$ in the direction x_k or in other words the maximum N_k for which $S_k^{N_k}$ is non-zero. Then the operators that keep the walks in the quarter

plane are

$$E_k = 1 - \sum_{i=1}^{N_k} \overline{x}_k^i [\overline{x}_k^i] \,. \tag{6.44}$$

Their conjugates are

$$E_k' = x_k^{N_k} E_k \overline{x}_k^{N_k} = 1 - \sum_{i=0}^{N_k - 1} x_k^i [x_k^i] = 1 - \mathcal{E}_k \tag{6.45}$$

and so in the kernel equation we obtain

$$x_{[d]}^N = x_{[d]}^N E \overline{x}_{[d]}^N W = E'W = W + \sum_{\varnothing \neq I \subseteq [d]} (-1)^{|I|} \mathcal{E}_I(W) \,. \tag{6.46}$$

Here we have various powers x_k^i along with terms with $x_k = 0$ for $k \in I$. So if we seek an operator D that does the same job as the orbit summation operator we need D to annihilate all the terms with x_k's missing in W on the RHS. So then we'll have

$$D(x_{[d]} KQ) = D(W) = D\left(x_{[d]}^N - \sum_{\varnothing \neq I \subseteq [d]} (-1)^{|I|} \mathcal{E}_k(W) \right) = D(x_{[d]}^N) \,. \tag{6.47}$$

In other words we want D to behave (in some sense) similarly to the derivative

$$\partial_{[d]}^N = \partial_1^{N_1} \cdots \partial_d^{N_d} \,. \tag{6.48}$$

This suggests some definitions.

Definition 82. *For a sequence $N = (N_1, \ldots, N_d)$ of positive integers we say that a model $\mathcal{M}$ is of type N that the longest step in $\mathcal{S}$ in the negative k-th direction has length N_k in that coordinate. In particular we may say that a model is of type n if $N_k = n$ for all k.*

For example, full random walks with small steps are of type 1.

Definition 83. *For sequences $N = (N_1, \ldots, N_d)$ and $M = (M_1, \ldots, M_d)$ of positive integers we say that a model $\mathcal{M}$ is of type (N, M) if it's of type N and the longest step in $\mathcal{S}$ in the positive k-th direction has length N_k in that coordinate. In particular we may say that a model is of type (n, m) is of type n and $M_k = m$ for all k.*

For example, full random walks with small steps are of type $1, 1$. The notation is still a little awful. Anyway, it allows us to write things in the following form

Theorem 84. *A random walk model of type N satisfies the functional equation*

$$E'W = x_{[d]}^N \tag{6.49}$$

where $E' = x_{[d]}^N E\overline{x}_{[d]}^N$ and $W = x_{[d]}^N KQ$.

Corollary 85. *For a random walk model of type N the generating function Q for the non-interacting case satisfies the PDE*

$$\partial_{[d]}^N \left(x_{[d]}^N KQ \right) = 1 \tag{6.50}$$

and is therefore D-finite in the x variables.

Here $\partial_{[d]}^N$ is an example of operator D that kills off all the unnecessary terms and doesn't kill off $x_1 \cdots x_d$. It's possible to discuss weighted operators in this setting too but the situation becomes more complicated. However we may investigate type (N, M) problems by finding a suitable model whose orbital operator is nice enough. This will show that all type (N, M) satisfy an orbital equation with that particular operator, not just a PDE.

Example 86. Consider the random walk model of type (N, N) with $S = \sum_{k=1}^d \overline{x}_k^{n_k} + x_k^{n_k}$. Its group G will is generated by the elements of groups G_k with $2n_k$ elements each - each of the elements $g_{k,j,l} = \omega_{n_k}^j x_k^l$ where $\omega_{n_k} = \exp(2\pi i/n_k)$ and $l \in \{-1, 1\}$. These elements commute and allow us to find an orbital operator that annihilates all terms on the LHS except $x_{[d]}^N KQ$ and also spares the $x_{[d]}^N$ term on the RHS.

6.3 Interacting Models

It is natural to consider extending the algebraic kernel method to one working for interacting models but we quickly see that the regular orbit summation operator is not sufficient. This is where the power of the weighted orbital summation operators starts to show. The analysis for two-dimensional models is particularly nice because we end up having the same number of equations as unknowns and we are able to find the required weights. The linear systems can be written as matrix equations where the determinant of the matrix tells us when we have a useful orbit summation operator. In the end the method doesn't extend fully because we do not eliminate the $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$ term. The D-finiteness of the full generating function Q depends on the D-finiteness of the function $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$. Also we hope to say something about the initial goal of establishing relationship between the full and partial interactions for a given model. We'll only consider the interesting finite cases with 2 nontrivial generators. The

group G has order 4, 6 or 8 and the functional equation in two dimensions is

$$KQ - K_1 Q_1^0 - K_2 Q_2^0 + K_{1,2} Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = \alpha \,. \tag{6.51}$$

6.3.1 Groups of order 4

From a previous section we found that

$$D_G = 1 - g_1 - g_2 + g_1 g_2 = (1 - g_1)(1 - g_2) = \Delta_1 \Delta_2 \tag{6.52}$$

where we defined $\Delta_i = 1 - g_i$. In the non-interacting orbit summation method we had a direct application of D_G on the equations to perform the required cancellations. Here we will attempt to do something similar for the interacting case. Since the cancellations don't happen automatically if we use D_G directly, we'll instead obtain a linear system of equations by applying the group operations on the original functional equation. Then we'll use linear algebra to find a solution where our variables will be the ones we wish to eliminate Q_i^0 and their images under the group actions. If the associated matrix has non-zero determinant we have a unique solution and unfortunately we won't be able to eliminate variables. However there are some cases where the determinant will be zero. Because of symmetry we expect to be able eliminate the desired variables. The group operations commute so we have

$$g_i Q_i^0 = Q_i^0, \quad g_i g_j Q_i^0 = g_j Q_i^0 \tag{6.53}$$

and therefore we have the variables that we wish to eliminate

$$E = \{Q_1^0, Q_2^0, g_2 Q_1^0, g_1 Q_2^0\} \,. \tag{6.54}$$

This is looking promising since we have four equations and four unknowns that we wish to eliminate. We re-write the original equation in a format centered on these variables

$$K_1 Q_1^0 + K_2 Q_2^0 = KQ + K_{1,2} Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha = \beta \,. \tag{6.55}$$

For brevity let $g_{12} = g_1 g_2$

Group action	Effect on Q_1^0	Effect on Q_2^0
1	Q_1^0	Q_2^0
g_1	Q_1^0	$g_1 Q_2^0$
g_2	$g_2 Q_1^0$	Q_2^0
$g_{12} = g_{21}$	$g_2 Q_1^0$	$g_1 Q_2^0$

Table 6.1: Effects of group actions $g \in G$ on Q_1^0 and Q_2^0.

Therefore we have the equations

$$K_1 Q_1^0 + K_2 Q_2^0 = \beta\,, \tag{6.56}$$

$$g_1 K_1 Q_1^0 + g_1 K_2 g_1 Q_2^0 = g_1 \beta = \beta_1\,, \tag{6.57}$$

$$g_2 K_1 g_2 Q_2^0 + g_2 K_2 Q_2^0 = g_2 \beta = \beta_2\,, \tag{6.58}$$

$$g_{12} K_1 g_2 Q_1^0 + g_{12} K_2 g_1 Q_2^0 = g_{12} \beta = \beta_{12}\,. \tag{6.59}$$

Using the order of variables in E we can write the associated matrix M of this linear system as

$$M_4 = \begin{bmatrix} K_1 & K_2 & 0 & 0 \\ g_1 K_1 & 0 & 0 & g_1 K_2 \\ 0 & g_2 K_2 & g_2 K_1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & g_{12} K_1 & g_{12} K_2 \end{bmatrix} \tag{6.60}$$

Its determinant is

$$\begin{aligned} \det M_4 &= K_1 g_{12} K_1 g_1 K_2 g_2 K_2 - g_1 K_1 g_2 K_1 K_2 g_{12} K_2 \\ &= K_1 g_{12} K_1 g_1 K_2 g_2 K_2 - g_1 (g_1 K_1 g_{12} K_1 g_1 K_2 g_2 K_2) \\ &= \Delta_1 (K_1 g_{12} K_1 g_1 K_2 g_2 K_2) \\ &= \Delta_2 (g_1 K_1 g_2 K_1 K_2 g_{12} K_2) \end{aligned} \tag{6.61}$$

where the last equation comes from doing the process in the same way but with g_2 instead.

When is $\det M_4 = 0$**?**

Now our task is to find where this determinant is zero. Clearly the expression within each Δ must be in the kernel of the operator. To that end let's find when that happens. For a Laurent polynomial

f in the variables x_i and t we have

$$\Delta_k f = \sum_n f_n(1-g_k)x_k^n = \sum_n (f_n - f_{-n}\mu_k^{-n})x_i^n \tag{6.62}$$

where $\mu_k = S_k^{-1}/S_k^1$. This implies that

$$f_n = f_{-n}\mu_k^{-n} \tag{6.63}$$

$$f_n(S_k^1)^n = f_{-n}(S_k^{-1})^n \tag{6.64}$$

for all $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. It's not clear if this will help us. However the models that exhibit groups of order 4 have at least one symmetry across a line - either vertical or horizontal symmetry. WLOG let the model have vertical symmetry. That is

$$g_1(x_1) = x_1, \quad g_1(S_2^i) = S_2^i, \quad g_1(S_1^i) = S_1^{-i}\,. \tag{6.65}$$

This allows us to compute some things. For example

$$g_1K_2 = c_2 - t\overline{x}_2 g_1 S_2^{-1} = c_2 - t\overline{x}_2 S_2^{-1} = K_2\,, g_1g_2K_2 = g_2g_1K_2 = g_2\,. \tag{6.66}$$

Therefore Δ_1 fixes both K_2 and g_2K_2. We see that the determinant is

$$\det M_4 = \Delta_1(K_1K_2g_{12}K_1g_2K_2) = K_2g_2K_2\Delta_1(K_1g_{12}K_1)\,. \tag{6.67}$$

This is zero if and only if $\Delta_1(K_1g_{12}K_1) = 0$ so we have

$$\begin{aligned}
0 &= \Delta_1(K_1g_{12}K_1) \\
&= K_1g_{12}K_1 - g_1K_1g_2K_2 \\
&= (c_1 - t\overline{x_1}S_1^{-1})(c_1 - tx_1g_2S_1^{-1}) - (c_1 - tx_1S_1^{-1})(c_1 - t\overline{x_1}g_2S_1^{-1}) \\
&= c_1t\overline{x}_1(g_2S_2^{-1} - S_2^{-1}) - c_1tx_1(g_2S_2^{-1} - S_2^{-1}) \\
&= c_1t(\overline{x}_1 - x_1)(g_2S_1^{-1} - S_1^{-1}) \\
&= -c_1t(\overline{x}_1 - x_1)\Delta_2(S_1^{-1})\,.
\end{aligned} \tag{6.68}$$

This is true if and only if

$$g_2S_1^{-1} = S_1^{-1}\,. \tag{6.69}$$

We have

$$g_2(S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}\overline{x}_2 + S_{1,2}^{-1,0} + S_{1,2}^{-1,1}x_2) = S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}x_2\overline{\mu}_2 + S_{1,2}^{-1,0} + S_{1,2}^{-1,1}\overline{x}_2\mu_2 \tag{6.70}$$

and

$$S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}x_2\overline{\mu}_2 + S_{1,2}^{-1,1}\overline{x}_2\mu_2 = S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}\overline{x}_2 + S_{1,2}^{-1,1}x_2 \tag{6.71}$$

which can be re-written succinctly as

$$S_{1,2}^{-1,-1} = \mu_2 S_{-1,1}\,. \tag{6.72}$$

If one of the S's is zero so is the other and therefore by symmetry the model doesn't have diagonal steps. Since we have two nontrivial generators this implies that both x_2 and $\overline{x}_2$ are present in S, so the model trivially exhibits a symmetry about the x_1 axis. If the S's are non-zero this implies μ_2 is a constant and therefore $S_2^{-1} = S_2^1$. Again the model exhibits symmetry about the x_1 axis.

Theorem 87. $\det M_4 = 0$ *if and only if the model is highly-symmetric.*

Corollary 88. *The algebraic kernel method extends to the non-interacting case for* $|G| = 4$ *if and only if the model is highly-symmetric.*

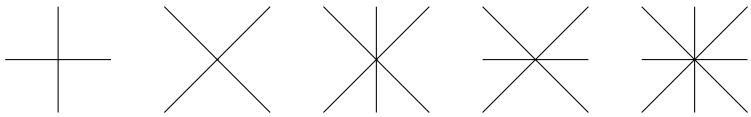


Figure 6.1: The highly symmetric models on the plane

We are now ready to attempt using the orbit summation method in the highly symmetric cases. There are 8 such models but only 5 of them have dimension 2. Furthermore 2 of the models are reflections of each other so we are really left with 4 interesting cases - diagonal walks, full walks, full walks minus two horizontal steps. If we are able to eliminate all the variables then we'll be left with a linear relation

$$\gamma\beta - \gamma_1\beta_1 - \gamma_2\beta_2 + \gamma_{12}\beta_{12} = 0\,. \tag{6.73}$$

Here the choice of signs is inspired by the orbit summation operators. Let $\bullet$ and $*$ stand for applications of g_1 and g_2 respectively. First we have $K_2^\bullet = K_2$ and $K_1^* = K_1$. Then we let

$$x = Q_1^0\,, \quad y = Q_2^0\,, \quad u = Q_1^{0,*}\,, \quad v = Q_2^{0,\bullet} \tag{6.74}$$

and

$$a = K_1\,, \quad b = K_1^\bullet\,, \quad c = K_2\,, \quad d = K_2^* \tag{6.75}$$

The original equations become

$$\beta = ax + cy\,, \quad \beta_1 = bx + cv\,, \tag{6.76}$$

$$\beta_2 = dy + au\,, \quad \beta_{12} = bu + dv\,, \tag{6.77}$$

Therefore the above equation needs to satisfy

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= (ax + cy)\gamma - (bx + cv)\gamma_1 - (dy + au)\gamma_2 + (bu + dv)\gamma_{12} \\ &= (a\gamma - b\gamma_1)x + (c\gamma - d\gamma_2)y + (b\gamma_{12} - a\gamma_2)u + (d\gamma_{12} - c\gamma_1)v \end{aligned} \tag{6.78}$$

and in order to eliminate the variables x, y, u, v we need to make all their coefficients zero. Therefore

$$a\gamma = b\gamma_1\,, \quad c\gamma = d\gamma_2\,, \quad b\gamma_{12} = a\gamma_2,\,, \quad d\gamma_{12} = c\gamma_1\,. \tag{6.79}$$

If we set $\gamma = 1$ then $\gamma_1 = a/b$, $\gamma_2 = c/d$ and $\gamma_{12} = (ac)/(bd)$. So we can multiply out by bd to find the relation

$$bd\beta - ad\beta_1 - cb\beta_2 + ac\beta_{12} = 0 \tag{6.80}$$

where we have successfully eliminated $Q_1^0, Q_2^0, Q_1^{0,*}$, and $Q_2^{0,\bullet}$. Or written in terms of the K's we have

$$K_1^\bullet K_2^* \beta - K_1 K_2^* \beta^\bullet - K_1^\bullet K_2 \beta^* + K_1 K_2 \beta^{\bullet *} = 0\,. \tag{6.81}$$

We can re-write this equation in the following nicer way.

Theorem 89. *For highly-symmetric models with small steps we have the functional equation*

$$\Delta(K_1^\bullet K_2^* \beta) = 0 \tag{6.82}$$

where $\beta = KQ + K_{1,2}Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha$.

This is a generalization of the result in [**?**] in which the authors use a weighted orbit sum to eliminate boundary terms. We can expand the functional equation to obtain a different form. Towards this end let $K_0 = K_1^\bullet K_2^*$. We obtain

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta(K_0\beta) &= \Delta(K_0(KQ + K_{1,2}Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha)) \\ &= \Delta(K_0KQ) + \Delta(K_0K_{1,2}Q_{1,2}^{0,0}) - \Delta(K_0\alpha) \\ &= K\Delta(K_0Q) + \Delta(K_0K_{1,2})Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \Delta(K_0)\alpha\end{aligned} \tag{6.83}$$

where the last line follows since Δ commutes with K and functions with some variables x_i missing. All that remains is to expand the various quantities involved

$$\Delta g_i K_i = -\Delta K_i = -(c_i - tx_iS_i^{-1} - c_i + t\overline{x}_iS_i^{-1}) = -t(\overline{x}_i - x_i)S_i^{-1}\,. \tag{6.84}$$

Therefore

$$\Delta K_0 = \Delta_1(K_1^\bullet)\Delta_2(K_2^*) = t^2(\overline{x}_1 - x_1)(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)S_1^{-1}S_2^{-1}\,. \tag{6.85}$$

Next

$$\Delta(K_0K_{1,2}) = \Delta_1K_1^\bullet\Delta_2K_2^*K_{1,2} = \Delta_1K_1^\bullet(K_2^*K_{1,2} - K_2K_{1,2}^*)\,. \tag{6.86}$$

The quantity in parentheses is

$$\begin{aligned}&K_2^*K_{1,2} - K_2K_{1,2}^* = \\ =&(c_2 - tx_2S_2^{-1})(c_1c_2 - t\overline{x_1x_2}S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}) - (c_2 - t\overline{x_2}S_2^{-1})(c_1c_2 - t\overline{x_1}x_2S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}) \\ =&c_1c_2tS_2^{-1}(\overline{x_2} - x_2) - c_2t\overline{x_2}S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}(\overline{x_2} - x_2) \\ =&c_2t(\overline{x_2} - x_2)(c_1S_2^{-1} - \overline{x_1}S_{1,2}^{-1,-1})\,.\end{aligned} \tag{6.87}$$

and thus

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta(K_0K_{1,2}) &= c_2t(\overline{x_2}-x_2)\Delta_1K_1^\bullet(c_1S_2^{-1}-\overline{x_1}S_{1,2}^{-1,-1})\\ &= c_2t(\overline{x_2}-x_2)\Delta_1K_1^\bullet(c_1S_2^{-1}-\overline{x_1}S_{1,2}^{-1,-1})\,.\end{aligned} \tag{6.88}$$

To simplify this quantity note that

$$\Delta_1K_1^\bullet c_1S_2^{-1} = c_1S_2^{-1}\Delta_1K_1^\bullet = -c_1tS_2^{-1}(\overline{x}_1-x_1) \tag{6.89}$$

and

$$\Delta_1K_1^\bullet\overline{x_1}S_{1,2}^{-1,-1} = S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}\Delta_1K_1^\bullet\overline{x_1} = c_1(\overline{x}_1-x_1)S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}\,. \tag{6.90}$$

Finally

$$\Delta(K_0K_{1,2}) = c_1c_2t(\overline{x}_1-x_1)(\overline{x}_2-x_2)(tS_1^{-1}S_2^{-2}-S_{1,2}^{-1,-1})\,. \tag{6.91}$$

Combining terms and simplifying a bit leads us to

$$K\Delta(K_0Q) = \alpha t(\overline{x}_1-x_1)(\overline{x}_2-x_2)(tS_1^{-1}S_2^{-1}-b_1b_2(tS_1^{-1}S_2^{-1}-S_{1,2}^{-1,-1})Q_{1,2}^{0,0}) \tag{6.92}$$

Corollary 90. *For a highly-symmetric model with $K_0 = K_1^\bullet K_2^*$ we have the functional equation*

$$K\Delta(K_0Q) = \alpha t(\overline{x}_1-x_1)(\overline{x}_2-x_2)(tS_1^{-1}S_2^{-1}(1-b_1b_2Q_{1,2}^{0,0})+S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}Q_{1,2}^{0,0})\,. \tag{6.93}$$

6.3.2 Groups of order 6

Since we have 6 group actions it's worth taking the time to see what kinds of expressions we obtain by applying g on Q_i^0 or K_i for each i. For example $g_iQ_i^0 = Q_i^0$ so we will say the action of g_i is reduced to $g_\varnothing = 1$ on Q_i^0. Using the sequences L produced in one orbit of a representation of G and their alternatives we can tabulate their reductions on the different expresions. For example

$$g_{2121}Q_1^0 = g_{212}Q_1^0 = g_{121}Q_1^0 = g_{12}Q_1^0 \tag{6.94}$$

where on the second step we've used the alternative form $g_{212} = g_{121}$. The table has 12 in the row and column corresponding to 2121 and Q_1^0. We'll omit the row corresponding to the identity.

Sequence L	Alternative	Q_1^0	Q_2^0	K_1	K_2
1	21212	$\varnothing$	1	1	1
21	1212	2	21	21	21
121	212	12	21	121	212
2121	12	12	1	12	12
12121	2	2	$\varnothing$	2	2

Table 6.2: Reductions of group actions $g \in G$ on Q_i^0 and K_i

We only have 6 different functions results of applying G on Q_1^0 and Q_2^0 so we have only 6 variables that we may wish to eliminate. Let

$$u_1 = Q_1^0\,, \quad u_2 = g_2 Q_1^0\,, \quad u_3 = g_{12} Q_1^0 \tag{6.95}$$

$$v_1 = Q_2^0\,, \quad v_2 = g_1 Q_2^0\,, \quad v_3 = g_{21} Q_2^0\,. \tag{6.96}$$

Also there are 12 different K_1's and K_2's which we label sequentially as $A_1, \ldots, A_6$ and $B_1, \ldots, B_6$ respectively. The associated matrix to the linear system of equations is

$$M_6 = \begin{bmatrix} A_1 & & & B_1 & & \\ A_2 & & & & B_2 & \\ & A_3 & & & & B_3 \\ & & A_4 & & & B_4 \\ & & A_5 & & B_5 & \\ & A_6 & & B_6 & & \end{bmatrix} \tag{6.97}$$

and it has determinant

$$\det M_6 = A_2 A_4 A_6 B_1 B_3 B_5 - A_1 A_3 A_5 B_2 B_4 B_6\,. \tag{6.98}$$

The even index $A's$ are obtained by applying g_1 on the odd indx $A's$ and vice versa for the $B's$. That is,

$$\det M_6 = \Delta_1(A_2 A_4 A_6 B_1 B_3 B_5) = \Delta_1(g_1 K_1 g_{121} K_1 g_{12} K_1 K_2 g_{21} K_2 g_{12} K_2)\,. \tag{6.99}$$

In the following table we show the relations between A's and B's for the 6 models with one of the two groups of order 6. $S11$, $S12$ and $S13$ have the one group and $S21$, $S22$ and $S23$ have the other.

Model	Name	A-relations	B-relations
	S11	$A_1 = A_6, A_2 = A_5, A_3 = A_4$	$B_1 = B_4, B_2 = B_3, B_5 = B_6$
	S12	$A_1 = A_4, A_2 = A_3, A_5 = A_6$	$B_1 = B_2, B_3 = B_6, B_4 = B_5$
	S13	None	None
	S21	$A_1 = A_6, A_2 = A_5, A_3 = A_4$	$B_1 = B_2, B_3 = B_6, B_4 = B_5$
	S22	$A_1 = A_4, A_2 = A_3, A_5 = A_6$	$B_1 = B_4, B_2 = B_3, B_5 = B_6$
	S23	None	None

Table 6.3: A and B relations

When a model has nontrivial relations $\det M_6 = 0$ and using a computer we can easily check that $\det M_6 \neq 0$ when there are no relations.

We seek the same type of relation on β and its orbit as for groups of order 4 so we'll use D_G as inspiration for the sign changes. We have the following

$$\begin{aligned} 0 =& \gamma\beta - \gamma_1\beta_1 + \gamma_{21}\beta_{21} - \gamma_{121}\beta_{121} + \gamma_{12}\beta_{12} - \gamma_2\beta_2 \\ =& \gamma(A_1u_1 + B_1v_1) - \gamma_2(A_6u_2 + B_6v_1) - \gamma_1A_2u_1 + B_2v_2) \\ &+ \gamma_{12}(A_5u_3 + B_5v_2) + \gamma_{21}(A_3u_2 + B_3v_3) - \gamma_{121}(A_4u_3 + B_4v_3)\,. \end{aligned} \tag{6.100}$$

Expanding out and collecting terms produces the system

$$A_1\gamma = A_2\gamma_1\,, \qquad A_3\gamma_{21} = A_6\gamma_2\,, \qquad A_5\gamma_{12} = A_4\gamma_{121}\,, \tag{6.101}$$

$$B_1\gamma = B_6\gamma_2\,, \qquad B_5\gamma_{12} = B_2\gamma_1\,, \qquad B_3\gamma_{21} = B_4\gamma_{121}\,. \tag{6.102}$$

This system of equations doesn't have a nontrivial symbolic solution so we need to use the relations here. There is a rational solution in each case with relations where γ is a free variable. We set γ to be the least common multiple of the denominators. We find that $K_0 = \gamma$ in each of the four cases with relations.

Model	S-polynomial	Weight $\gamma = K_0$	K-form
	$x_1\overline{x}_2 + \overline{x}_1 + x_2$	$A_3A_5B_6$	$g_{21}(K_1)g_{12}(K_1)g_2(K_2)$
	$\overline{x}_1x_2 + x_1 + \overline{x}_2$	$A_2A_5B_6$	$g_1(K_1)g_{12}(K_1)g_2(K_2)$
	$x_1x_2 + \overline{x}_1 + \overline{x}_2$	$A_2A_3B_5B_6$	$g_1(K_1)g_{21}(K_1)g_{12}(K_2)g_2(K_2)$
	$\overline{x}_1\overline{x}_2 + x_1 + x_2$	A_2B_6	$g_1(K_1)g_2(K_2)$

Table 6.4: Weight K_0 for the Orbit Summation operators

Here we've picked the respresentations of A's and B' with the least number of group operations g_i to reach the resulting expression. We also tried finding a possible K_0 by brute force for $S13$ and $S23$ but we did not find any among products of distinct A's and B's. It's likely that such a weight does not exist for these cases.

Theorem 91. *The algebraic kernel method extends for interacting random walk models with small steps and group G of size 6 if and only if* $\det M_6 = 0$. *In those cases we have the functional equation*

$$D_G(K_0\beta) = 0 \tag{6.103}$$

where $\beta = KQ + K_{1,2}Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha$ and K_0 depends on the specific model.

6.3.3 Groups of order 8

The analysis for groups of order 8 is quite similar so we will omit it. Here are the results.

Model	S-polynomial
	$x_1 + \overline{x}_1 + x_1\overline{x}_2 + \overline{x}_1x_2$
	$x_1 + \overline{x}_1 + x_1x_2 + \overline{x}_1\overline{x}_2$

Table 6.5: Models with group of size 8

We name the $A_1 = K_1$ and $B_1 = K_2$ iterates as before, e.g. $A_2 = g_1A_1$ and $A_3 = g_2g_1A_1$.

Sequence L	Alternative	Q_1^0	Q_2^0
1	2121212	$\varnothing$	1
21	121212	2	21
121	21212	12	121
2121	1212	212	121
12121	212	212	21
212121	12	12	1
1212121	2	2	$\varnothing$

Table 6.6: Reductions of group actions $g \in G$ on Q_i^0 and K_i

The relations are the same in both models

$$A_1 = A_6\,, \quad A_2 = A_5\,, \quad A_3 = A_4\,, \quad A_7 = A_8 \tag{6.104}$$

$$B_1 = B_4\,, \quad B_2 = B_3\,, \quad B_4 = B_8\,, \quad B_6 = B_7\,. \tag{6.105}$$

In both cases we obtain the same γ and write it in a form involving the least number of group actions.

$$\gamma = K_0 = A_2A_3B_5B_6 = g_1(K_1)g_{21}(K_1)g_{212}(K_2)g_{1212}(K_2)\,. \tag{6.106}$$

Theorem 92. *The algebraic kernel method extends for all interacting random walk models with small steps and group G of size 8. The functional equation is*

$$D_G(K_0\beta) = 0 \tag{6.107}$$

where $\beta = KQ + K_{1,2}Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha$ and $K_0 = g_1(K_1)g_{21}(K_1)g_{212}(K_2)g_{1212}(K_2)$.

Chapter 7

Obstinate Kernel Method

Another tool at our disposal is the Obstinate Kernel method which was used in the interacting case in [29]. The idea is similar to the weighted algebraic kernel method in that we produce more functional equations from the master equation via group actions $g \in G$. The difference is that here we also set one of $x_1 = \sigma_1$, $x_2 = \sigma_2$ equal to a root of K in order to eliminate the KQ term from the equations. This leaves equations that only include the other variable. It turns out that some combinations of substitutions and group operations don't lead to valid functional equations. This happens when one of the Q_k^0 terms is not a formal power series in t. In all the cases with finite groups of order 4, 6 and 8 we find that there are 2 roots of K for each x_k and that one root is in $O(t)$ and the other in $O(1/t)$. Generally it works out better if we use the $O(t)$ roots because that at least guarantees that the Q_k^0 terms remain as formal power series in t. However, sometimes (page 11 of [29]) even the $O(1/t)$ term may lead to a valid power series.

It may not be necessary but it will be sufficient if a combination of a substitution $x_k = \sigma_k$ and a group action g_L together give a power series in t when applied to single variables like x_1 or x_2. For example we would hope that $g_L(x_j)|_{x_k=\sigma_k}$ is a power series in t for some i, j, L. Again, this is not a necessary condition but it will be sufficient to show that a lot of the cases involved produce enough different equations to allow us to go through the Obstinate Kernel method. For those cases that we obtain less equations, it is likely that we'll be able to show that the Q_k^0 terms are power series in t via another method like in (two friendly walks).

Definition 93. *A function $f(x_1, \ldots, x_d; t)$ is admissible if it is a power series in t. Furthermore f is k-admissible if $f|_{x_k=\sigma_k}$ is admissible for an admissible σ_k root. A tuple of functions is admissible if each element of the tuple is admissible.*

Proposition 94. *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a random walk model with small nonrepeating steps and group G of order 4. The actions $g \in G$ that preserve the admissibility are given in the following table*

When $|G| = 6$ we have a richer situation.

Proposition 95. *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be a random walk model with small nonrepeating steps and group G of order 4, 6 or 8. Models with the same group have the same admissibility properties with respect to admissible when it comes to x_1, x_2 or the pair (x_1, x_2).*

Proof. We don't know of a conceptual proof of this fact so we performed the calculations on a computer. They are trivial computationally speaking. For a given model $\mathcal{M}$ we construct its S-polynomial which can be used to find the admissible roots σ_k for $k = 1, 2$. We can use S to express the generators g_k and their action on the pair (x_1, x_2). Once we have the generators we form the group G. Next, to check the admissibility of $f \in \{x_1, x_2, (x_1, x_2)\}$ all we need to do is find $|\mathrm{Orbit}_G(f)|$ and see if substituting $x_k = \sigma_k$ in the resulting expressions leads to admissible functions. The calculations can be done by hand but they are tedious so we've employed a computer to do the legwork. Then it is a trivial matter of checking the admissible properties for the various models and comparing the results. These are be summarized in the tables following this exposition. □

Type	x_1	x_2	(x_1, x_2)
1-admissibility	$1,\ g_2$	all $g \in G$	$1,\ g_2$
2-admissibility	$1,\ g_1$	all $g \in G$	$1,\ g_1$

Table 7.1: k-admissibility of functions when $|G| = 4$.

Type	x_1	x_2	(x_1, x_2)
1-admissibility	$1,\ g_2,\ g_{21},\ g_{121}$	$1,\ g_1,\ g_2,\ g_{21}$	$1,\ g_2,\ g_{21}$
2-admissibility	$1,\ g_1,\ g_2,\ g_{12}$	$1,\ g_1,\ g_{12},\ g_{121}$	$1,\ g_1,\ g_{12}$

Table 7.2: k-admissibility of functions for $S11$, $S12$, $S13$. Here $|G| = 6$

Type	x_1	x_2	(x_1, x_2)
1-admissibility	$1,\ g_2,\ g_{21},\ g_{121}$	$1,\ g_1,\ g_{12},\ g_{121}$	$1,\ g_{121}$
2-admissibility	$1,\ g_2,\ g_{21},\ g_{121}$	$1,\ g_1,\ g_{12},\ g_{121}$	$1,\ g_{121}$

Table 7.3: k-admissibility of functions for $S21$, $S22$, $S33$. Here $|G| = 6$

Type	x_1	x_2	(x_1, x_2)
1-admissibility	$1,\ g_2,\ g_{21},\ g_{212}$	all $g \in G$	$1,\ g_2,\ g_{21},\ g_{212}$
2-admissibility	$1,\ g_1,\ g_2,\ g_{12},\ g_{121},\ g_{2121}$	$1,\ g_1,\ g_{12},\ g_{121}$	$1,\ g_1,\ g_{12},\ g_{121}$

Table 7.4: k-admissibility of functions for $S1$. Here $|G| = 8$.

Type	x_1	x_2	(x_1, x_2)
1-admissibility	$1,\ g_2,\ g_{21},\ g_{212}$	all $g \in G$	$1,\ g_2,\ g_{21},\ g_{212}$
2-admissibility	$1,\ g_2,\ g_{21},\ g_{121},\ g_{212},\ g_{2121}$	$1,\ g_1,\ g_{12},\ g_{121}$	$1,\ g_{121}$

Table 7.5: k-admissibility of functions for $S2$. Here $|G| = 8$.

What this classification tells us is that we can easily treat all $|G| = 4$ models with the same method. When $|G| = 6$ we either have to do some more work in the $S2k$ cases to show that the functions are admissible with respect to one more group operation or just deal with them as they are. The situation is similar in the $|G| = 8$ case. Now suppose that we have a set of valid equations for a substitution $x_k = \sigma_k$. They are a linear system in the variable quantities $Q^{0,0}_{1,2}$, Q^0_1, Q^0_2 and their orbits under the set of valid group actions. We hope for a high level of redundancy in these equations. Then we can eliminate some variables by taking a weighted sum over the valid equations. That is we obtain a weighted Orbit Sum operator with only a few group operations perhaps. We also have to keep in mind that we are also making the substitution $x_k = \sigma_k$.

We'll perform the first steps in the analysis of the Obstinate Kernel method for each situation that has $|G|/2$ k-admissible elements since that seems to work.

7.1 Group of order 4

The analysis in this case is the same whether we work with the σ_1 or σ_2 substitutions. We'll just work wit hthe σ_1 substitution and group actions $1,\ g_2$ where we let $g_2(F) = F^*$ to keep the notation cleaner. The functional equations corresponding the the group actions are

$$KQ - K_1 Q^0_1 - K_2 Q^0_2 + K_{12} Q^{0,0}_{1,2} = \alpha\,, \tag{7.1}$$

$$KQ^* - K^*_1 Q^{0,*}_1 - K^*_2 Q^0_2 - K^*_{12} Q^{0,0}_{1,2} = \alpha\,. \tag{7.2}$$

We'll eliminate Q^0_2 because once we maket the σ_1 substitution we would have a tough time trying to expand this into series. We do this by taking K^*_2 times the first equation and subtract K_2 times

the second equation. This leads to the functional equation

$$K_2^* KQ - K_2 KQ^* - (K_2^* K_1 Q_1^0 - K_2 K_1^* Q_1^{0,*}) + (K_2^* K_{12} - K_2 K_{12}^*) Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha(K_2^* - K_2) = 0 \tag{7.3}$$

where we can set $x_1 = \sigma_1$ to eliminate the K term. We'll overload notation by not changing any of the symbols. From now on we'll know that $x_1 = \sigma_1$ in the equations that follow. We have

$$(K_2^* K_1 Q_1^0 - K_2 K_1^* Q_1^{0,*}) - (K_2^* K_{12} - K_2 K_{12}^*) Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + \alpha(K_2^* - K_2) = 0. \tag{7.4}$$

We can also think of this process as applying a weighted orbit sum over group actions that preserve the admissibility of functions in the master equation. The operator is

$$D_2 = g_2(K_2) - K_2 g_2 = (1 - g_2) K_2^* \tag{7.5}$$

where the weights are given by pre-multiplying an expression by K_2^* before applying the operator $\Delta_2 = 1 - g_2$. The equation can be written as

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= D_2(KQ - K_1 Q_1^0 - K_2 Q_2^0 + K_{12} Q_{1,2}^{0,0}) \\ 0 &= D_2(K_1 Q_1^0) - D_2(K_{12}) Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + D(\alpha) \end{aligned} \tag{7.6}$$

where the second one follow from substituting $x_1 = \sigma_1$. The situation is similar to the Algebraic Kernel method except that the operators there retain the KQ term and its orbit while they eliminate the Q_1^0 and Q_2^0 terms and their orbits. Since we'll be using operators like D_2 we'll have some notation.

Definition 96. *For a concatenated list $L = L_1 L_2 \ldots$ of positive integer indices let $g_L = g_{L_1} g_{L_2} \ldots$ whenever this group action makes sense. That is, either the list is finite or there is some form of convergence when L is infinite.*

Definition 97. *Let L be a concatenated list. Definte $\Delta_L = 1 - g_L$. Now let X be some function. The operator $D_L[X]$ is defined by its action on functions F as*

$$D_L[X](F) = \Delta_L(XF) = (1 - g_L)(XF) = XF - g_L(XF)\,. \tag{7.7}$$

We'll drop the X from the notation if it's clear in context. In particular $D_L[1] = \Delta_L$.

For example, $D_2 = D_2[g_2(K_2)]$.

Example 98. If we use $g_L(X)$ instead of X in the above definition we obtain

$$D_L[g_L(X)] = g_L(X) - Xg_L \tag{7.8}$$

which is essentially an Ore operator. In our analysis we'll see these somewhat frequently.

7.1.1 Some Calculations

Before we go onto groups of order 6 we can expand some of the terms in the functional equation. First

$$\begin{aligned} D_2(\alpha) &= \alpha(K_2^* - K_2) = \\ &= \alpha((c_2 - tx_2\overline{\mu}_2 S_2^{-1}) - (c_2 - t\overline{x}_2 S_2^{-1})) \\ &= \alpha t(\overline{x}_2 - x_2\overline{\mu}_2(\sigma_1))S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1)\,. \end{aligned} \tag{7.9}$$

Then

$$\begin{aligned} D_2(K_{12}) &= K_2^* K_{12} - K_2 K_{12}^* = \\ &= (c_2 - tx_2\overline{\mu}_2 S_2^{-1})(c_1c_2 - t\overline{\sigma}_1\overline{x}_2 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}) \\ &\quad - (c_2 - t\overline{x}_2 S_2^{-1})(c_1c_2 - t\overline{\sigma}_1 x_2\overline{\mu}_2 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}) \\ &= c_1c_2^2 - c_1c_2tx_2\overline{\mu}_2 S_2^{-1} - c_2t\overline{\sigma}_1\overline{x}_2 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1} + t^2\overline{\sigma}_1\overline{\mu}_2 S_2^{-1}S_{1,2}^{-1,-1} \\ &\quad - c_1c_2^2 + c_1c_2t\overline{x}_2 S_2^{-1} + c_2t\overline{\sigma}_1 x_2\overline{\mu}_2 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1} - t^2\overline{\sigma}_1\overline{\mu}_2 S_2^{-1}S_{1,2}^{-1,-1} \\ &= c_1c_2t(\overline{x}_2 - x_2\overline{\mu}_2)S_2^{-1} - c_2t\overline{\sigma}_1(\overline{x}_2 - x_2\overline{\mu}_2)S_{1,2}^{-1,-1} \\ &= c_2t(\overline{x}_2 - x_2\overline{\mu}_2(\sigma_1))(c_1S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1) - \overline{\sigma}_1 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}) \end{aligned} \tag{7.10}$$

Now if the model is symmetric in both directions we see that $g_2S_1^{-1} = S_1^{-1}$ and so $g_2K_1 = K_1$ and we may bring that factor outside of $D_2(K_1^*F) = K_1D_2(F)$. It's worth investigating if this happens in other cases since this will make it easier to perform coefficient extraction later. We can answer this in the negative.

Proposition 99. *Suppose that a model with group of order 4 has symmetry around the x_i axis and $j \neq i$. Then $D_i[g_iK_j] = K_jD_i[1] = K_j\Delta_i$ in the σ_j substitution. Also $D_j[g_j(K_i)] = K_iD_j[1] = K_i\Delta_j$ if and only if the model is also symmetric around the x_j axis. Thus we can bring out the K term out of both operators if and only if the model is highly symmetric.*

Proof. Assume that the model is symmetric around the x_1-axis, that is, it is vertically symmetric. This implies that $S_1^{-1} = S_1^1$ and $g_1(S_2^k) = S_2^k$ for all k. This immediately tells us that $g_1(K_2) = K_2$

and $D_1[g_1K_2] = K_2\Delta_1$. This remains true when we substitute $x_2 = \sigma_2$. This would also be true for the other operator if the model is symmetric around the x_2-axis. Thus we only need to show the forward direction of the statement. We'll show that if the model is not highly symmetric, the factoring won't happen. It's enough to show that $g_2(K_1) \neq K_1$ even after the $x_1 = \sigma_1$ substitution is made.

The solutions to $K = 0$ in the x_1 variable are

$$x_1 = \frac{(1 - tS_1^0) \pm \sqrt{(1 - tS_1^0)^2 - 4t^2(S_1^1)^2}}{2tS_1^1}. \tag{7.11}$$

If $\sigma_1 = u \pm v\sqrt{w}$ then it turns out that $\overline{\sigma}_1 = u \mp v\sqrt{w}$ due to the symmetry and

$$s = \sigma_1 + \overline{\sigma}_1 = 2u = \frac{1 - tS_1^0}{tS_1^1}. \tag{7.12}$$

Now

$$g_2K_1 = c_2 - t\overline{x}_1 g_2(S_1^{-1}(x_2)) = c_2 - t\overline{x}_1 S_1^{-1}(\overline{x}_2\mu_2(x_1)) \tag{7.13}$$

and $g_2K_1 = K_1$ if and only if

$$S_1^{-1}(\overline{x}_2\mu_2(x_1)) = S_1^{-1}(x_2) \tag{7.14}$$

upon making the substitution $x_1 = \sigma_1$. We'll first compute $\mu_2(\sigma_1)$. To that end we have

$$S_2^k(\sigma_1) = S_{1,2}^{0,k} + S_{1,2}^{1,k}(\overline{\sigma}_1 + \sigma_1) = S_{1,2}^{0,k} + S_{1,2}^{1,k}\frac{1 - tS_1^0}{tS_1^1} \tag{7.15}$$

and

$$\mu_2(\sigma_1) = \frac{S_2^{-1}}{S_2^1} = \frac{S_{1,2}^{0,-1} + S_{1,2}^{1,-1}\frac{1-tS_1^0}{tS_1^1}}{S_{1,2}^{0,1} + S_{1,2}^{1,1}\frac{1-tS_1^0}{tS_1^1}} = \frac{S_{1,2}^{1,-1} + t\left(S_{1,2}^{0,-1}S_1^1 - S_{1,2}^{1,-1}S_1^0\right)}{S_{1,2}^{1,1} + t\left(S_{1,2}^{0,1}S_1^1 - S_{1,2}^{1,1}S_1^0\right)}. \tag{7.16}$$

This is a rational function in x_2. Using software we can easily compute this expression and further $S_1^{-1}(\overline{x}_2\mu_2(x_1))$ to show that we only have equality when the model is highly symmetric.

□

In the next chapter we'll investigate the highly-symmetric models in more detail.

7.2 Group of order 6

We can perform the Obstinate Kernel method on the three models in the first group. They are as follows.

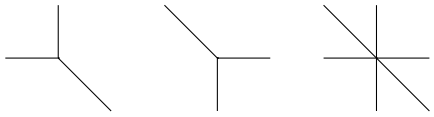


Figure 7.1: Models $S11,\ S12,\ S13$ with group of order 6

The k-admissibility of (x_1, x_2) is preserved by actions $1,\ g_j,\ g_{jk}$ for $j \neq k$. For consistency we'll work on the 1-admissible case. The actions are $1,\ g_2,\ g_{21}$. We have the table from the Algebraic Kernel method.

Sequence L	Q_1^0	Q_2^0
$\varnothing$	$\varnothing$	$\varnothing$
2	2	$\varnothing$
21	2	21

Table 7.6: Reductions of group actions $g \in G$ on Q_1^0 and Q_2^0.

In this group we have $g_2(x_1, x_2) = (x_1, x_1\overline{x}_2)$ and $g_{21}(x_1, x_2) = (\overline{x}_2, x_1\overline{x}_2)$ so the terms we wish to eliminate are those involving an x_1 because the substitution $x_1 = \sigma_1$ will make it difficult to expand the Q functions into series. That is, we wish to eliminate $X_2 = g_2 Q_1^0$ and $Y = Q_2^0$. Let

$$\beta = K_{12} Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha = \alpha(b_1 b_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - 1) \tag{7.17}$$

so that we have equations

$$AX + BY = \beta\,, \quad A_2 X_2 + B_2 Y = \beta_2\,, \quad A_{21} X + B_{21} Y_{21} = \beta_{21}\,. \tag{7.18}$$

We want a linear combination of $\beta, \beta_2, \beta_{21}$ that will eliminate X_2 and Y. We may write

$$a\beta - b\beta_2 + c\beta_{21} = aAX + (aB - bB_2)Y + (cA_{21} - bA_2) + cB_{21}Y_{21} = aAX + cB_{21}Y_{21} \tag{7.19}$$

which means that

$$aB = bB_2\,, \quad cA_{21} = bA_2\,. \tag{7.20}$$

We don't want to have any denominators so when we solve for a, b and c we have a small solution

$$a = A_{21}B_2\,, \quad b = A_{21}B\,, \quad c = A_2B\,, \tag{7.21}$$

and these may or may not have common factors. In other words the elimination procedure yields

$$\begin{aligned} &AA_{21}B_2Q_1^0 + A_2BB_{21}g_{21}Q_2^0 = A_{21}B_2\beta - A_{21}B\beta_2 + A_2B\beta_{21} \\ &= (A_{21}B_2 - A_{21}B + A_2B)\beta\,. \end{aligned} \tag{7.22}$$

Here we may think of a weighted sum operator too. Let

$$D(F) = A_{21}B_2F - A_{21}Bg_2(F) + A_2Bg_{21}(F)\,. \tag{7.23}$$

Then we can re-write the equation as

$$D(AX + BY) = AA_{21}B_2Q_1^0 + A_2BB_{21}g_{21}Q_2^0 = \beta D(1)\,. \tag{7.24}$$

We may compute $D(1)$ for each case but the expressions are somewhat complicated. $D(1)$ for each of $S11$, $S12$ and $S13$ will contain a square root like in σ_1. So do the terms $AA_{21}B_2$ and A_2BB_{21}. It's worth mentioning that we can convert the equation to one with no square roots by collecting terms involving the square root on one side and squaring. Then we have a non-linear equation in X and Y with rational function coefficients. It's not clear how we could go further.

7.3 Group of order 8

The the group G has order 8 we only have two non-isomorphic models but we'll deal with the one with four group actions that preserve the admissibility of (x_1, x_2). The actions are 1, g_2, g_{21}, g_{212}. The step polynomial is


$$:\ S = \overline{x}_1 + x_1 + \overline{x}_1x_2 + x_1\overline{x}_2 \tag{7.25}$$

This is the case covered in [29]. We'll go through the same problem but from this new perspective. From the previous chapter we have

Sequence L	Q_1^0	Q_2^0
$\varnothing$	$\varnothing$	$\varnothing$
2	2	$\varnothing$
21	2	21
212	212	21

Table 7.7: Reductions of group actions $g \in G$ on Q_1^0 and Q_2^0 that preserve 1-admissibility.

We'll Let $\beta = K_{12}Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha = \alpha(b_1 b_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - 1)$, $X = Q_1^0$ and $Y = Q_2^0$. Note that β is left unaffected by group actions. We have the four equations

$$AX + BY = \beta\,, \tag{7.26}$$

$$A_2X_2 + B_2Y = \beta\,, \tag{7.27}$$

$$A_{21}X_2 + B_{21}Y_{21} = \beta\,, \tag{7.28}$$

$$A_{212}X_{212} + B_{212}Y_{21} = \beta\,, \tag{7.29}$$

where we wish to eliminate variables X, Y that contain σ_1 in their input. Those are X_2, Y and Y_{21} and we can eliminate them by first eliminating Y and Y_{21} from the first two and second two equations, and then eliminating X_2 from the resulting two equations. That is, we compute B_2 times the first equation minus B times the second equation, and B_{212} times the third equation minus B_{21} from the last equation. In other words this is the same as if we apply the operators

$$D_2[B_2] = B_2 - Bg_2\,, \tag{7.30}$$

$$-g_{212}D_2[B_2] = g_{212}\,Bg_2 - g_{212}\,B_2 = B_{212}\,g_{21} - B_{21}\,g_{212} \tag{7.31}$$

to both sides of the master functional equation and substitute $x_1 = \sigma_1$. We obtain the equations

$$AB_2X - A_2BX_2 = \beta(B_2 - B)\,, \tag{7.32}$$

$$A_{21}B_{212}X_2 - A_{212}B_{21}X_{212} = \beta(B_{212} - B_{21})\,. \tag{7.33}$$

To eliminate the X_2 terms we take $A_{21}B_{212}$ times the first equation and add A_2B times the second equation. We have

$$A_{21}B_{212}AB_2X - A_2BA_{212}B_{21}X_{212} = \beta(A_{21}B_{212}(B - B_2) + A_2B(B_{212} - B_{21})) \tag{7.34}$$

We could obtain the same result by applying the following operator D to both sides of the master functional equation.

$$\begin{aligned} D &= A_{21}B_{212}D_2[B_2] - A_2Bg_{212}D_2[B_2] \\ &= (A_{21}B_{212} - A_2Bg_{212})D_2[B_2] \\ &= (A_{21}B_{212} - g_{212}A_{21}B_{212})D_2[B_2] \\ &= D_{212}[A_{21}B_{212}]D_2[B_2]\,. \end{aligned} \tag{7.35}$$

Starting from the master functional equation we have

$$D(RHS) = D(\beta) = \beta D_{212}[A_{21}B_{212}](B_2 - B) \tag{7.36}$$

$$\begin{aligned} D(LHS) &= D(AX + BY) = D(AX) \\ &= D_{212}[A_{21}B_{212}]D_2[B_2](AX) \\ &= D_{212}[A_{21}B_{212}](AB_2X - A_2BX_2) \\ &= D_{212}[A_{21}B_{212}](AB_2X) \\ &= D_{212}[AA_{21}B_2B_{212}](X) \end{aligned} \tag{7.37}$$

We note that $A_{212} = A$ so we can actually factor out A from the operator. Finally we have the following theorem.

Theorem 100. *For the first model with group of order 8 we have*

$$D_{212}[A_{21}B_2B_{212}]\left(Q_1^0\right) = \frac{\beta}{A}D_{212}[A_{21}B_{212}](B_2 - B) \tag{7.38}$$

where $A_L = g_L(K_1)$, $B_L = g_L(K_2)$ and $\beta = \alpha(b_1b_2Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - 1)$ and we only obtain an equality once we set $x_1 = \sigma_1$ in this expression.

If we went through the σ_2 substitution instead, we would have onbtained an analogous statement which we show here without proof.

Theorem 101. *For the first model with group of order 8 we have*

$$D_{121}[B_{12}A_1A_{121}]\left(Q_2^0\right) = \frac{\beta}{B}D_{121}[B_{12}A_{121}](A_1 - A) \tag{7.39}$$

where $A_L = g_L(K_1)$, $B_L = g_L(K_2)$ and $\beta = \alpha(b_1b_2Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - 1)$ and we only obtain an equality once we set $x_2 = \sigma_2$ in this expression.

The interesting fact (as found in [29]) is that the coefficients in front of the Q's become Laurent polynomials once we take into consideration the σ_k substitutions, even though the σ_k's contain square roots. The coefficient in front of β can be reduced to a rational function plus a rational function times a square root after properly conjugating. The calculations are exceedingly complicated and unlikely to be done easily by hand. The square root part does not depend on a_2 in the first case and a_1 in the second case. This is what allows the authors to obtain relationships between $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$ and setting one or more of a_1, a_2 equal to 1.

Chapter 8

OKM in Highly symmetric 2D models

We'll continue further with the OKM for highly-symmetric models. There are only a few such models. If x_k is in S then so is $\overline{x}_k$. If one of the diagonal terms is in S then so are the others. To have a group of order 4 we need to have both an x_1 and x_2 variable in S so we have several non-isomorphic models. One with cartesian steps, one with diagonal steps, one with diagonal step and x_1,$\overline{x}_1$ and finally the model with all steps. The notation will be the same as in previous chapters. We derived the following equations

$$x_1 = \sigma_1 : \quad \Delta_2(K2^* Q_1^0) = \frac{1}{K_1}\left(\Delta_2(K_2^* K_{12}) Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha(K_2^* - K_2)\right) , \tag{8.1}$$

$$x_2 = \sigma_2 : \quad \Delta_1(K1^\bullet Q_2^0) = \frac{1}{K_2}\left(\Delta_1(K_1^\bullet K_{12}) Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \alpha(K_1^\bullet - K_1)\right) . \tag{8.2}$$

It is enough to only consider the analysis for one of the quations for now. Only the third model requires looking at both equations. We already know from the previous chapter that $\mu_2 = S_2^{-1}/S_2^1 = 1$ and

$$\alpha(K_2^* - K_2) = \alpha t(\overline{x}_2 - x_2) S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1) , \tag{8.3}$$

$$\Delta_2(K_2^* K_{12}) = c_2 t(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)(c_1 S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1) - \overline{\sigma}_1 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}) . \tag{8.4}$$

To compute $\Delta_2(K2^* Q_1^0)$ we need to compute $K_2(\sigma_1, x_2)$ and $K_2^*(\sigma_1, x_2)$ which are given by

$$K_2 = c_2 - t\overline{x}_2 S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1) , \quad K_2^* = c_2 - t x_2 S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1) . \tag{8.5}$$

Therefore we will focus on computing $S_2^{-1}(\sigma)$ first.

$$\begin{aligned} S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1) &= S_{1,2}^{0,1} + S_{1,2}^{1,1}(\overline{\sigma}_1 + \sigma_1) \\ &= S_{1,2}^{0,1} + S_{1,2}^{1,1}\frac{1 - tS_1^0}{tS_1^1} \\ &= \frac{1}{tS_1^1}\left(S_{1,2}^{1,1} + t\left(S_{1,2}^{0,1}S_1^1 - S_{1,2}^{1,1}S_1^0\right)\right) \\ &= \frac{S_{1,2}^{1,1} + tS_{1,2}^{0,1}S_{1,2}^{1,0}}{t\left(S_{1,2}^{1,0} + S_{1,2}^{1,1}(\overline{x}_2 + x_2)\right)}\,. \end{aligned} \tag{8.6}$$

Therefore the function $S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1)$ is a rational function of x_2.

Model	$S_{1,2}^{0,1}$	$S_{1,2}^{1,0}$	$S_{1,2}^{1,1}$	$S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1)$
	1	1	0	1
	0	0	1	$\bar{t}/(\overline{x}_2 + x_2)$
	1	0	1	$\bar{t}/(\overline{x}_2 + x_2)$
	0	1	1	$\bar{t}/(\overline{x}_2 + 1 + x_2)$
	1	1	1	$(1 + \bar{t})/(\overline{x}_2 + 1 + x_2)$

Table 8.1: Function $S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1)$ for highly symmetric models.

Lemma 102. *For highly symmetric models with $e = S_{1,2}^{1,1}, f = S_{1,2}^{1,0}, g = S_{1,2}^{0,1}$ we have*

$$\frac{\alpha(K_2^* - K_2)}{K_1} = \frac{\alpha(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)(e + tfg)}{S_1^1 K_1}\,, \tag{8.7}$$

$$\frac{\Delta_2(K_2^* K_{12})}{K_1} = \frac{c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)(c_1(e + tfg) - et\overline{\sigma}_1 S_1^1)}{S_1^1(c_1 - t\overline{\sigma}_1 S_1^1)}\,. \tag{8.8}$$

8.1 Cartesian model: steps N, S, E, W

In this case $S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1) = 1$ so a lot of the calculations will be simpler and this is a good place to start further work. Here $K_{12} = c_1 c_2$ so it behaves like α and we have

$$\Delta_2(K2^* Q_1^0) + \frac{\alpha\beta(K_2^* - K_2)}{K_1} = 0\,, \tag{8.9}$$

where

$$\beta = 1 - b_1 b_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} \tag{8.10}$$

and

$$\frac{\alpha\beta(K_2^* - K_2)}{K_1} = \frac{\alpha\beta t(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)}{K_1} = \alpha\beta f(c_1, x_2)\,, \tag{8.11}$$

since K_1 doesn't depend on c_2 or x_1. The equation finally becomes

$$(c_2 - t x_2) Q_1^0(x_2) - (c_2 - t\overline{x}_2) Q_1^0(\overline{x}_2) + \alpha\beta f = 0\,. \tag{8.12}$$

We perform the extraction $[x_2^1]$ to get

$$c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,1} - t Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + \alpha\beta f_2^1 = 0 \tag{8.13}$$

and the extraction $[b_2^0]$ to get

$$-t\check{Q}_{1,2}^{0,0} + \overline{a}_1 f_2^1\,. \tag{8.14}$$

Using the second equation within the first one and simplifying yields

$$b_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,1} = t(a_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \beta\check{Q}_{1,2}^{0,0})\,, \tag{8.15}$$

$$b_1 Q_{1,2}^{1,0} = t(a_1 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - \beta\widehat{Q}_{1,2}^{0,0}) \tag{8.16}$$

Here the second equation is obtained via the same method but with $\bullet$ instead of $*$. Using the same method we can also obtain

$$b_2 Q_{1,2}^{1,1} = t(a_2 Q_{1,2}^{1,0} - \beta\check{Q}_{1,2}^{1,0})\,. \tag{8.17}$$

Multiplying by b_1 and using the above relations leads to

$$\begin{aligned} b_1 b_2 Q^{1,1}_{1,2} &= t(a_2 b_1 Q^{1,0}_{1,2} - \beta b_1 \breve{Q}^{1,0}_{1,2}) \\ &= t a_2 t(a_1 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - \beta \widehat{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2}) - t\beta t(a_1 \breve{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} - \beta \breve{\widehat{Q}}^{0,0}_{1,2}) \\ &= t^2(a_1 a_2 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - a_2\beta \widehat{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} - a_1 \beta \breve{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} + \beta^2 \breve{\widehat{Q}}^{0,0}_{1,2}) \,. \end{aligned} \tag{8.18}$$

Let

$$G = Q^{0,0}_{1,2}, \quad \widehat{G} = G_1, \quad \breve{G} = G_2 \,. \tag{8.19}$$

From before we have

$$Q^{0,0}_{1,2} = 1 + t a_1 a_2 (Q^{1,0}_{1,2} + Q^{0,1}_{1,2}) \,. \tag{8.20}$$

Multiplying by $b_1 b_2$ and using the above relations leads to

$$\begin{aligned} b_1 b_2 G &= b_1 b_2 + t a_1 a_2 (b_2 b_1 Q^{1,0}_{1,2} + b_1 b_2 Q^{0,1}_{1,2}) \\ &= b_1 b_2 + t a_1 a_2 (b_2 t(a_1 G - \beta G_1) + b_1 t(a_2 G - \beta G_2) \\ &= b_1 b_2 + t^2 a_1 a_2 (b_2 a_1 G + b_1 a_2 G - b_2 \beta G_1 - b_1 \beta G_2) \,. \end{aligned} \tag{8.21}$$

Using the relation for β and simplifying leads to

$$G = \frac{b_1 b - 2 - t^2 a_1 a_2 (b_2 G_1 + b_1 G_2)}{b_1 b_2 - t^2 a_1 a_2 (a_2 b_1 + a_1 b_2 + b_1 b_2 (b_2 G_1 + b_1 G_2))} \,. \tag{8.22}$$

If we let $F = (b_2 G_1 + b_1 G_2)$ and perform the long division with respect to F we find that

$$Q^{0,0}_{1,2} = \frac{1}{b_1 b_2} \left(1 - \frac{b_1 b_2 (1 - b_1 b_2) - t^2 a_1 a_2 (a_1 b_2 + a_2 b_1)}{b_1 b_2 + t^2 a_1 a_2 (a_1 b_2 + a_2 b_1 + b_1 b_2 F)} \right) \,. \tag{8.23}$$

Using arguments similar to those in the later section on diagonal steps we can find out more about the various Q's.

$$b_2 Q^{m,n+1}_{1,2} = t(a_2 Q^{m,n}_{1,2} - \beta \breve{Q}^{m,n}_{1,2}) \,, \tag{8.24}$$

$$b_1 Q^{m+1,n}_{1,2} = t(a_1 Q^{m,n}_{1,2} - \beta \widehat{Q}^{m,n}_{1,2}) \,. \tag{8.25}$$

Summing the equations multiplied by their respective powers of x_1 and x_2 we find the equations

$$b_2 Q_2^{n+1} = t(a_2 Q_2^n - \beta \breve{Q}_2^n)\,, \tag{8.26}$$

$$b_1 Q_1^{m+1} = t(a_1 Q_1^m - \beta \widehat{Q}_1^m)\,. \tag{8.27}$$

Now we can sum with respect to x_2 and x_1 to find

$$b_2(Q - Q_2^0) = x_2 t(a_2 Q - \beta \breve{Q})\,, \tag{8.28}$$

$$b_1(Q - Q_1^0) = x_1 t(a_1 Q - \beta \widehat{Q})\,. \tag{8.29}$$

We can solve these for Q_2^0 and Q_1^0 as follows

$$b_2 Q_2^0 = (b_2 - a_2 x_2 t)Q + x_2 t\beta \breve{Q}\,, \tag{8.30}$$

$$b_1 Q_1^0 = (b_1 - a_1 x_1 t)Q + x_1 t\beta \widehat{Q}\,. \tag{8.31}$$

We substitute these two expressions into the original functional equation and after some algebra we find that

$$Q = \frac{(1 - b_1 b_2 G)(\alpha + t x_1 \overline{b_1} K_1 \widehat{Q} + t x_2 \overline{b_2} K_2 \breve{Q})}{K - (1 - \overline{c_1} x_1 t)K_1 - (1 - \overline{c_2} x_2 t)K_2} \tag{8.32}$$

and after recognizing some of the quantities as modified K_1 and K_2's we finally stop at the solution for Q

$$Q = \frac{(1 - b_1 b_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0})(\alpha - \bar{b}_1 K_1 \widehat{K}_1^{\bullet} \widehat{Q} - \bar{b}_2 K_2 \breve{K}_2^{*} \breve{Q})}{K - \bar{c}_1 K_1 K_1^{\bullet} - \bar{c}_2 K_2 K_2^{*}}\,. \tag{8.33}$$

This rather complicated expression shows that the generating function$Q$ is obtained via copies of Q which have some of their marking variables set to 1.

8.2 Diagonal model: steps NE, NW, SE, SW

The next case in terms of difficulty is when we have diagonal steps. This model is very similar to the one covered in [**?**] where they have two interacting walks confined in a semi-infinite strip. The models are different because there we have an extra term in the functional equations. The difficulty in the current case perhaps arrises in that $S_2^{-1}(\sigma_1)$ is now more complicated which is due to the

diagonal terms. Also $S_{1,2}^{-1,-1} \neq 1$ so K_{12} is not trivial. Here

$$\frac{\alpha(K_2^* - K_2)}{K_1} = \frac{\alpha(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)}{K_1(\overline{x}_2 + x_2)}\,, \tag{8.34}$$

$$\frac{\Delta_2(K_2^* K_{12})}{K_1} = \frac{c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)(c_1 - t\overline{\sigma}_1 S_1^1)}{S_1^1(c_1 - t\overline{\sigma}_1 S_1^1)} = \frac{c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)}{\overline{x}_2 + x_2}\,. \tag{8.35}$$

The functional equation becomes

$$K_2^* Q_1 - K_2 Q_1^* - \frac{c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)}{\overline{x}_2 + x_2} Q_{1,2} + \alpha \frac{\overline{x}_2 - x_2}{(\overline{x}_2 + x_2)K_1} = 0\,. \tag{8.36}$$

Surprisingly enough, the only term that depends on σ_1 remaining in this expression is K_1 and this will be of no consequence to the rest of the analysis. We just need to take care of the remaining terms. We'll do this by multiplying the equation by $\overline{x}_2 + x_2$. We have

$$R^* = (\overline{x}_2 + x_2)K_2^* = c_2(\overline{x}_2 + x_2) - x_2 = c_2\overline{x}_2 - \overline{a}_2 x_2\,, \tag{8.37}$$

$$R = (\overline{x}_2 + x_2)K_2 = c_2(\overline{x}_2 + x_2) - \overline{x}_2 = c_2 x_2 - \overline{a}_2\overline{x}_2\,. \tag{8.38}$$

There are a couple of relations here

$$R^* - R = v(K_2^* - K_2) = \overline{x}_2 - x_2 \tag{8.39}$$

$$\overline{x}_2 R^* - x_2 R = \overline{x}_2 c_2 v - 1 - x_2 c_2 v + 1 \tag{8.40}$$

$$= c_2 v(\overline{x}_2 - x_2) \tag{8.41}$$

The equation becomes

$$(c_2\overline{x}_2 - \overline{a}_2 x_2)Q_1^0(x_2) + (\overline{a}_2\overline{x}_2 - c_2 x_2)Q_1^0(\overline{x}_2) + (\alpha\overline{K}_1 - c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0})(\overline{x}_2 - x_2) = 0 \tag{8.42}$$

and it's ready for extraction. Let $\delta_0 = \overline{a}_1(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)\overline{K}_1$. We re-write the equation as

$$R^* Q_1^0 - R Q_1^{0,*} - c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + \overline{a}_2\delta_0 = 0\,. \tag{8.43}$$

We'll use the master equation

$$(1 - tS)Q - (c_1 - t\overline{x}_1 S_1^{-1})Q_1^0 - (c_2 - t\overline{x}_2 S_2^{-1})Q_2^0 + (c_1 c_2 - t\overline{x}_1\overline{x}_2 S_{1,2}^{-1,-1})Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = \overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2 \tag{8.44}$$

to further our work here. For diagonal steps it is

$$(1 - tS)Q - (c_1 - tv\overline{x}_1)Q_1^0 - (c_2 - t\overline{x}_2 S_2^{-1})Q_2^0 + (c_1c_2 - t\overline{x}_1\overline{x}_2)Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = \overline{a}_1\overline{a}_2 \tag{8.45}$$

extracting the $[x_1^0]$ coefficient yields

$$Q_1^0 = \overline{a}_2 + c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + a_1 tv Q_1^1 \,. \tag{8.46}$$

We can extract higher coefficients too. Let $k \geqslant 1$. Then the $[x_2^k]$ coefficient is

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= Q_1^k - tS_1^{-1}Q_1^{k+1} - tS_1^0 Q_1^k - tS_1^1 Q_1^{k-1} - c_2 Q_{1,2}^{k,0} \\ &\quad + t\overline{x}_2(S_{1,2}^{-1,-1}Q_{1,2}^{k+1,0} + S_{1,2}^{0,-1}Q_{1,2}^{k,0} + S_{1,2}^{1,-1}Q_{1,2}^{k-1,0}) \\ &= Q_1^k - tvQ_1^{k+1} - tvQ_1^{k-1} - c_2 Q_{1,2}^{k,0} + t\overline{x}_2(Q_{1,2}^{k+1,0} + Q_{1,2}^{k-1,0}) \,. \end{aligned} \tag{8.47}$$

We can re-write the last one in a form more convenient for the next few steps

$$Q_1^k = tv(Q_1^{k+1} + Q_1^{k-1}) + c_2 Q_{1,2}^{k,0} - t\overline{x}_2(Q_{1,2}^{k+1,0} + Q_{1,2}^{k-1,0}) \,. \tag{8.48}$$

We'll use induction to prove a nice formula but for that we'll first need to establish another base case because of this splitting of cases for the coefficient extraction. We have

$$Q_1^0 = \overline{a}_2 + c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + a_1 tv Q_1^1 \,, \tag{8.49}$$

$$Q_1^{0,*} = \overline{a}_2 + c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + a_1 tv Q_1^{1,*} \,. \tag{8.50}$$

Combining them with equation (8.43) gives

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= R^* Q_1^0 - RQ_1^{0,*} - c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + \overline{a}_2\delta_0 \\ &= R^*(\overline{a}_2 + c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + a_1 tv Q_1^1) - R(\overline{a}_2 + c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + a_1 tv Q_1^{1,*}) \\ &\quad - c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + \overline{a}_2\delta_0 \\ &= a_1 tv(R^* Q_1^1 - RQ_1^{1,*}) + (R^* - R)(\overline{a}_2 + c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,0}) \\ &\quad - c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + \overline{a}_2\delta_0 \\ &= a_1 tv(R^* Q_1^1 - RQ_1^{1,*}) + \overline{a}_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2) + \overline{a}_2\delta_0 \\ &= a_1 tv(R^* Q_1^1 - RQ_1^{1,*}) + \overline{a}_2((\overline{x}_2 - x_2) + \delta_0) \,. \end{aligned} \tag{8.51}$$

So we can write the equation

$$R^*Q_1^1 - RQ_1^{1,*} + \overline{a}_2\delta_1 = 0 \tag{8.52}$$

where

$$\delta_1 = \frac{(\overline{x}_2 - x_2) + \delta_0}{a_1 tv}\,. \tag{8.53}$$

This equation together with equation (8.43) form the base cases for the following lemma

Lemma 103. *Let $m \geqslant 0$ be an integer. Then*

$$R^*Q_1^m - RQ_1^{m,*} - c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{m,0} + \overline{a}_2\delta_m = 0 \tag{8.54}$$

where δ_m is not a function of a_2.

Proof. We'll show this by induction. We have the base cases $m = 0$ and $m = 1$. The latter one fits the pattern because $Q_{1,2}^{1,0} = 0$ since we cannot have any walks end on coordinates $(1, 0)$. Now we assume that the formula is true for all cases up to and including m. Then we use formula (8.48)

$$\begin{aligned}
&R^*Q_1^m - RQ_1^{m,*}\\
=&tv(R^*Q_1^{m+1} - RQ_1^{m+1,*}) + tv(R^*Q_1^{m-1} - RQ_1^{m-1,*})\\
&+ c_2(R^* - R)Q_{1,2}^{m,0} - t(\overline{x}_2R^* - x_2R)(Q_{1,2}^{m+1,0} + Q_{1,2}^{m-1,0})\\
=&tv(R^*Q_1^{m+1} - RQ_1^{m+1,*}) + tv(c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{m-1,0} - \overline{a}_2\delta_{m-1})\\
&+ c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{m,0} - c_2tv(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)(Q_{1,2}^{m+1,0} + Q_{1,2}^{m-1,0})\\
=&tv(R^*Q_1^{m+1} - RQ_1^{m+1,*}) + c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{m,0}\\
&- c_2tv(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{m+1,0}) - \overline{a}_2tv\delta_{m-1})\,.
\end{aligned} \tag{8.55}$$

Combining this with equation (8.54) leads to

$$0 = tv(R^*Q_1^{m+1} - RQ_1^{m+1,*}) - c_2tv(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{m+1,0} - \overline{a}_2tv\delta_{m-1} + \overline{a}_2\delta_m\,, \tag{8.56}$$

$$0 = R^*Q_1^{m+1} - RQ_1^{m+1,*} - c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{m+1,0} + \overline{a}_2\delta_{m+1} \tag{8.57}$$

where

$$\delta_{m+1} = \frac{\delta_m}{tv} - \delta_{m-1}\,. \tag{8.58}$$

This function δ_{m+1} is also independent from a_2 and this completes the proof! □

There is an equivalent statement for Q_2^n. We can expand R^* and R to a form we can use

$$\begin{aligned} 0 = (c_2\overline{x}_2 - \overline{a}_2 x_2)Q_1^m(x_2) - (c_2 x_2 - \overline{a}_2\overline{x}_2)Q_1^m(\overline{x}_2) \\ - c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)Q_{1,2}^{m,0} + \overline{a}_2\delta_m \,. \end{aligned} \tag{8.59}$$

We start by extracting the $[x_2^1]$ coefficient

$$\begin{aligned} c_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,2} - \overline{a}_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,0} - c_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,0} + c_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,0} + [x_2^1]\overline{a}_2\delta_m = 0 \\ c_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,2} - \overline{a}_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,0} + [x_2^1]\overline{a}_2\delta_m = 0 \,. \end{aligned} \tag{8.60}$$

We can also extract the $[x_2^{n+1}]$ coefficient for $n \geqslant 2$

$$c_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,n+2} - \overline{a}_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,n} + [x_2^{n+1}]\overline{a}_2\delta_m = 0 \,. \tag{8.61}$$

This formula also contains the $n = 0$ case so we treat them together. We can set $a_2 = 1$ to get

$$-\breve{Q}_{1,2}^{m,n} + [x_2^{n+1}]\delta_m = 0 \,. \tag{8.62}$$

Substituting this back into the above equation gives

$$b_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,n+2} = Q_{1,2}^{m,n} - \breve{Q}_{1,2}^{m,n} \,. \tag{8.63}$$

An equivalent formula can be derived if the process is followed through the use of x_1 instead of x_2 in the analysis.

Corollary 104. *For integers $m, n \geqslant 0$ we have the following relations*

$$b_1 Q_{1,2}^{m+2,n} = Q_{1,2}^{m,n} - \widehat{Q}_{1,2}^{m,n} \,, \tag{8.64}$$

$$b_2 Q_{1,2}^{m,n+2} = Q_{1,2}^{m,n} - \breve{Q}_{1,2}^{m,n} \,. \tag{8.65}$$

We can sum up those equations to obtain functional equations

Corollary 105. *For integers $m \geqslant 0$ we have the following relations*

$$Q_1^m - \widehat{Q}_1^m = b_1 Q_1^{m+2}\,, \tag{8.66}$$

$$\breve{Q}_1^m - \breve{\widehat{Q}}_1^m = b_1 \breve{Q}_1^{m+2}\,, \tag{8.67}$$

$$x_1^2(Q_2^n - \widehat{Q}_2^n) = b_1(Q_2^n - Q_{1,2}^{1,n} x_1 - Q_{1,2}^{0,n})\,, \tag{8.68}$$

$$x_1^2(\breve{Q}_2^n - \breve{\widehat{Q}}_2^n) = b_1(\breve{Q}_2^n - \breve{Q}_{1,2}^{1,n} x_1 - \breve{Q}_{1,2}^{0,n})\,, \tag{8.69}$$

$$x_1^2(Q - \widehat{Q}) = b_1(Q - x_1 Q_1^1 - Q_1^0)\,, \tag{8.70}$$

$$x_1^2(\breve{Q} - \breve{\widehat{Q}}) = b_1(\breve{Q} - x_1 \breve{Q}_1^1 - \breve{Q}_1^0)\,. \tag{8.71}$$

Corollary 106. *For integers $n \geqslant 0$ we have the following relations*

$$Q_2^n - \breve{Q}_2^n = b_2 Q_2^{n+2}\,, \tag{8.72}$$

$$\widehat{Q}_2^n - \breve{\widehat{Q}}_2^n = b_2 \widehat{Q}_2^{n+2}\,, \tag{8.73}$$

$$x_2^2(Q_1^m - \breve{Q}_1^m) = b_2(Q_1^m - Q_{1,2}^{m,1} x_1 - Q_{1,2}^{m,0})\,, \tag{8.74}$$

$$x_2^2(\widehat{Q}_1^m - \breve{\widehat{Q}}_1^m) = b_2(\widehat{Q}_1^m - \widehat{Q}_{1,2}^{m,1} x_1 - \widehat{Q}_{1,2}^{m,0})\,, \tag{8.75}$$

$$x_2^2(Q - \breve{Q}) = b_2(Q - x_2 Q_2^1 - Q_2^0)\,, \tag{8.76}$$

$$x_2^2(\widehat{Q} - \breve{\widehat{Q}}) = b_2(\widehat{Q} - x_2 \widehat{Q}_2^1 - \widehat{Q}_2^0)\,. \tag{8.77}$$

Every other equation is obtained from the previous one by either setting $a_1 = 1$ or $a_2 = 1$. Here we can hope to find some telescoping sum type of thing in order to say more about $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$

Now we can move onto the main result about the diagonal walks and it is that the function for labelled walks ending at $(0, 0)$ is connected to the functions for semi-labelled and unlabelled walks endind at $(0, 0)$. We can use the master equation to extract the $[x_1^0 x_2^0]$ and $[x_1^1 x_2^1]$ coefficients yielding the following two relations

$$Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = 1 + t a_1 a_2 Q_{1,2}^{1,1}\,, \tag{8.78}$$

$$Q_{1,2}^{1,1} = t(Q_{1,2}^{0,0} + Q_{1,2}^{2,0} + Q_{1,2}^{0,2} + Q_{1,2}^{2,2})\,. \tag{8.79}$$

We also have

$$\begin{aligned} b_1 b_2 Q^{2,2}_{1,2} &= b_1 (Q^{2,0}_{1,2} - \breve{Q}^{2,0}_{1,2}) \,, \\ &= b_1 Q^{2,0}_{1,2} - b_1 \breve{Q}^{2,0}_{1,2} \,, \\ &= Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - \widehat{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} - \breve{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} + \breve{\widehat{Q}}^{0,0}_{1,2} \,, \end{aligned} \tag{8.80}$$

together with

$$b_1 b_2 Q^{2,0}_{1,2} = b_2 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - b_2 \widehat{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} \,, \tag{8.81}$$

$$b_1 b_2 Q^{0,2}_{1,2} = b_1 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - b_1 \breve{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} \,. \tag{8.82}$$

We we have

$$\begin{aligned} b_1 b_2 Q^{1,1}_{1,2} &= t(b_1 b_2 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} + b_1 b_2 Q^{2,0}_{1,2} + b_1 b_2 Q^{0,2}_{1,2} + b_1 b_2 Q^{2,2}_{1,2}) \\ &= t(b_1 b_2 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} + b_2 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - b_2 \widehat{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} + b_1 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} \\ &\quad - b_1 \breve{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} + Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - \widehat{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} - \breve{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} + \breve{\widehat{Q}}^{0,0}_{1,2}) \\ &= t((b_1 b_2 + b_1 + b_2 + 1) Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - (b_2 + 1) \widehat{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} \\ &\quad - (b_1 + 1) \breve{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} + \breve{\widehat{Q}}^{0,0}_{1,2}) \\ &= t(a_1 a_2 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - a_2 \widehat{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} - a_1 \breve{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} + \breve{\widehat{Q}}^{0,0}_{1,2}) \,, \end{aligned} \tag{8.83}$$

We can finally write

$$\begin{aligned} b_1 b_2 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} &= b_1 b_2 + t a_1 a_2 b_1 b_2 Q^{1,1}_{1,2} \\ &= b_1 b_2 + t^2 a_1 a_2 (a_1 a_2 Q^{0,0}_{1,2} - a_2 \widehat{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} - a_1 \breve{Q}^{0,0}_{1,2} + \breve{\widehat{Q}}^{0,0}_{1,2}) \,. \end{aligned} \tag{8.84}$$

Let $G(b_1, b_2)$ stand for $Q(0, 0, b_1, b_2)$ and G_k has $b_k = 0$. Then we can write it all as

$$b_1 b_2 G = b_1 b_2 + t^2 a_1 a_2 (a_1 a_2 G - a_2 G_1 - a_1 G_2 + G_{1,2}) \tag{8.85}$$

or written as a linear combination

$$(b_1 b_2 - t^2 a_1^2 a_2^2) G + t^2 a_1 a_2^2 G_1 + t^2 a_1^2 a_2 G_2 - t^2 a_1 a_2 G_{1,2} = b_1 b_2 \,. \tag{8.86}$$

We can divide out by $a_1 a_2$ and obtain the equation

$$(c_1 c_2 - a_1 a_2 t^2)G + a_2 t^2 G_1 + a_1 t^2 G_2 - t^2 G_{1,2} = c_1 c_2 \,, \tag{8.87}$$

from which we can read off

$$f(a_1, a_2, t) = c_1 c_2 - a_1 a_2 t^2 \tag{8.88}$$

and

$$G = \frac{(c_1 c_2 - t^2(a_2 G_1 + a_1 G_2 - G_{1,2})}{f(a_1, a_2, t)} \tag{8.89}$$

where $B(fG) = c_1 c_2$. Also, we can solve for Q_k^j and other terms, in terms of various $[b_k^l]$ extractions, so overall it should lead to a relationship of the form $B(FQ) = 0$.

8.3 The full model

We skip right to the final model - the one with all the possible small step. Here we have the most complicated functions. Here

$$\frac{\alpha(K_2^* - K_2)}{K_1} = \frac{\alpha(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)(1+t)}{S_1^1 K_1} \,, \tag{8.90}$$

$$\frac{\Delta_2(K_2^* K_{12})}{K_1} = \frac{c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)(c_1(1+t) - t\overline{\sigma}_1 S_1^1)}{S_1^1(c_1 - t\overline{\sigma}_1 S_1^1)} \tag{8.91}$$

$$= \frac{c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2))}{S_1^1}\left(1 - \frac{t}{c_1 - t\overline{\sigma}_1 S_1^1}\right) . \tag{8.92}$$

We'll need to do some more work to find a representation for that last fraction. For that we'll need to σ_1 root which is

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_1 &= \frac{(1 - tS_1^0) - \sqrt{(1 - tS_1^0)^2 - 4t^2(S_1^1)^2}}{2tS_1^1} \\ &= \frac{u - \sqrt{u^2 - 4w^2}}{2w} \end{aligned} \tag{8.93}$$

$$\overline{\sigma}_1 = \frac{u + \sqrt{u^2 - 4w^2}}{2w} \tag{8.94}$$

Then we have

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{t}{c_1 - \overline{\sigma}_1 w} &= \frac{2t}{2c_1 - u - \sqrt{u^2 - 4w^2)}} \\ &= \frac{2t(2c_1 - u + \sqrt{u^2 - 4w^2})}{(2c_1 - u)^2 - (u^2 - 4w^2)} \\ &= \frac{t(2c_1 - u + \sqrt{u^2 - 4w^2})}{2(c_1^2 - c_1 u + w^2)}\end{aligned} \tag{8.95}$$

Let $v = \overline{x}_2 + x_2$. Then the denominator has

$$\begin{aligned}c_1^2 - c_1 u + w^2 &= c_1^2 - c_1(1 - tS_1^0) + t^2(S_1^1)^2 \\ &= \overline{a}_1^2 b_1 - \overline{a}_1 b_1 v t + (1+v)^2 t^2\end{aligned} \tag{8.96}$$

and the numerator has

$$\begin{aligned}u^2 - 4w^2 &= (1 - tv)^2 - 4t^2(1+v)^2 \\ &= 1 - 2tv - (3v+2)(v+2)t^2 \\ &= (1 - (3v+2)t)(1 + (v+2)t)\,.\end{aligned} \tag{8.97}$$

Thus the square root has the expansion

$$\sqrt{u^2 - 4w^2} = 1 - vt - 2(1+v)^2 t^2 - 2v(1+v)^2 t^3 + \cdots \tag{8.98}$$

We can give a series representation of the square root via the series

$$\sqrt{1-z} = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(2n)!}{(1-2n)(n!)^2 4^n} z^n\,. \tag{8.99}$$

That is,

$$\begin{aligned}&\sqrt{(1 + (v+2)t)(1 - (3v+2)t)} \\ &= \left(\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n (2n)! (v+2)^n t^n}{(1-2n)(n!)^2 4^n}\right)\left(\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(2n)!(3v+2)^n t^n}{(1-2n)(n!)^2 4^n}\right) \\ &= \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{t^n}{4^n} \sum_{k=0}^{n} \frac{(-1)^k (2k)!(2n-2k)!}{(1-2k)(1-2n+2k)k!^2 (n-k)!^2} (v+2)^k (3v+2)^{n-k}\,,\end{aligned} \tag{8.100}$$

But we're not sure if a closed form exists for these coefficients. If we want to extract x_2 coefficients from this expression we wouldn't have an easy time. Now K_2 and K_2^* will have $1 + v$ in

their denominators so we can multiply the whole functional equation by $1+v$ to clear out these denominator. We have

$$(1+v)K_2 = c_2(1+v) - \overline{x}_2(1+t) = (c_2 - 1 - t)\overline{x}_2 + c_2 + c_2 x_2\,, \tag{8.101}$$

$$(1+v)K_2^* = c_2(1+v) - x_2(1+t) = c_2\overline{x}_2 + c_2 + (c_2 - 1 - t)x_2\,, \tag{8.102}$$

and

$$(1+v)\frac{\alpha(K_2^* - K_2)}{K_1} = \frac{\alpha(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)(1+t)}{K_1} = \alpha g(a_1, x_2, t)\,, \tag{8.103}$$

$$(1+v)\frac{\Delta_2(K_2^* K_{12})}{K_1} = c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)\left(1 - t\frac{c_1 - 1 + tv + \sqrt{(1+(v+2)t)(1-(3v+2)t)}}{c_1^2 - c_1 + c_1 tv + (1+v)^2 t^2}\right)\,, \tag{8.104}$$

and let the latter be $c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)f(a_1, x_2, t)$. Then if we let $A = c_2 - (1+t)$ we can write the funtional equation as

$$(c_2\overline{x}_2 + c_2 + Ax_2)Q_1^0(x_2) - (A\overline{x}_2 + c_2 + c_2 x_2)Q_1^0(\overline{x}_2) = c_2(\overline{x}_2 - x_2)f - \alpha g\,. \tag{8.105}$$

As before, we extract the $[x_2]$ coefficient from both sides to obtain

$$c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,2} + c_2 Q_{1,2}^{0,1} - (1+t)Q_{1,2}^{0,0} = -\alpha g_2^1 + c_2(f_2^2 - f_2^0)Q_{1,2}^{0,0}\,, \tag{8.106}$$

and then set $a_2 = 1$ on both sides to find that

$$-(1+t)\check{Q}_{1,2}^{0,0} = -\overline{a}_1 g_2^1\,. \tag{8.107}$$

When we finally substitute this quantity back into the equation we can simplify it to

$$b_2(Q_{1,2}^{0,2} + Q_{1,2}^{0,1}) = (b_2(f_2^2 - f_2^0) - a_2(1+t))Q_{1,2}^{0,0} - (1+t)\check{Q}_{1,2}^{0,0}\,. \tag{8.108}$$

The question is can we find the quantity $f_2^2 - f_2^0$? It appears that

$$-(f_2^2 - f_2^0) = 1 + a_1 t + \frac{a_1^2}{b_1}(a_1^2 - a_1 - 4)t^3 + \frac{4a_1^2}{b_1^2}(a_1^3 - 3a_1^2 + 1)t^4 + \cdots \tag{8.109}$$

which is not a nice form. Unfortunately we haven't been able to go further with this case. One could try making some assumptions for the form of equations like these for $Q_{1,2}^{m,n}$,$\breve{Q}_{1,2}^{m,n}$ and $\widehat{Q}_{1,2}^{m,n}$ but even then it's not clear if one find a relation between $Q_{1,2}^{0,0}$, $\breve{Q}_{1,2}^{0,0}$,$\widehat{Q}_{1,2}^{0,0}$ and $\breve{\widehat{Q}}_{1,2}^{0,0}$. We would have 6 equations like the one above plus 6 more where $b_i = 0$ for the b_i not present. Then one may use the 4 regular coefficient extractions from the master functional equation for $Q_{1,2}^{m,n}$ and $m, n \leqslant 1$ plus 12 more where we set one or more of b_1, b_2 to zero. This brings us to a grand total of 28 equations in 36 unknown variables of which we need to eliminate 32. It's not entirely clear if we may do that.

Chapter 9

Epilogue

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